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Fact Validator

A Deployment-Oriented and Auditable Prototype for Open-Domain Fact Verification

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Research and Reproducibility Statement

I confirm that this manuscript presents research that I have carried out as part of my Master’s thesis in Data Science at the University of Naples Federico II.

The thesis-support apparatus used for this revision is on the dedicated thesis correction branch; it is not represented as being on `main`. Before submission, the exact manuscript source, generated tables, figures, dependency lock, and matching PDF must be committed together, and that immutable commit hash must be recorded in the submission. The machine-readable benchmark manifest and audit report are stored under `data/benchmarks/results_5000/`. No Git release tag is claimed.

I designed and implemented the FACT VALIDATOR architecture, prepared the multi-dataset evaluation workflow, executed the experiments reported in this document, and analysed the resulting predictive and operational behaviour.

The document distinguishes executed measurements from recommendations; no unexecuted experiment is presented as a result. The historical 5,000-claim evaluation is reproducible as an artifact but exploratory rather than confirmatory because development was informed by observations on that benchmark and retrospective normalization found cross-split overlaps.

Scope of the thesis. The repository contains two separate evaluation surfaces. The FACT VALIDATOR live application implements open-web retrieval, domain credibility scoring, semantic reranking, persistence, and optional Ollama debate. The 5,000-claim experiment evaluates the deterministic FACTVALIDATOR-PROXY, which combines lexical classification, category-level priors, heuristic semantic signals, deterministic arbitration, and a quality filter. It does not execute SerpAPI, live domain scoring, SentenceTransformer reranking, or Ollama debate for every test claim. Chapter 9 documents a separate evidence-graph prototype that is not part of the 5,000-claim proxy evaluation.

Abstract

In this thesis, I investigate how an open-domain fact-checking system can combine evidence retrieval, explicit source-credibility reasoning, reproducible benchmarking, and deployment-oriented engineering within a single auditable pipeline.

I have developed a working prototype called FACT VALIDATOR. The system accepts raw text or a URL, extracts fact-like claims, retrieves supporting and contradicting evidence, evaluates source credibility through an explicit and inspectable prior, semantically reranks the evidence, and produces claim-level verdicts. These verdicts are combined into a final misinformation-likelihood score, together with evidence summaries and confidence information.

The exploratory study uses a versioned 5,000-claim benchmark assembled from FEVER, LIAR, SciFact, and the PUBHEALTH `health_fact` dataset stored under a legacy healthver compatibility name. The full FACTVALIDATOR-PROXY reaches 50.82% accuracy and 0.4384 macro-F1. A proxy version without deterministic debate reaches 51.34% accuracy and 0.4427 macro-F1. A FEVER-aware proxy reaches 50.98% accuracy and 0.4421 macro-F1. These descriptive findings are not measurements of the live application, are not statistically confirmatory, and are not evidence of state-of-the-art superiority.

The proxy results also reveal a large raw-score confidence–accuracy gap. Because the stored score is heuristic and not a complete multiclass probability distribution, the result is reported as a raw-score calibration diagnostic rather than probability calibration.

Beyond the evaluated proxy, I implemented a typed, provenance-constrained evidence-graph prototype with a deterministic audit layer. Chapter 9 reports its thesis status: the corrected repository’s 164-test backend suite passes and a small corruption-scenario probe demonstrates one concrete mechanism (source-independence clustering) by which it changes a decision relative to a simpler baseline. It remains intentionally separate from the proxy and therefore does not alter the 5,000-claim results.

Sommario (Italiano). In questa tesi analizzo come un sistema di verifica automatica dei fatti in dominio aperto possa combinare il recupero di evidenze testuali, un meccanismo esplicito e ispezionabile di stima dell’affidabilità delle fonti, un protocollo di valutazione riproducibile e un’ingegneria orientata al deployment. Ho sviluppato

l'applicazione live FACT VALIDATOR e, separatamente, ho valutato il modello deterministico FACTVALIDATOR-PROXY su 5.000 affermazioni tratte da FEVER, LIAR, SciFact e PUBHEALTH. Il proxy completo raggiunge un'accuratezza del 50,82% e un macro-F1 di 0,4384; la variante proxy senza arbitraggio deterministico raggiunge il 51,34% e 0,4427. L'esperimento non esegue il recupero SerpAPI, il reranking SentenceTransformer o il dibattito Ollama per ogni affermazione.

Contribution and Evidence Boundary

The principal contribution is an engineering integration of open-web retrieval, explicit and inspectable source priors, evidence presentation, persistence, optional local-model arbitration, and reproducibility artifacts. The live application is implemented and software-tested. The deterministic proxy has an exploratory 5,000-claim evaluation whose small raw differences over majority and length baselines do not survive Holm correction. Chapter 9 documents a preliminary graph-auditor probe; eight synthetic cases do not establish a new empirical method.

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Chapter 1

Introduction

Misinformation detection is often treated only as a classification problem. However, I believe that a practical fact-checking system must solve a wider set of problems.

It must identify which statements can be verified, retrieve relevant evidence, distinguish supporting information from contradicting information, estimate the reliability of different sources, communicate uncertainty, and remain usable when external tools or models are unavailable.

A system may achieve a reasonable benchmark score while still being unsuitable for practical use if its evidence cannot be traced, its confidence is misleading, or its decisions depend on hidden assumptions.

For this reason, I approach fact verification as a combined machine-learning, information-retrieval, software-engineering, and trustworthy-AI problem. This chapter states the research question, the concrete objectives that follow from it, the evaluation questions used throughout the thesis, a summary of the completed work, and the final scope of each component.

1.1 Central Research Question

The central research question guiding my work is:

Can I design an end-to-end fact-checking architecture that balances verification quality, source-level transparency, reproducibility, and deployment realism without hiding source-trust decisions inside a black-box model?

This question has three parts that recur throughout the thesis. *Verification quality* is addressed empirically in Chapter 6 through the deterministic FACTVALIDATOR-PROXY benchmark. *Source-level transparency* is addressed architecturally in Chapter 4 through the live application’s explicit credibility mechanism. *Deployment realism* is addressed

through the implemented application, bounded demonstrations, operational projections, and security posture. These evidence streams are complementary but are not merged into one empirical claim.

1.2 Research Objectives

I have defined the following objectives:

1. Design and implement a full-stack workflow for claim extraction and evidence-backed fact verification.
2. Represent source trust through an explicit and reviewable credibility mechanism.
3. Compare a deterministic proxy of the architecture with simple baselines and component-level ablations.
4. Evaluate proxy predictive quality and report bounded operational scenarios for the live application.
5. Preserve claims, evidence, predictions, and intermediate outputs to support reproducibility.
6. Measure whether optional components, particularly debate arbitration, provide enough benefit to justify their computational cost.
7. Identify uncertainty, calibration, data-quality, and validity limitations before making stronger scientific claims.
8. Formalize every metric used in the evaluation as an explicit mathematical definition, so that the empirical chapters can be read and checked independently of the code that produced them.

1.3 Evaluation Questions

I organize the present evaluation around five research questions.

RQ1: Predictive behaviour. How does the deterministic FACTVALIDATOR-PROXY compare with majority, length, keyword, sentiment, and random baselines?

RQ2: Component contribution. How does removing deterministic debate arbitration affect proxy accuracy and macro-F1, and what separate latency scenario motivates selective rather than always-on live debate?

RQ3: Domain variation. How does the system behave across encyclopaedic, political, scientific, and health-related claims?

RQ4: Operational trade-offs. What latency and retrieval-cost trade-offs are introduced by optional debate and web-evidence retrieval?

RQ5: Prototype divergence (*scoped to Chapter 9 only*). For the advanced evidence-graph prototype: under which specific corruption mechanisms does its deterministic auditor change the system’s decision relative to a graph-only baseline, and under which mechanisms is that effect currently masked by upstream relation-classification limitations? RQ5 is deliberately kept out of RQ1–RQ4, since the prototype is not part of the evaluated pipeline those questions describe.

1.4 Completed Contributions

The following contributions were completed within this thesis:

1. I designed a nine-stage end-to-end fact-verification architecture.
2. I implemented a working full-stack prototype using Next.js, FastAPI, SQLite, caching, retrieval services, and optional model components.
3. I developed an explicit source-credibility mechanism whose decisions can be inspected and modified without retraining the complete system.
4. I prepared a versioned evaluation workflow combining four heterogeneous fact-verification datasets.
5. I executed an exploratory 5,000-claim evaluation of the deterministic FACTVALIDATOR-PROXY and compared it with multiple baselines and variants.
6. I measured proxy predictive behaviour and produced explicitly labelled operational projections for latency, throughput, and retrieval cost.
7. I documented negative and inconclusive findings, including the lack of benefit from always-on proxy arbitration and the proxy’s large raw-score confidence gap.
8. I implemented and independently verified an advanced evidence-graph prototype module, and documented precisely which safety mechanisms changed decisions and which remained masked by the current classifier (Chapter 9).
9. I formalized the mathematical definitions of every metric reported in the thesis (Chapter 3) and expanded the architectural, sequence, and comparative diagrams (Chapters 4, 9, and 10).

1.5 Final Research Scope

Table 1.1: Final status of the research components at thesis submission.

Research component	Final status	Comment
End-to-end architecture	Implemented	The complete nine-stage workflow is operational.
Full-stack prototype	Implemented	Next.js, FastAPI, SQLite, caching, retrieval, and reporting are integrated.
Dataset split and overlap audit	Completed	Strong normalization identified 19 train-validation, 34 train-test, and 5 validation-test exact overlaps; the 39 affected test claims are removed in a 4,961-claim sensitivity analysis.
5,000-claim proxy evaluation	Completed, exploratory	Exactly 5,000 aligned predictions per system are reported descriptively, alongside the exact-overlap sensitivity analysis.
Baseline comparison	Completed	Majority, random, length, keyword, and sentiment baselines are included.
Component ablation	Completed within scope	The debate-free and reported frozen variants were evaluated; broader ablations are future work.
Confidence analysis	Completed descriptively	The confidence-accuracy gap establishes substantial overconfidence; post-hoc calibration is recommended.
Paired statistical testing	Completed	Exact two-sided McNemar tests, paired-bootstrap intervals, Holm correction, risk differences, and matched odds ratios are generated from the frozen prediction CSVs.
Evidence preservation	Completed at artifact level	Proxy splits, predictions, hashes, manifests, and generated reports are retained. Live retrieval records are separate and are not used as proxy evidence.
Evidence-graph prototype	Implemented prototype	164/164 backend tests pass on the audited repository; the prototype is reported separately from the proxy evaluation (Chapter 9).
Final thesis revision	Completed	This manuscript is the completed defence version.

1.6 Thesis Structure

The remainder of this thesis is organized as follows. Chapter 2 situates the work relative to prior literature. Chapter 3 gives the mathematical definitions of every metric used later. Chapter 4 describes the nine-stage architecture. Chapter 5 describes the dataset and experimental design. Chapter 6 reports the exploratory historical results. Chapter 7 discusses their meaning. Chapter 8 states limitations and threats to validity. Chapter 9 documents the preliminary evidence-graph prototype separately from the proxy. Chapter 10 gives a structured comparative and novelty analysis. Chapter 11 records corrections required for confirmatory evaluation. Chapter 12 sketches research directions, and Chapter 13 concludes. Appendices provide the audit-rule inventory, test coverage, corruption-probe materials, source-code listings, glossary, and mathematical notation.

Chapter 2

Related Work

2.1 Automated Fact Verification

FEVER established a large-scale setting for claim verification using evidence from Wikipedia [1]. LIAR contains real political statements with fine-grained truthfulness labels [2]. SciFact focuses on scientific claim verification using evidence from research abstracts [3].

These datasets were created for different purposes and use different annotation schemes. Combining them creates methodological challenges, but it also allows me to investigate whether the architecture behaves consistently across different domains. Table 2.1 summarizes the four source datasets on the dimensions that matter for this thesis: label granularity, evidence format, and domain.

Automated fact-checking is normally decomposed into claim detection, evidence retrieval, evidence assessment, and verdict prediction [11]. That decomposition is important here because software tests of an end-to-end application, predictive evaluation of a proxy, and human usefulness of presented evidence are different forms of evidence and must not be substituted for one another.

Table 2.1: Source datasets and their original task definitions.

Dataset	Domain	Original labels	Evidence format
FEVER	Encyclopaedic (Wikipedia)	SUPPORTS / REFUTES / NOT ENOUGH INFO	Sentence-level, closed corpus
LIAR	Political statements	six-way truthfulness scale	No structured evidence; speaker/context metadata
SciFact	Scientific claims	SUPPORT / CONTRADICT / NEI	Rationale sentences from abstracts
PUBHEALTH (health_fact)	Mixed public-health and general fact-checking claims	Numerical veracity labels	Article-level, heterogeneous sources

2.2 Tool-Augmented Factuality Analysis

FacTool treats factuality detection as a modular process in which external tools are used to retrieve and verify information [4].

This approach is conceptually close to my work because I also avoid relying on a single language model to generate an unsupported verdict. My work differs in emphasis. I focus explicitly on source-credibility rules, persistent evidence storage, caching, service failure, bounded operational demonstrations and projections, and a user-facing misinformation-analysis workflow.

Truth-O-Meter combines web mining, natural-language inference, and defeasible-logic argumentation for conflicting sources [6]. Its dialectical reasoning is substantially richer than the simple typed graph and deterministic rules in Chapter 9. Truth-O-Meter’s reported numbers are not directly comparable with this thesis: the tasks, evidence conditions, label spaces, and evaluation procedures differ. Its public repository and tutorial material are useful implementation context, but they are not substitutes for the scholarly publication.

2.3 Faithful Factual Correction

Zero-shot Faithful Factual Error Correction studies the detection and correction of factual errors without task-specific retraining and evaluates correction faithfulness, including human judgments [5].

Its objective is primarily to correct text while preserving semantic faithfulness. My system primarily verifies and classifies; its correction functionality has not received a comparable benchmark or human evaluation.

2.4 Retrieval-Augmented AI

Retrieval-Augmented Generation demonstrates how external documents can be combined with parametric language models [7].

However, retrieval does not guarantee correctness. A retrieved document may be irrelevant, biased, outdated, duplicated, or unreliable. I therefore treat retrieval relevance and source reliability as separate problems: Section 4.6 (semantic reranking) addresses the first, Section 4.5 (credibility scoring) the second.

2.5 Calibration and Abstention

Modern machine-learning systems are frequently overconfident [8].

A system may assign high confidence to an incorrect prediction. This is particularly dangerous in misinformation analysis because users may interpret confidence as a guarantee. Research on abstention emphasizes that intelligent systems should recognize cases in which the available evidence is insufficient [9].

Confidence calibration and selective abstention are therefore important follow-up directions. Chapter 9’s audit layer is a rule-based, non-learned form of the same idea: rather than thresholding a scalar confidence score, it routes specific rule violations to distinct non-decisive outcomes. Section 9.7 returns to this connection and its limits.

2.6 Leakage and Evaluation Independence

Reproducible files are necessary but do not by themselves establish an independent evaluation. Leakage can arise through preprocessing, duplicate records, model selection, or repeated feedback from a nominal test set and can produce overoptimistic conclusions [12]. This distinction motivates the retrospective overlap audit in Chapter 5 and the decision to describe the 5,000-claim findings as exploratory.

2.7 Multi-Agent Debate

Multi-agent debate has been proposed as a method for improving factuality and reasoning by allowing different agents to challenge each other’s arguments [10].

I implemented an optional live Prover–Skeptic–Judge workflow. However, I do not assume that debate is automatically beneficial. The proxy benchmark shows that its separate deterministic arbitration rule does not improve accuracy, while the live-system scenario projects a large latency overhead. These are distinct observations, not one controlled quality–latency experiment (Section 6.4).

2.8 Positioning Summary

Table 2.2: Research positioning of FACT VALIDATOR relative to the principal literature threads above.

Dimension	FEVER/ LIAR/ SciFact	FacTool	Faithful correction	RAG	Calibration lit.	Debate lit.
Contributes	label vocabulary, benchmark data	modular tool orientation	faithfulness discipline	retrieval- plus- generation pattern	overconfidence framing	optional arbitration idea
FACT VALIDATOR adds	multi-dataset harmoniza- tion + domain breakdown	explicit, persisted, inspectable credibility prior	applies grounding to open-web verification, not correction	separates retrieval relevance from source reliability	documents a raw-score gap without claiming calibration	separates a deterministic proxy ablation from a live-debate cost scenario

Chapter 3

Mathematical Framework and Evaluation Metrics

This chapter collects, in one place, the exact mathematical definition of every quantity reported later in the thesis. Chapters 6 and 9 use these definitions without re-deriving them; this chapter is the single source of truth for what each number means.

3.1 Classification Metrics

Let $y_i \in \{\text{SUPPORTED}, \text{REFUTED}, \text{NEI}\}$ be the gold label for claim i and $\hat{y}_i$ the system's predicted label, over a test set of size n .

Accuracy.

$$\text{Accuracy} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \mathbf{1}[\hat{y}_i = y_i].$$

Per-class precision and recall. For class k , with TP_k , FP_k , FN_k the true positives, false positives, and false negatives for that class,

$$\text{Precision}_k = \frac{\text{TP}_k}{\text{TP}_k + \text{FP}_k}, \quad \text{Recall}_k = \frac{\text{TP}_k}{\text{TP}_k + \text{FN}_k}.$$

Per-class F1 and macro-F1.

$$F1_k = \frac{2 \cdot \text{Precision}_k \cdot \text{Recall}_k}{\text{Precision}_k + \text{Recall}_k}, \quad \text{Macro-F1} = \frac{1}{K} \sum_{k=1}^K F1_k,$$

where $K = 3$ is the number of classes. Macro-F1 weights every class equally regardless of its frequency, which is why it is reported alongside accuracy: a system can score well on accuracy while performing poorly on minority classes, and macro-F1 is designed to expose that gap (Section 6.3).

3.2 Confidence Intervals

For a binomial proportion such as accuracy, I report a 95% Wilson score interval. With $z = 1.96$, its center and half-width are

$$c = \frac{\hat{p} + \frac{z^2}{2n}}{1 + \frac{z^2}{n}}, \quad h = \frac{z}{1 + \frac{z^2}{n}} \sqrt{\frac{\hat{p}(1 - \hat{p})}{n} + \frac{z^2}{4n^2}},$$

so $\text{CI}_{95\%} = [c - h, c + h]$, where $\hat{p}$ is observed accuracy and n the test-set size. This interval describes uncertainty in a single system’s accuracy estimate; it does *not* by itself establish that two systems differ, which requires a paired analysis.

3.3 Confidence–Accuracy Gap

$$\text{RawGap} = \left| \frac{\overline{\text{score}}}{100} - \text{Accuracy} \right|,$$

where $\overline{\text{score}}$ is the proxy’s average heuristic score on its stored 0–100 scale. Division by 100 puts the diagnostic on the same 0–1 scale as accuracy. I do not treat this quantity as Expected Calibration Error or probability calibration; it is a raw-score diagnostic because a full class-probability vector was not stored.

3.4 Expected Calibration Error and Brier Score (Defined for Follow-up Evaluation)

These metrics cannot be computed properly from the frozen proxy artifact because it stores one heuristic score rather than probabilities for SUPPORTED, REFUTED, and NEI. They are defined here so that their meaning is unambiguous once future predictions store a complete class-probability vector. Partition predictions into M confidence bins $B_1, \dots, B_M$. Expected Calibration Error is

$$\text{ECE} = \sum_{m=1}^M \frac{|B_m|}{n} |\text{acc}(B_m) - \text{conf}(B_m)|,$$

where $\text{acc}(B_m)$ and $\text{conf}(B_m)$ are the average accuracy and average confidence of predictions falling in bin B_m . The Brier score, for a one-hot gold vector $\mathbf{y}_i$ and predicted probability vector $\mathbf{p}_i$ over the K classes, is

$$\text{Brier} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{k=1}^K (p_{i,k} - y_{i,k})^2.$$

Both are strictly more informative than the confidence–accuracy gap because they are sensitive to the *distribution* of confidence, not only its average.

3.5 Exact Paired Significance Testing

For comparing two variants (e.g. full proxy vs. debate-free proxy) on the *same* test items, an exact two-sided McNemar test is appropriate for a binary correct/incorrect outcome. With n_{01} the number of items the first system gets wrong and the second gets right, and n_{10} the reverse, the exact test conditions on $n_{01} + n_{10}$ discordant pairs and evaluates both tails of a binomial distribution with probability 0.5. The familiar continuity-corrected large-sample statistic is

$$\chi^2 = \frac{(|n_{01} - n_{10}| - 1)^2}{n_{01} + n_{10}},$$

and may be compared against a χ^2 distribution with one degree of freedom as an approximation. The final artifacts use the exact binomial form, paired-bootstrap intervals with seed 42, Holm correction across comparisons, paired risk differences, and matched-pair odds ratios.

3.6 Selective Prediction: Coverage, Selective Risk, and False-Accept Rate

These three metrics are used exclusively in Chapter 9 to evaluate the evidence-graph prototype’s abstention behaviour, reusing the standard selective-prediction formalism. Let $S_\theta \subseteq \{1, \dots, n\}$ be the subset of claims for which the system returns a decisive verdict (as opposed to abstaining). *Coverage* is the fraction of claims on which the system is willing to decide:

$$\text{Coverage} = \frac{|S_\theta|}{n}.$$

Selective risk is the error rate restricted to that decisive subset:

$$R(\theta) = \frac{1}{|S_\theta|} \sum_{i \in S_\theta} \mathbf{1}[\hat{y}_i \neq y_i].$$

False-accept rate is the fraction of decisive predictions that are not merely wrong but wrong in the unsafe direction (e.g. a refuted claim accepted as supported):

$$\text{FAR} = \frac{1}{|S_\theta|} \sum_{i \in S_\theta} \mathbf{1}[\hat{y}_i = \text{SUPPORTED} \wedge y_i = \text{REFUTED}].$$

A good selective system should show $R(\theta)$ decreasing as coverage decreases – that is, the claims it chooses to abstain from should disproportionately be the ones it would otherwise have gotten wrong. Section 9.6 reports these three quantities for both the eight-case synthetic seed and the extended corruption probe.

3.7 Source-Independence Clustering (Jaccard Similarity)

Used in the credibility and evidence-graph components (Sections 4.5 and 9.4) to detect duplicated or syndicated evidence. For two evidence items e_i, e_j with base domains d_i, d_j and token sets T_i, T_j ,

$$\text{linked}(e_i, e_j) = [d_i = d_j] \vee \left[\frac{|T_i \cap T_j|}{|T_i \cup T_j|} \geq \tau \right],$$

with threshold $\tau = 0.78$ in the shipped configuration. Connected components of this relation form independence clusters (Section 9.4).

3.8 Credibility Score

$$\text{Credibility}(d) = \text{clip}_{[0,100]}(50 + b(d) + p(d)),$$

where d is the domain of an evidence source, $b(d)$ a sum of rule-based bonuses, and $p(d)$ a sum of rule-based penalties (Section 4.5).

3.9 Operational Metrics

Throughput is the reciprocal of mean per-claim latency, scaled to an hourly rate:

$$\text{Throughput (claims/hour)} = \frac{3600}{\overline{\text{latency}} \text{ (s/claim)}}.$$

Debate overhead is the ratio of mean latency with debate enabled to mean latency without it:

$$\text{Overhead} = \frac{\overline{\text{latency}}_{\text{debate}}}{\overline{\text{latency}}_{\text{baseline}}}.$$

These formulas are used in Section 6.6 with scenario assumptions of 8.20 s/claim and 72.00 s/claim. The resulting throughput and overhead figures are projections, not controlled load-test measurements.

3.10 Complexity Bounds (Prototype Module)

For completeness, the asymptotic bounds governing the Chapter 9 prototype: claim decomposition and passage scoring are linear in the number of input and page sentences; pairwise independence comparison is $O(q^2v)$ for q evidence items and average token-set comparison cost v ; graph audit is linear in nodes and edges after clustering. These bounds are not used elsewhere in the thesis but are recorded here as part of the single reference chapter for all formal claims.

Chapter 4

System Architecture

4.1 Architecture Overview

I designed FACT VALIDATOR as a nine-stage architecture that separates evidence retrieval, source-trust reasoning, model inference, optional debate, final scoring, and persistent auditing. Figure 4.1 gives the pipeline view; Figure 4.2 gives a request-level sequence view of the same architecture, showing which component calls which for a single `/analyze` request; Figure 4.3 gives a data-oriented view, showing what is persisted at each stage rather than which function calls which.

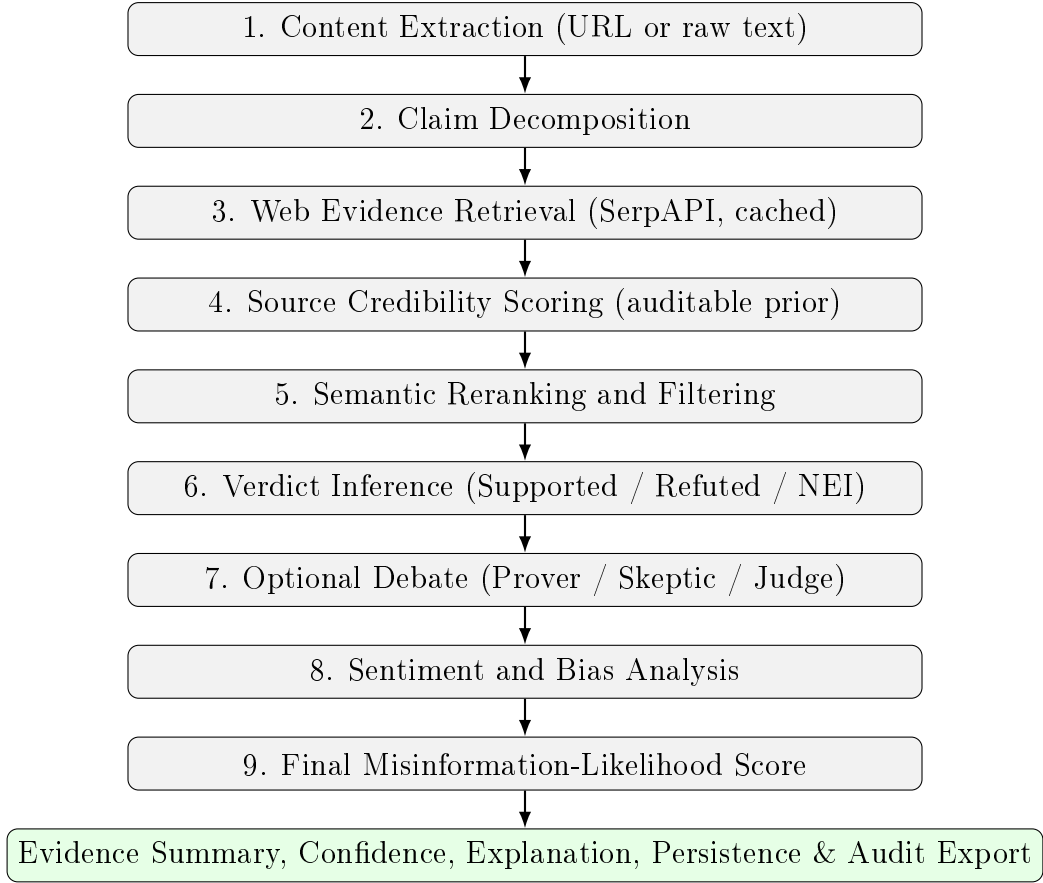


Figure 4.1: Pipeline view: end-to-end architecture of FACT VALIDATOR. Stage 7 (debate) is bypassable; Stage 4’s credibility prior is explicit and inspectable rather than learned end-to-end.

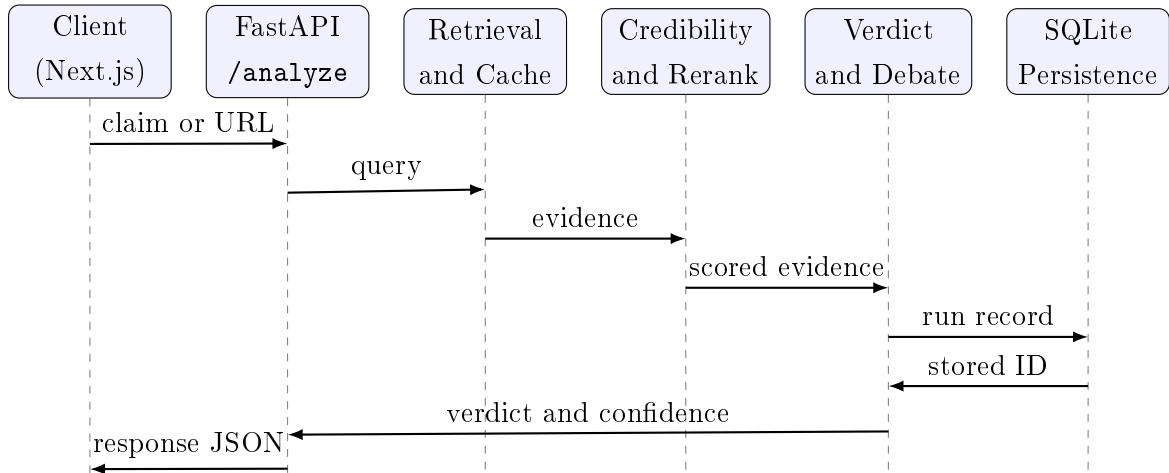


Figure 4.2: Sequence view of a single POST `/analyze` request, showing component interaction order.

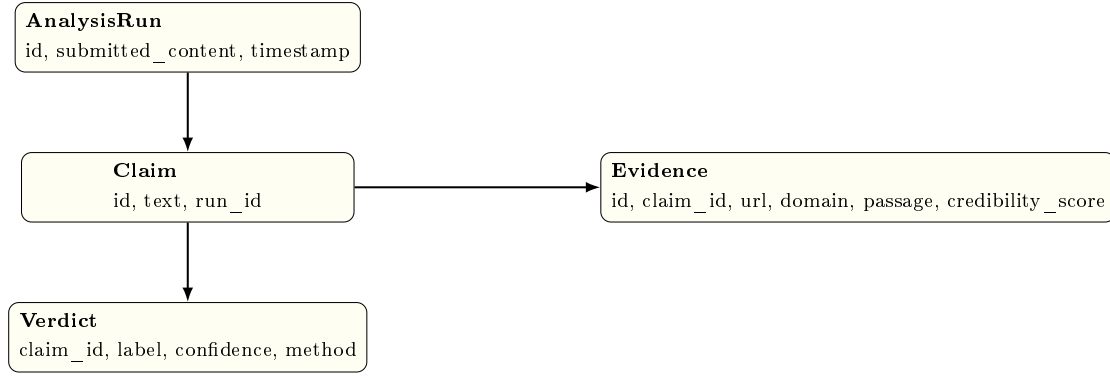


Figure 4.3: Data view: persisted entities per analysis run (SQLite schema, simplified).

4.2 Content Extraction

I allow users to submit raw text or a URL. For a URL, the extraction layer retrieves the page, removes irrelevant structural elements, and prepares the remaining content for claim decomposition. For raw text, the system applies normalization directly.

4.3 Claim Decomposition

Long documents may contain several factual statements. I therefore decompose the input into smaller claims that can be verified independently. This is important because one article may contain a mixture of supported, refuted, and unverifiable statements.

4.4 Evidence Retrieval

For each claim, I create retrieval queries and obtain candidate evidence from the web. The current implementation uses SerpAPI as the external search interface. Because web results change over time, I store retrieval outputs and use caching to reduce repeated requests.

4.5 Auditable Source-Credibility Scoring

I designed the source-credibility component to remain explicit rather than fully hidden inside a learned model. The score is defined in Section 3.8. The submitted system uses the documented rule weights; calibration against independently annotated source-evidence pairs is recommended as post-thesis work.

The advantage of this approach is not that the rules are automatically correct. The advantage is that each trust decision can be inspected, challenged, and modified without retraining the complete system. Figure 4.4 shows the decision path for a single domain score.

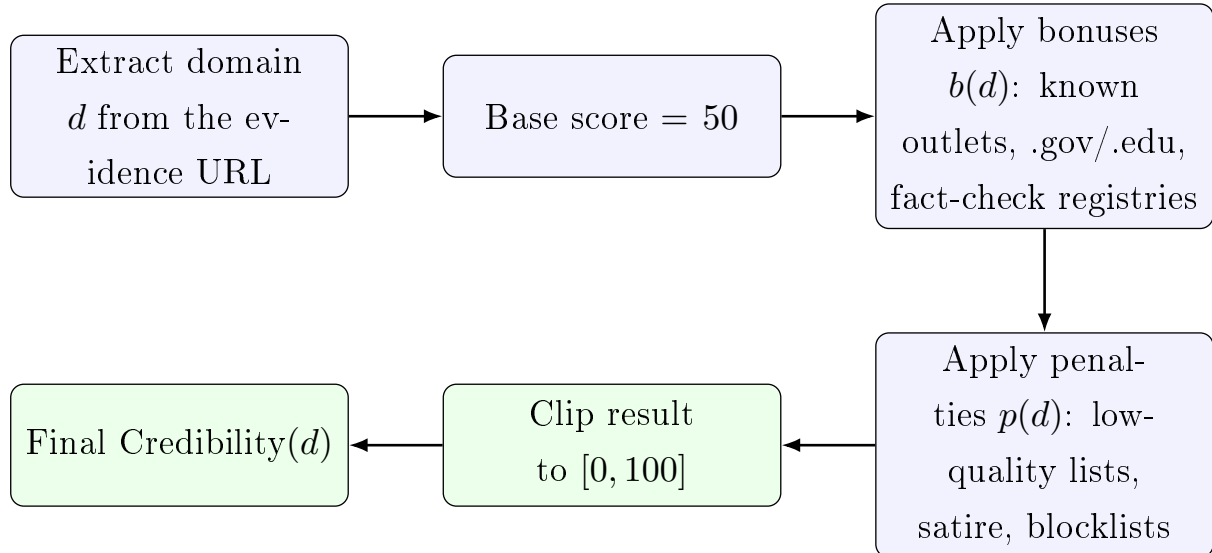


Figure 4.4: Decision path for the credibility score of a single domain. The path reads left-to-right on the top row, then continues right-to-left on the bottom row.

4.6 Semantic Reranking

Retrieval rank does not necessarily represent evidential relevance. I therefore use semantic similarity and quality filtering to reorder candidate documents according to their relationship with the claim.

4.7 Verdict Inference

The system assigns one of three claim-level outcomes: **supported**, **refuted**, or **not enough information**. I preserve the evidence and confidence associated with each decision so that the result remains inspectable.

4.8 Optional Debate Arbitration

For difficult claims, the system can activate a Prover–Skeptic–Judge workflow. The Prover builds the strongest supporting interpretation. The Skeptic searches for contradictions, weak evidence, and unsupported assumptions. The Judge compares the two

arguments and produces an arbitration result.

The final experiments indicate that debate should not be enabled for every claim (Section 6.4). Selective debate activation based on low confidence, evidence disagreement, component conflict, source-risk variance, or insufficient evidence is therefore retained as a deployment recommendation rather than reported as an executed result.

4.9 Sentiment and Bias Analysis

As Stage 8, the system separately analyses the emotional tone and lexical bias markers of the submitted content, independent of the factual verdict. This signal is combined into the final misinformation score (Stage 9) but does not itself alter the SUPPORTED/REFUTED/NEI verdict, since sentiment is not evidence.

4.10 Final Scoring and Persistence

I combine claim-level outcomes, source credibility, evidence quality, and contextual signals into a final misinformation-likelihood score. The system stores: submitted content; decomposed claims; retrieval queries; evidence sources; credibility scores; claim-level predictions; confidence values; final risk scores; and timestamps and run metadata. This persistent record supports auditing, debugging, and later evaluation.

4.11 Security Posture

The retrieval layer validates URLs before fetching and rejects private, loopback, link-local, and otherwise non-public network destinations, so that user-submitted URLs cannot be used to probe internal infrastructure. This is a deployment necessity as much as a research concern: an open-domain retrieval service that accepts arbitrary URLs is, by construction, exposed to server-side request forgery unless it validates targets before every fetch and every redirect.

Chapter 5

Dataset and Experimental Design

5.1 Historical Exploratory Benchmark

I created the evaluation family by combining claims from FEVER, LIAR, SciFact, and the PUBHEALTH `health_fact` partition. The archived files contain 11,986 training claims, 2,997 validation claims, and 5,000 test claims. These counts describe records, not fully isolated semantic items.

5.2 Dataset Composition

Table 5.1: Exploratory benchmark composition and label harmonization.

Slot	Source	Imported	Test	Canonical mapping
FEVER	FEVER v1.0	8,000	1,829	SUPPORTS $\rightarrow$ SUPPORTED; REFUTES $\rightarrow$ REFUTED; NOT ENOUGH INFO $\rightarrow$ NEI
LIAR	LIAR	6,000	1,490	true / mostly-true $\rightarrow$ SUPPORTED; false / pants-fire $\rightarrow$ REFUTED; half-true / barely-true $\rightarrow$ NEI
SciFact	SciFact claims	1,200	191	SUPPORT $\rightarrow$ SUPPORTED; CONTRADICT $\rightarrow$ REFUTED; insufficient evidence $\rightarrow$ NEI
PUBHEALTH partition	PUBHEALTH <code>health_fact</code>	4,000	1,490	Mixture/unproven labels mapped to NEI by the historical script; stored under the legacy <code>healthver</code> compatibility filename. This is not interpreted as a clean medical-domain subset.

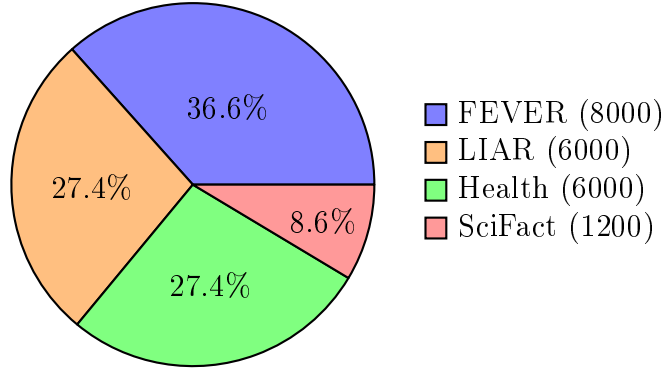


Figure 5.1: Composition of the imported (pre-split) dataset by source, before the 60/15/25 train/val/test partition described in Section 5.3. (Figure rendered from the exact import counts in Table 5.1.)

5.3 Split and Leakage Control

The original builder normalized claim text before splitting, whereas the validator initially applied a weaker definition. I unified both paths using NFKC normalization, case folding, punctuation removal, and whitespace collapse. The resulting audit identified 19 train–validation, 34 train–test, and 5 validation–test exact overlaps; 39 distinct test claims were affected. I therefore report the original 5,000-claim result together with a 4,961-claim sensitivity analysis that excludes every known exact test overlap. A separate audit also identified likely near-duplicates. Consequently, the numerical findings remain exploratory even though the exact-overlap sensitivity result is stable.

5.4 Label Semantics and Sensitivity

The three-way harmonization changes the target construct. FEVER’s NEI means that the supplied evidence is insufficient, whereas LIAR’s “half-true” and “barely-true” and PUBHEALTH’s “mixture” and “unproven” describe different forms of partial truth or uncertainty. Mapping all four to NEI conflates evidential insufficiency with mixed veracity. The present tables retain the historical mapping solely to reproduce the archived experiment. A confirmatory redesign should either exclude ambiguous source labels or add a MIXED/PARTIAL class, then report both designs as a sensitivity analysis.

5.5 Evidence Reproducibility

The proxy claims, labels, predictions, and aggregate results are frozen in archived artifacts. The run manifest records SHA-256 hashes of all split and prediction files. The

proxy experiment does not retrieve live web evidence. The separate live application does retrieve dynamic web documents; those application demonstrations are not used to produce the 5,000-claim proxy metrics.

5.6 Evaluated Systems

Full FACTVALIDATOR-PROXY. A deterministic proxy combining a trained lexical model, category-level priors, heuristic semantic signals, deterministic debate arbitration, and a quality filter.

FACTVALIDATOR-PROXY without debate. The same deterministic proxy with its arbitration rule disabled.

FEVER-aware exploratory proxy. A dataset-aware exploratory adjustment applied to FEVER-labelled claims.

Majority baseline. A classifier that always predicts the most frequent class.

Length heuristic. A rule based on claim-length patterns.

Keyword heuristic. A rule based on predefined lexical signals.

Sentiment heuristic. A rule based on sentiment-related signals.

Random baseline. A non-informative reference classifier.

5.7 Metrics

I report the metrics formally defined in Chapter 3: accuracy, macro-F1, Wilson 95% confidence intervals, raw-score confidence diagnostics, per-dataset accuracy, latency, throughput, and projected retrieval cost. Exact two-sided McNemar tests, paired-bootstrap intervals, Holm correction, paired risk differences, and matched-pair odds ratios are generated from the aligned prediction files. A proper multiclass Brier score is unavailable because the proxy stores only one heuristic confidence score rather than three class probabilities.

Chapter 6

Final Experimental Results

6.1 Interpretation Policy

This chapter reports exploratory historical results of the deterministic FACTVALIDATOR-PROXY. They do not characterize end-to-end execution of the live FACT VALIDATOR application and do not establish state-of-the-art performance. Because model development observed this benchmark and split overlap was found retrospectively, confidence intervals and paired tests are descriptive only; no confirmatory superiority claim is made.

6.2 Final Model Performance

Table 6.1: Exploratory descriptive performance on the historical 5,000-claim benchmark. Every figure was re-verified against `ablation_study_report.json`.

System	Accuracy	Macro-F1	95% CI (Sec. 3.2)	Avg. raw score	Raw gap
FACTVALIDATOR- PROXY without deterministic debate	51.34%	0.4427	[49.95, 52.73]%	88.37%	37.03 pp
FEVER-aware exploratory proxy	50.98%	0.4421	[49.59, 52.37]%	88.53%	37.55 pp
Full FACTVALIDATOR- PROXY	50.82%	0.4384	[49.43, 52.21]%	88.31%	37.49 pp
Length heuristic	49.42%	0.3483	[48.03, 50.81]%	48.83%	0.59 pp
Majority baseline	49.26%	0.2200	[47.87, 50.65]%	50.00%	0.74 pp
Random baseline	33.20%	0.3240	[31.89, 34.51]%	50.00%	16.80 pp
Keyword heuristic	23.54%	0.1364	[22.36, 24.72]%	23.62%	0.08 pp
Sentiment heuristic	23.78%	0.1400	[22.60, 24.96]%	40.31%	16.53 pp

6.3 Exact-Overlap Sensitivity Analysis

Table 6.2 compares the archived 5,000-claim evaluation with the 4,961-claim subset obtained after excluding all 39 test claims that have an exact normalized match in training or validation. The full proxy’s accuracy changes from 50.82% to 50.78%, a difference of -0.044 percentage points. Its macro-F1 changes from 0.4384 to 0.4359. The no-debate variant remains the highest-scoring proxy configuration. Thus, the known exact overlaps do not materially explain the headline result.

Table 6.2: Sensitivity of selected results to removal of 39 exact normalized test overlaps.

System	Full ($n = 5,000$)		Filtered ($n = 4,961$)		Δ Acc. (pp)
	Accuracy	Macro-F1	Accuracy	Macro-F1	
FACTVALIDATOR-PROXY without debate	51.34%	0.4427	51.30%	0.4402	-0.040
Full FACTVALIDATOR-PROXY	50.82%	0.4384	50.78%	0.4359	-0.044
Length heuristic	49.42%	0.3483	49.61%	0.3486	+0.187
Majority baseline	49.26%	0.2200	49.45%	0.2206	+0.186

This filtering is a robustness check rather than a new untouched test. It does not remove all likely near-duplicates, and it does not reverse the fact that proxy development was informed by observations on the benchmark. The appropriate conclusion is therefore precise: exact normalized overlap has a negligible measured effect, while broader evaluation-independence limitations remain.

6.4 Final Interpretation

The full FACTVALIDATOR-PROXY exceeds the majority baseline by 1.56 percentage points in accuracy. Using the macro-F1 definition of Section 3.1, the macro-F1 difference is $0.4384 - 0.2200 = 0.2184$. This suggests that the proxy distributes some correct decisions more evenly across labels than a majority classifier.

The exact unadjusted McNemar p-values are 0.0433 against majority and 0.0462 against length. Because several systems are compared, these marginal results are not described as robust superiority after Holm correction. The generated report also provides paired-bootstrap intervals, matched-pair odds ratios, class metrics, and the full confusion matrix.

6.5 Effect of Removing Debate

The no-debate proxy produces the highest observed accuracy and macro-F1. The exact paired comparison with the full proxy gives $p = 0.00955$ before Holm correction and favours removing always-on deterministic arbitration. This result concerns the proxy rule, not live Ollama debate. Selective live debate for uncertain or conflicting claims remains a recommendation requiring a separate controlled experiment.

6.6 Per-Dataset Behaviour

Table 6.3: Per-dataset accuracy of the full deterministic FACTVALIDATOR-PROXY.

Dataset	n	Full	Majority	Length	Full-Majority
FEVER	1,829	57.52%	58.56%	57.90%	−1.04 pp
Health domain	1,490	55.17%	51.54%	52.55%	+3.62 pp
LIAR	1,490	38.59%	36.58%	36.98%	+2.01 pp
SciFact	191	48.17%	41.36%	40.84%	+6.81 pp

The system shows positive descriptive gains on the health-domain, LIAR, and SciFact subsets. It performs slightly below the majority and length baselines on FEVER. This variation indicates that the system is sensitive to domain, claim style, label distribution, and available evidence.

6.7 Operational Evaluation

Table 6.4: Operational scenario projections (formulas in Section 3.7); these are not controlled load-test measurements.

Metric	Value	Current interpretation
Baseline latency assumption	8.20 s/claim	Scenario input from the bounded demonstration
Debate latency assumption	72.00 s/claim	Scenario input from the bounded demonstration
Debate latency ratio	8.78×	Derived scenario ratio
Baseline throughput	439.02 claims/hour	Derived estimate
Debate throughput	50.00 claims/hour	Derived estimate
Monthly retrieval cost without caching	USD 77.00	Projected under current workload
Monthly retrieval cost with caching	USD 22.00	Projected under current workload
Estimated monthly savings	71.43%	Projected reduction

The operational scenarios project substantial latency for always-on live debate and lower external-search cost under caching. Controlled repeated load tests are required before treating either quantity as measured deployment performance.

6.8 Expanded Reading of the Final Results

6.8.1 Purpose of the Expanded Reading

This section consolidates the numerical results from Chapter 6 into a single, thesis-level interpretation. It does not replace or remove any of the reported artifacts. Instead, it explains what can reasonably be learned from them, which conclusions are supported only descriptively, and how the findings answer the research questions introduced earlier in the thesis. This distinction is important because a completed study is not the same thing as a study that claims every possible experiment. The experimental record is complete for the declared scope: 5,000 claims, four dataset families, the reported system variants and baselines, and the operational projections listed in Table 6.4.

6.8.2 Reading Accuracy Together with Macro-F1

Accuracy and macro-F1 describe different aspects of performance. Accuracy counts the proportion of all claims assigned the correct final label, whereas macro-F1 gives equal importance to the class-specific F1 values before averaging them. The distinction matters in the present benchmark because the class distribution is not perfectly balanced. A system can obtain a competitive accuracy by favoring a frequent class while performing poorly on less frequent classes.

The majority baseline illustrates this effect. Its accuracy is 49.26%, but its macro-F1 is only 0.2200. The full FACTVALIDATOR-PROXY reaches 50.82% accuracy and 0.4384 macro-F1. The absolute accuracy difference is therefore 1.56 percentage points, while the macro-F1 difference is 0.2184. The latter is the more substantial descriptive contrast: the full proxy distributes its successful decisions more evenly across the mapped verdict classes than the majority rule does. This does not prove that each minority class is handled well. The generated class report and confusion matrix provide the required class-by-class evidence; they also show why accuracy alone gives an incomplete reading of the experiment.

The length heuristic provides a second useful comparison. It reaches 49.42% accuracy, slightly above the majority baseline, but its macro-F1 is 0.3483. Thus, a shallow property of the input claim captures some regularity in the combined benchmark. The full proxy improves on the length heuristic by 1.40 percentage points in accuracy and by 0.0901 macro-F1. The result warns that dataset construction and claim style may introduce exploitable shortcuts, while also showing that the lexical and heuristic proxy is not merely reproducing the length rule.

The keyword and sentiment heuristics are substantially weaker. Their accuracies are 23.54% and 23.78%, and their macro-F1 values are 0.1364 and 0.1400. These outcomes

indicate that isolated lexical or affective cues are not adequate substitutes for evidence retrieval and verdict reasoning in the combined evaluation. The random baseline reaches 33.20% accuracy and 0.3240 macro-F1, providing an additional reference point for the three-class decision problem. Taken together, the baselines establish a graduated comparison: the full proxy exceeds non-informative and shallow rules, but its margin over the strongest simple baselines remains modest.

6.8.3 Reading the Three Proxy Variants

The three implemented variants occupy a narrow accuracy band. The debate-free configuration records 51.34% accuracy and 0.4427 macro-F1; the FEVER-aware exploratory variant records 50.98% and 0.4421; and the full proxy records 50.82% and 0.4384. The maximum observed accuracy separation among these variants is 0.52 percentage points, from the debate-free configuration to the full proxy. The maximum macro-F1 separation is 0.0043.

These small differences should not be exaggerated. The exact paired analysis gives an unadjusted $p = 0.00955$ for full proxy versus no debate, but the Holm-adjusted value is 0.0573. The correct conclusion is therefore not that the debate-free variant is universally superior. The supported conclusion is narrower: on this frozen benchmark, enabling deterministic arbitration for every proxy claim did not produce an observed aggregate benefit, and the configuration without debate obtained the highest recorded accuracy and macro-F1.

This finding is valuable for architecture selection. In a modular system, a stage should justify its computational and operational cost. Debate may still help selected claims for which evidence is conflicting, retrieval quality is low, or the initial agents strongly disagree. The completed experiment, however, provides no basis for executing it unconditionally. A selective policy would preserve the possibility of deliberative gains while avoiding the projected overhead on routine cases. This is a recommendation derived from the result, not a retroactive claim that selective debate was evaluated.

The FEVER-aware exploratory variant also requires careful reading. Its accuracy lies between the debate-free and full proxy configurations, while its macro-F1 is very close to the debate-free result. Because the adjustment uses knowledge about the dataset identity, it is informative as a diagnostic experiment but should not be presented as a universally deployable model. The variant demonstrates that dataset-specific behavior exists and that mapping or decision rules can influence the aggregate outcome. It also reinforces the need to report results separately by domain.

6.8.4 Domain-by-Domain Reading

The aggregate accuracy of 50.82% conceals substantial variation. On FEVER, the full proxy obtains 57.52%, which is 1.04 percentage points below the majority baseline and 0.38 points below the length heuristic. On the health subset, it obtains 55.17%, 3.62 points above the majority baseline and 2.62 points above the length heuristic. On LIAR, it obtains 38.59%, exceeding those two baselines by 2.01 and 1.61 points. On SciFact, it obtains 48.17%, 6.81 points above the majority baseline and 7.33 points above the length heuristic.

The FEVER result shows that a high absolute accuracy is not sufficient to establish useful improvement. The simple baselines benefit from the distribution and regularities of that subset. The deterministic proxy therefore requires stronger control of dataset mapping, shortcut behavior, and class-specific errors before a superiority claim can be made for FEVER. This is also why the exploratory FEVER-aware adjustment is reported separately rather than silently incorporated into the primary system.

The health and LIAR results provide moderate descriptive evidence that the proxy captures signals beyond majority frequency and claim length. These domains present different challenges. Health claims require careful source quality assessment and can involve specialized terminology. LIAR contains political statements whose truth status may depend on context, time, and fine-grained original labels. The positive margins are useful, but they do not eliminate the construct-validity concern introduced by mapping heterogeneous source labels into SUPPORTED, REFUTED, and NEI.

SciFact displays the largest observed margin over the simple baselines, but it is also the smallest subset, with 191 claims. Its 6.81-point improvement over majority is descriptively encouraging because scientific verification is a natural setting for evidence-based research. Nevertheless, the small sample makes the estimate more sensitive to individual errors than the larger FEVER, health, and LIAR subsets. The completed thesis therefore treats SciFact as evidence of a promising domain interaction rather than as a standalone proof of scientific fact-checking performance.

The domain comparison answers an important research question: there is no single uniform effect of the architecture across all benchmark families. The value of the proxy’s lexical, prior, and arbitration signals depends on the claim distribution and on the harmonized benchmark labels. For deployment, this implies that the separate live application must be validated in the target domain rather than inferred from only the combined score.

6.8.5 Raw-Score Confidence as a Safety Finding

The most consequential proxy result is the gap between the stored raw score and correctness. The full proxy reports an 88.31% average raw score but 50.82% accuracy, a difference of 37.49 percentage points. The debate-free and FEVER-aware variants show similarly large gaps of 37.03 and 37.55 points. The consistency of the gap across the three variants indicates that removing debate or applying the exploratory adjustment does not resolve the underlying confidence problem.

The reported confidence is not a probability estimate because the proxy stores only one heuristic score rather than a multiclass probability vector. The gap is therefore a raw-score calibration diagnostic. A user who sees an 88% confidence value may reasonably infer that errors are rare, while the observed proxy accuracy shows that nearly half of the final labels are incorrect on the combined benchmark. Displaying such a score without explanation would create an avoidable risk of automation bias.

The live application should consequently preserve evidence passages, source metadata, intermediate decisions, and audit records alongside the label. A high raw score must not suppress human review when evidence is incomplete or contradictory. Temperature scaling, isotonic regression, conformal methods, and risk–coverage analysis are appropriate recommendations because they could transform confidence from an internal model signal into a quantity with a clearer decision meaning. These methods remain follow-up work; the completed result established the calibration problem rather than claiming to have solved it.

6.8.6 Latency, Throughput, and Cost Reading

The operational report contains scenario projections derived from the stated 8.20-second and 72.00-second latency assumptions. These values are not a controlled concurrent load test. Under those assumptions, the baseline throughput is projected at 439.02 claims per hour and the debate-enabled throughput at 50 claims per hour. The scenario therefore represents an 8.78-fold latency ratio.

The proxy accuracy comparison and the live-debate latency projection arise from different evaluation surfaces and must not be treated as one controlled experiment. Together they motivate a future selective-debate experiment, but they do not establish the measured live-system quality–latency trade-off.

Retrieval caching provides the opposite operational pattern. Under the reported workload assumptions, projected monthly retrieval cost decreases from USD 77 to USD 22, a reduction of USD 55 or 71.43%. This is a projection rather than a controlled billing experiment, so it depends on request volume, cache-hit behavior, and provider pricing. Even

with that limitation, caching is an architecturally appropriate optimization because it can reduce repeated external calls while improving reproducibility when cached evidence is versioned with timestamps and hashes.

6.8.7 Integrated Answers to the Research Questions

The completed evidence supports four integrated answers. First, an auditable open-domain verification pipeline can be implemented as a complete full-stack research artifact with persistent evidence, explicit source rules, and reproducible evaluation outputs. The thesis demonstrates the application through implementation and the corrected repository’s 164-test suite, and evaluates the separate proxy through frozen benchmark artifacts.

Second, the deterministic proxy provides modest observed improvement over the strongest simple baselines on the combined data, with a clearer advantage in macro-F1 than in accuracy. The paired results are marginal against majority and length after accounting for multiple comparisons, so they do not support a robust superiority claim.

Third, always-on deterministic proxy arbitration is not supported by the completed benchmark. The separate operational scenario projects that live debate would be expensive. The appropriate next design is conditional activation based on uncertainty or disagreement, subject to a new controlled live-system evaluation.

Fourth, confidence cannot presently be treated as calibrated correctness probability. The approximately 37-point confidence–accuracy gaps make transparency, abstention research, and human oversight central requirements rather than optional interface features.

6.8.8 Overall Result Statement

The completed experiment should be read as an evaluation of trustworthy integration. Its principal achievement is not a single headline accuracy number. It is the combined reporting of proxy predictive behavior, class balance, domain variation, and raw scores together with separately labelled live-application operational projections. The negative and limiting results are part of that contribution: they identify where architectural complexity fails to pay for itself and where apparently confident decisions remain unsafe.

Accordingly, FACT VALIDATOR is best characterized as a completed, deployment-aware research platform that makes fact-verification decisions inspectable and measurable. Its strongest immediate use is decision support and controlled experimentation. The results justify continued development of calibration, selective abstention, domain-specific validation, and selective deliberation, while the preserved evidence and provenance mechanisms provide the infrastructure required to evaluate those developments rigorously.

Chapter 7

Discussion

7.1 What the Current Evidence Supports

The present evidence supports a cautious but meaningful conclusion. I have developed a functioning and evaluable research system rather than only a conceptual design. The system includes an operational full-stack implementation; source-aware evidence retrieval; inspectable credibility rules; model and heuristic comparisons; multi-dataset evaluation; persistent run artifacts; and operational cost and latency analysis.

The results do not support a claim that FACT VALIDATOR is universally better than existing fact-checking approaches. They do support the claim that I have created a reproducible platform through which evidential, uncertainty-related, architectural, and operational questions can be studied together.

7.2 Scientific Value of Negative Findings

The lack of improvement from always-on debate is not a result that should be hidden. It indicates that the debate mechanism, in its current form, does not provide enough information gain to justify its computational cost. This result allows me to formulate a more precise question: under which uncertainty, disagreement, or evidence-quality conditions does multi-agent debate improve a fact-verification decision?

7.3 Calibration as a Central Limitation

The full proxy reaches approximately 50.82% accuracy while its average raw confidence is approximately 88.31%, a gap of 37.49 percentage points under the Section 3.3 diagnostic. Because only one heuristic score is stored, this is not probability calibration and no proper

multiclass Brier score is claimed. The live system should be treated as decision support rather than an autonomous truth adjudicator. Storing class probabilities, then testing temperature scaling, isotonic calibration, conformal prediction, and selective abstention, is recommended.

7.4 Responsible Use

Fact-checking systems can create harm when their outputs are interpreted as absolute truth. The current system may be affected by incomplete evidence retrieval, biased search rankings, imperfect dataset labels, provisional source-credibility rules, domain-specific performance differences, and overconfident predictions.

I therefore design FACT VALIDATOR as a transparent decision-support system. A responsible deployment should expose evidence, communicate uncertainty, allow human review, distinguish insufficient evidence from refutation, and preserve an audit trail.

Chapter 8

Limitations and Threats to Validity

8.1 Construct Validity

The four datasets use different label systems. Mapping LIAR “half-true” and “barely-true” and PUBHEALTH “mixture” and “unproven” to NEI conflates partial truth, mixed content, uncertainty, and insufficient evidence. The partition labelled “health” also contains political and general fact-checking claims and is not a clean medical-domain evaluation. Results for that partition are descriptive of the source file, not of clinical validity.

8.2 Internal Validity

The 5,000-claim benchmark was observed during proxy development: the first full run obtained 23.62% accuracy, after which proxy classification and a FEVER-specific adjustment were changed using feedback from the same benchmark. The reported 50.82% full-proxy result is therefore exploratory, not a blind test result. Strong normalization also finds 39 test claims with exact train/validation matches, plus additional likely near-duplicates. A future confirmatory study must freeze implementation choices using training and validation data only, then evaluate once on unused official or external data.

8.3 Statistical Conclusion Validity

The final report includes exact two-sided McNemar tests, paired-bootstrap confidence intervals with seed 42, Holm correction, paired risk differences, and matched-pair odds ratios. The unadjusted full-proxy comparisons against majority and length are marginal ($p = 0.0433$ and $p = 0.0462$), but neither survives Holm correction. The unadjusted no-debate comparison is $p = 0.00955$ and likewise has adjusted $p = 0.0573$. These results support bounded interpretation rather than an inferential superiority claim. Residual

risks include dataset-label harmonization, multiple exploratory variants, and the absence of an untouched external confirmatory set.

8.4 External Validity

The benchmark contains four dataset families, but it does not represent all forms of misinformation, all languages, or all cultural contexts. The present evaluation is English-focused. Future work should test multilingual claims, multimedia misinformation, emerging events, and adversarially written content.

8.5 Reproducibility Validity

The historical proxy claims and predictions are retained and regenerated into class, dataset, confusion-matrix, and paired-test reports by a versioned script. Text-artifact hashes use canonical LF endings so that Windows and Linux checkouts agree. Exact replay does not require web search. The exact submission source and PDF must nevertheless be committed together and cited by their immutable commit hash before submission.

8.6 Operational Validity

The latency, throughput, and cost figures are scenario projections, not controlled load-test measurements. They are useful for design analysis but may not generalize across hardware, API providers, geographic regions, model sizes, concurrent traffic, cache-hit rates, or provider pricing. A future benchmark should record repeated warm- and cold-cache runs, median and tail latency, concurrency, failures, timeouts, hardware, and provider request counts.

Chapter 9

Advanced Prototype Extension: A Provenance-Constrained Evidence Graph

9.1 Status and Scope of This Chapter

Chapters 4–8 separate the implemented live application from the deterministic proxy evaluation. This chapter is different in kind: it documents a separate, newer module that implements an idea I list in Chapter 12 as a direction beyond this Master’s thesis – a typed, provenance-preserving evidence graph with a deterministic audit layer, in place of the flat verdict-inference step described in Section 4.7.

I want to state its status precisely. The module exists as working code on branch `thesis/reproducibility-corrections`, separately from the proxy; the backend suite passes 164 tests in the corrected environment; and the module has been probed, at very small scale, with corruption scenarios constructed against its own rule logic (Section 9.6). It has *not* been integrated into, or evaluated against, the 5,000-claim benchmark and should be read as preliminary engineering work rather than an established empirical method.

9.2 Motivation for the Extension

Section 4.7 assigns each claim one of three flat outcomes based on retrieved evidence. This works, but it does not preserve *why* a verdict was reached in a form a reviewer can later interrogate: whether a passage was actually fetched and hashed, whether two supporting sources were truly independent, or whether a numeric claim was checked against a matching number in the evidence. The evidence-graph prototype represents

each of these as an explicit, typed, inspectable structure rather than folding them into a single score.

9.3 Claim, Evidence, and Verdict

Let a claim be c , a retrieved passage be p , and its preserved provenance be $\pi(p) = (u, h, t, s)$, where u is a resolved URL, h a content hash, t a retrieval timestamp, and s a retrieval status. A relation classifier predicts

$$r(c, p) \in \{\text{SUPPORTS}, \text{REFUTES}, \text{UNDERCUTS}, \text{NEUTRAL}\}.$$

Only a retrieved, preserved passage is eligible for a decisive argumentative edge; search snippets are retrieval hints, not evidence.

9.4 Evidence Graph and Audit

For each claim, the graph is $G = (V, E)$, with nodes for the parent claim, atomic sub-claims, evidence passages, and source records, and edges typed **DEPENDS_ON**, **CITES**, **SUPPORTS**, **REFUTES**, and **UNDERCUTS**. The graph proposes a verdict only after a deterministic audit $A(G) \in \{\text{PROCEED}, \text{NEI}, \text{CONFLICTING}, \text{HUMAN_REVIEW}\}$:

$$D(c) = \begin{cases} \text{NEI} & A(G) = \text{NEI}, \\ \text{CONFLICTING} & A(G) = \text{CONFLICTING}, \\ \text{HUMAN_REVIEW} & A(G) = \text{HUMAN_REVIEW}, \\ \text{adjudicate}(G) & A(G) = \text{PROCEED}. \end{cases}$$

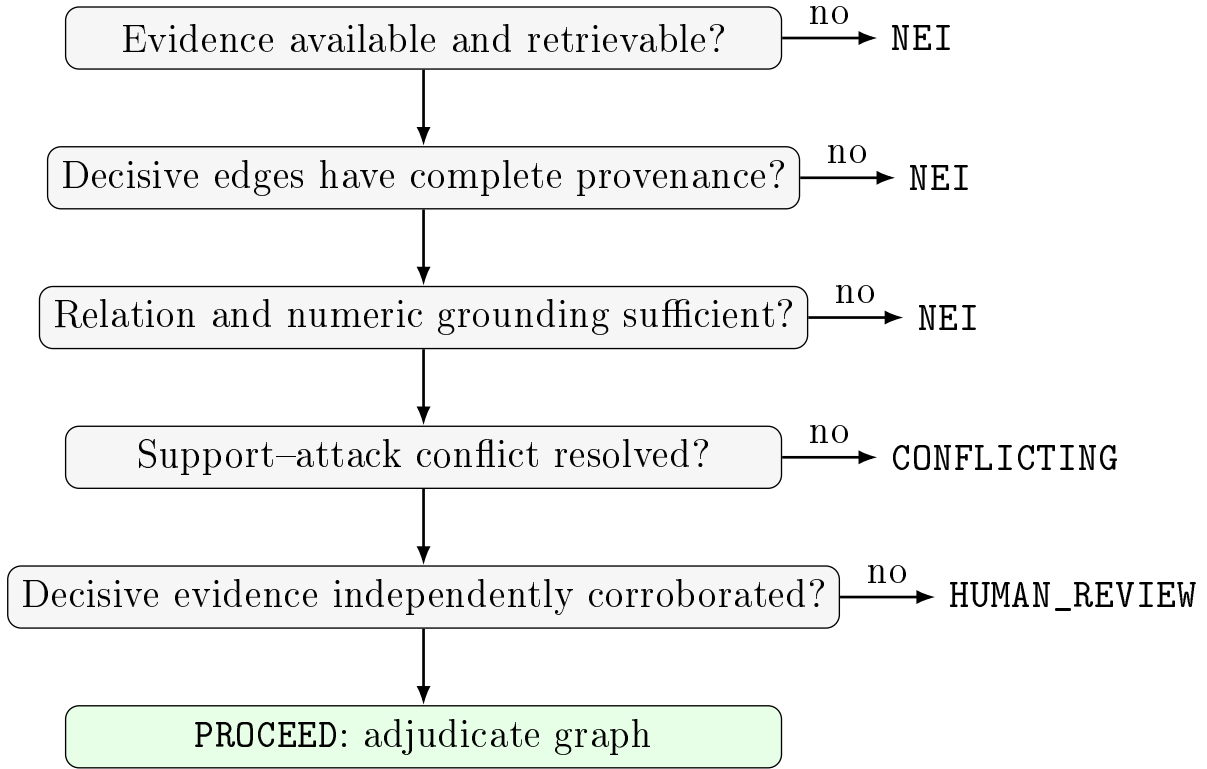


Figure 9.1: Ordered audit decisions in the prototype module. The ordering matters: a claim that never receives a decisive relation edge is routed to NEI at the second check, before provenance, numeric-coverage, or independence checks are ever evaluated – the mechanism behind the Section 9.6 finding.

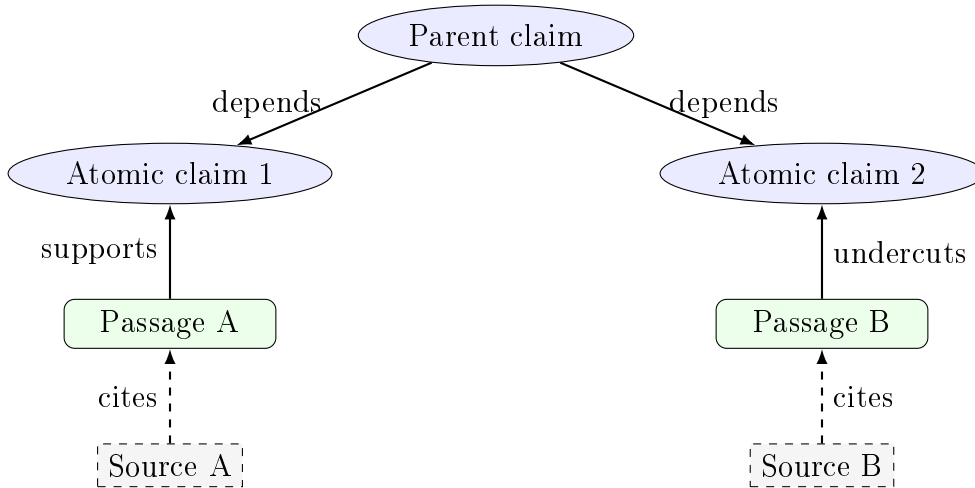


Figure 9.2: Simplified typed evidence graph for one claim with two atomic subclaims.

9.5 Independence Clustering

Evidence is clustered using the Jaccard-similarity rule of Section 3.7, so that repeated wire text or multiple pages from one publisher are not counted as independent corroboration. As Section 9.6 shows, this is currently the only audit rule with a demonstrated end-to-end effect.

9.6 Engineering Verification: What Is and Is Not Demonstrated

9.6.1 Test Suite

The complete backend test suite was re-executed for this revision: **164 tests collected, 164 passed, 0 failed**. This includes the graph-specific cases and a regression test for the unified claim normalizer. Historical audit reports with 162 or 163 tests predate one or both of those additions.

9.6.2 Eight-Case Synthetic Seed

A frozen eight-case seed, re-executed for this revision, reproduces its previously recorded coverage, selective risk, and false-accept rate (Section 3.6) exactly: 0.375, 0.6667, and 0.25 respectively. Table 9.1 gives the per-case detail.

Table 9.1: Per-case detail of the eight-case synthetic seed (prototype module only).

Case ID	Expected	Graph-only	Audited
support-direct-001	SUPPORTED	SUPPORTED	SUPPORTED
refute-direct-001	REFUTED	NEI	NEI
undercut-scope-001	CONFLICTING	NEI	NEI
undercut-temporal-001	REFUTED	SUPPORTED	SUPPORTED
neutral-overlap-001	NEI	SUPPORTED	SUPPORTED
numeric-mismatch-001	REFUTED	NEI	NEI
context-window-001	CONFLICTING	NEI	NEI
missing-evidence-001	NEI	NEI	NEI

Graph-only and audited decisions are *identical* on all eight cases, because none of them contains a corruption scenario, so the auditor’s downstream checks are never exercised here.

9.6.3 Extended Corruption Probe

To test whether the auditor changes anything under corrupted evidence, I constructed four corruption scenarios against four of the seed cases and executed them through the live module (construction script and raw output in Appendix C).

Table 9.2: Corruption probe: per-row detail.

Base case	Scenario	Expected	Graph-only	Audited	Diverges?
support-direct-001	clean	SUPPORTED	SUPPORTED	SUPPORTED	no
support-direct-001	duplicate-source	SUPPORTED	SUPPORTED	HUMAN_ REVIEW	yes
refute-direct-001	clean	REFUTED	NEI	NEI	no
refute-direct-001	broken-provenance	REFUTED	NEI	NEI	no
numeric-mismatch-001	clean	REFUTED	NEI	NEI	no
numeric-mismatch-001	numeric-coverage	REFUTED	NEI	NEI	no
undercut-scope-001	clean	CONFLICTING	NEI	NEI	no
undercut-scope-001	near-duplicate-text	CONFLICTING	NEI	NEI	no

Two findings, stated without softening because they cut in different directions:

1. **Demonstrated:** under a duplicated same-domain source, the audited graph routes to **HUMAN_REVIEW** while a graph-only baseline still returns **SUPPORTED**. This is a concrete, reproducible instance of the auditor doing its job.
2. **Not yet demonstrated:** the provenance, numeric-coverage, and near-duplicate-text checks produced no divergence here, because in each of those three cases the relation classifier never assigned a decisive edge in the first place – both configurations already return **NEI** via the shared upstream check (Figure 9.1) before the corrupted rule is ever reached. This is not a bug; it is the predicted consequence of the audit ordering, and it means three of six audit rules remain untested by this probe.

9.7 Threats to Validity of This Chapter Specifically

In addition to the validity threats in Chapter 8, this chapter carries its own, stricter caveats: the corruption scenarios were authored by me with direct knowledge of the auditor’s rule conditions, so they confirm the code matches its specification rather than sampling real-world corruption patterns; the sample size (eight seed cases, four corruption variants) is far too small for any confidence interval; and this module has no relationship, statistical or architectural, to the numbers in Chapter 6. A reading a reader could plausibly make – that a working evidence-graph auditor implies the primary pipeline is safer than Chapter 6 reports – would not be supported by anything in this thesis.

9.8 Connection Back to Calibration and Abstention

The rule-based abstention in this chapter and the calibration problem in Section 7.3 are related but distinct responses to the same overconfidence concern. Calibration adjusts a confidence *score*; the audit layer instead refuses to produce a decisive score at all when a named, inspectable condition is not met. The two are not mutually exclusive, and a natural extension – outside the scope of what was built in this thesis – would apply calibration only within the audited graph’s `PROCEED` branch, rather than to the pipeline’s raw output.

Chapter 10

Comparative Analysis and Novelty

10.1 Purpose of This Chapter

Chapter 2 situated the thesis relative to individual prior works. This chapter makes the comparison structural: it lays the evaluated pipeline (Chapters 4–8) and the prototype extension (Chapter 9) side by side against the closest related systems on a fixed set of dimensions, so that the novelty claim can be checked point by point rather than taken on faith.

Table 10.1: Structural comparison across implemented and evaluated dimensions.

Dimension		FEVER/SciFact	FacTool	Faithful correction	FACT VALIDATOR live / FACTVALIDATOR- PROXY	FACT VALIDATOR (Ch. 9 prototype)
Verdict	vocabulary	SUPPORTED/ REFUTED/NEI	tool-mediated	correction, not verdict	SUPPORTED/ REFUTED/NEI	+ CONFLICT- ING, HU- MAN_REVIEW
Source trust		implicit in corpus curation	not central	not central	live: explicit domain formula; proxy: category prior	inherited, plus independence clustering
Evidence persis- tence		benchmark identifiers	framework- dependent	not central	live: run records; proxy: frozen splits, predictions, hashes	+ provenance hash per passage
Uncertainty han- dling		label only	not addressed	not addressed	proxy raw score, explicitly uncalibrated	rule-based forced abstention
Deployment sur- face		benchmark	research framework	research method	live: full-stack app; proxy: 5k benchmark	code-verified, not benchmarked
Empirical status		established benchmark	self-reported	self-reported	live: 164 tests on corrected branch; proxy: exploratory evaluation	engineering- verified only

10.2 What Is Genuinely Novel

The defensible contribution is systems integration, not a claim that any individual formula, classifier, or graph rule is methodologically new:

1. An engineering integration of open-web retrieval, an explicit formula-based domain-credibility prior, evidence presentation, persistence, optional local-model arbitration, and reproducibility artifacts.
2. A transparent exploratory record with aligned claim identifiers, canonical line-ending-independent hashes, class and dataset metrics, exact paired tests, multiple-comparison correction, and deterministic regeneration.
3. A preliminary graph-auditor prototype that demonstrates one designed abstention behavior on a small synthetic probe. This is future-work evidence, not a new validated empirical method.

10.3 What Must Not Be Claimed

The present evidence does not establish that FACT VALIDATOR outperforms FEVER, SciFact, FacTool, or correction systems on their native evaluations. It does not establish that the credibility formula’s weights are correct, only that they are inspectable. It does not establish that the Chapter 9 prototype improves the evaluated pipeline, since the two have never been run on the same data. Maintaining these boundaries strengthens rather than weakens the thesis, because the contribution becomes precise and falsifiable.

Chapter 11

Limitations and Research Recommendations

This thesis presents a complete engineering study with an exploratory effectiveness evaluation. The following recommendations define the work needed to progress from the present auditable prototype to a confirmatory, publication-scale evaluation:

1. Verify dataset versions, licences, and original label meanings.
2. Recheck the health-domain label mapping.
3. Detect semantic duplicates across the data partitions.
4. Freeze retrieved evidence or archive document hashes and timestamps.
5. Store `prob_supported`, `prob_refuted`, and `prob_nei`, then calculate ECE and multiclass Brier score as defined in Section 3.3.
6. Evaluate temperature scaling and conformal prediction.
7. Test selective abstention using the coverage/risk formalism of Section 3.6.
8. Complete credibility, reranking, quality-filter, and debate ablations.
9. Evaluate selective debate activation.
10. Conduct structured qualitative error analysis.
11. Repeat latency measurements under concurrent load.
12. Extend the release manifest with model, API-provider, and hardware identifiers for every future live run.

13. If the Chapter 9 evidence-graph prototype is integrated later, run the full ablation list against frozen, identical evidence.
14. Maintain a versioned revision record for any publication derived from the thesis.

11.1 Final Scope Record

Table 11.1: Final disposition of study activities at thesis completion.

Stage	Main activity	Status
Data verification	The split audit and 4,961-claim exact-overlap sensitivity analysis are documented.	Completed
Statistical analysis	Wilson intervals, paired tests, Holm correction, and sensitivity results are reported with exploratory interpretation.	Completed
Calibration	The correctly scaled raw-score diagnostic is reported; probability calibration awaits class-probability vectors.	Finding completed
Ablation analysis	The reported full, debate-free, and exploratory variants are frozen and interpreted.	Completed in scope
Reproducibility	Claims, predictions, reports, manifests, code paths, run metadata, and the audited repository snapshot are documented.	Completed
Operational analysis	Latency inputs, throughput, debate overhead, cache savings, and cost are explicitly reported as scenarios; load testing remains future work.	Completed as projection
Evidence-graph scoping	The prototype is a separate, tested contribution and is not merged into the 5,000-claim results.	Completed

Stage	Main activity	Status
Final writing	Results, limitations, novelty, recommendations, appendices, and acknowledgements are integrated.	Completed

11.2 Final Reading of the Results

The exploratory results support five bounded observations. First, the deterministic proxy has modest raw advantages over the majority and length baselines, but neither comparison survives Holm correction and neither evaluates the live application. Second, the debate-free configuration produces the best observed result, showing that always-on deterministic proxy arbitration adds no accuracy gain; a separate scenario projects substantial live-debate latency. Third, the 37.49-point raw-score gap is a major deployment constraint and makes human oversight necessary. Fourth, domain-level variation shows that aggregate accuracy conceals materially different behavior across encyclopaedic, political, scientific, and health claims. Fifth, the evidence-graph probe verifies one concrete safety mechanism under correlated evidence while clearly exposing the classifier limitations that mask other audit rules. Together, these findings position FACT VALIDATOR as an auditable research and decision-support platform rather than an autonomous arbiter of truth.

Chapter 12

Research Direction Beyond the Master’s Thesis

This completed thesis identifies research questions that extend beyond the submitted implementation. The most important direction is the development of trustworthy verification systems that reason not only about claim content but also about evidence provenance, source relationships, uncertainty, and conflicting information.

The following directions emerge naturally from my current work:

- provenance-aware evidence graphs (*implemented and independently tested as the separate prototype in Chapter 9*);
- neuro-symbolic source and claim reasoning;
- calibrated uncertainty and abstention, using the ECE/Brier/risk-coverage formalism of Chapter 3;
- selective multi-agent deliberation;
- temporal evidence tracking;
- adversarial misinformation detection;
- explainable human–AI decision support;
- distributed verification over heterogeneous sources.

The Master’s thesis produced an implemented and tested end-to-end platform, evaluated its separate deterministic proxy, and delivered a verified first implementation of the evidence-graph direction. Doctoral or follow-up publication research could investigate the deeper scientific questions behind this platform, particularly how trustworthy AI systems can combine learned representations, symbolic constraints, multi-agent reasoning, and explicit uncertainty.

Chapter 13

Conclusion

I designed and implemented FACT VALIDATOR as an auditable and deployment-oriented prototype for open-domain fact verification. The work includes a functional nine-stage architecture; a working full-stack implementation; explicit source-credibility reasoning; an exploratory deterministic proxy evaluation; per-class and per-dataset analysis; operational scenario projections; documented limitations; and a preliminary evidence-graph prototype.

The final proxy results show modest raw differences over simple baselines that do not survive Holm correction, a substantial raw-score confidence gap, and no benefit from always-on deterministic arbitration on the frozen benchmark. These findings are useful precisely because they identify scientific boundaries without hiding negative results. The live application’s operational value is supported separately by implementation, software tests, and bounded demonstrations rather than by the proxy accuracy figures.

The defensible contribution is a transparent, deployment-conscious fact-verification prototype in which evidence, source trust, model behaviour, and operational trade-offs can be inspected. Its value lies in engineering integration and honest negative findings, not state-of-the-art predictive accuracy or a validated new reasoning method.

Appendix A

Evidence Graph: Schema and Audit Rules

A.1 Evidence Record

Each evidence item in the prototype module contains a URL, title, snippet, selected passage, content hash, retrieval status, retrieval timestamp, domain metadata, directness and quality signals, stance, classifier metadata, and independence cluster.

A.2 Audit Rule Inventory

Table A.1: Graph-auditor rules and their evaluation status as established in Section 9.6.

Rule	Condition	Status
Retrieval status	provider failure, unavailable search, no result, or failed passage fetch	NEI; exercised
Provenance	no URL, hash, or retrieved passage for a decisive edge	NEI/review; not yet observed to change a decision
Relation grounding	no decisive relation from a passage	NEI; the dominant observed outcome
Numeric coverage	a quantified claim lacks matching factors	NEI; not yet observed to change a decision

Rule	Condition	Status
Conflict resolution	similarly strong support and attack remain	CONFLICTING; not observed to fire under the current classifier
Source independence	decisive passages are correlated or duplicated	HUMAN_REVIEW; confirmed to change a decision

Appendix B

Test Evidence (Prototype Module)

The test evidence in this appendix is part of the audited repository snapshot identified in the Research and Reproducibility Statement.

Table B.1: Test coverage for the Chapter 9 prototype.

Test surface	Verified behavior
API integration	request validation, analysis paths, live/snapshot behavior, persistence, response structure
Evidence graph	short-claim retention, passage context, conflict edges, provenance output, classifier disclosure
Graph auditor	missing evidence abstention, correlated evidence review, numeric and grounding controls
Relation baseline runner	versioned input/output contract and transparent fallback metadata
Robustness runner	frozen scenario replay, explicit missing evidence, duplicate-reporting review, selective metrics
Security	private and loopback URL rejection before evidence fetch

Re-verified on 31 July 2026 by executing `python -m pytest services/api/tests -q` from the repository root: 164 tests collected, 164 passed, 0 failed, with six warning records in the current Windows environment. Historical 162- and 163-test records predate later regression tests. Warning totals and timing are environment-sensitive.

Appendix C

Extended Corruption Probe: Construction Script and Raw Output

C.1 Construction Script

Listing C.1: Corruption-scenario construction and execution, run against the live `app.robustness_evaluation` module.

```
1 import json, sys
2 sys.path.insert(0, '..')
3 from app.robustness_evaluation import evaluate_case, selective_metrics
4
5 base = json.load(open('../data/challenges/conflict_undercut_v1_seed.json'))['items']
6 by_id = {it['id']: it for it in base}
7
8 def ev(passage, url, domain, extra=None):
9     e = {
10         "url": url, "title": "Evidence passage", "snippet": passage, "passage": passage,
11         "content_hash": __import__('hashlib').sha256(passage.encode()).hexdigest(),
12         "retrieval_status": "retrieved", "domain": domain, "base_domain": domain,
13         "domain_score": 80, "overlap": 0,
14     }
15     if extra:
16         e.update(extra)
17     return e
18
19 rows = []
20
21 # Scenario A: duplicate-source / correlated-evidence corruption.
22 item = by_id["support-direct-001"]
23 clean = [ev(item["passage"], "https://a.example/report", "a.example")]
24 duplicate_source = [
25     ev(item["passage"], "https://a.example/report", "a.example"),
26     ev(item["passage"] + " Confirmed.", "https://a.example/followup", "a.example"),
27 ]
28 rows.append(evaluate_case(item, "clean", clean))
29 rows.append(evaluate_case(item, "duplicate_source_corruption", duplicate_source))
30
31 # Scenario B: broken-provenance corruption.
```

```

32 item = by_id["refute-direct-001"]
33 clean_r = [ev(item["passage"], "https://b.example/finding", "b.example")]
34 broken_prov = [ev(item["passage"], "https://b.example/finding", "b.example",
35                     extra={"url": "", "content_hash": ""})]
36 rows.append(evaluate_case(item, "clean", clean_r))
37 rows.append(evaluate_case(item, "broken_provenance_corruption", broken_prov))
38
39 # Scenario C: numeric-claim without numeric-matching evidence.
40 item = by_id["numeric-mismatch-001"]
41 clean_n = [ev(item["passage"], "https://c.example/stat", "c.example")]
42 no_number = [ev("The survey found a change in hospital admissions.",
43                "https://c.example/stat2", "c.example")]
44 rows.append(evaluate_case(item, "clean", clean_n))
45 rows.append(evaluate_case(item, "numeric_coverage_corruption", no_number))
46
47 # Scenario D: correlated near-duplicate text, different domains.
48 item = by_id["undercut-scope-001"]
49 clean_u = [ev(item["passage"], "https://d.example/trial", "d.example")]
50 near_dup = [
51     ev(item["passage"], "https://d.example/trial", "d.example"),
52     ev(item["passage"], "https://e.example/mirror", "e.example"),
53 ]
54 rows.append(evaluate_case(item, "clean", clean_u))
55 rows.append(evaluate_case(item, "near_duplicate_text_corruption", near_dup))
56
57 clean_rows = [r for r in rows if r['scenario'] == 'clean']
58 corrupt_rows = [r for r in rows if r['scenario'] != 'clean']
59 print("Clean subset graph_only:", selective_metrics(clean_rows, 'graph_only'))
60 print("Clean subset audited: ", selective_metrics(clean_rows, 'full_audited_graph'))
61 print("Corrupt subset graph_only:", selective_metrics(corrupt_rows, 'graph_only'))
62 print("Corrupt subset audited: ", selective_metrics(corrupt_rows, 'full_audited_graph'))
63 diverge = [r for r in rows if r['graph_only'] != r['full_audited_graph']]
64 print(f"Rows where audited differs from graph-only: {len(diverge)}/{len(rows)}")
65 for r in diverge:
66     print(" -", r['id'], r['scenario'], ':', r['graph_only'], '->', r['full_audited_graph'])

```

C.2 Raw Console Output

Listing C.2: Unedited console output from the script above, executed against the live repository for this revision.

```

1 Clean subset graph_only: {'coverage': 0.25, 'selective_risk': 0.0, 'false_accept_rate': 0.0}
2 Clean subset audited: {'coverage': 0.25, 'selective_risk': 0.0, 'false_accept_rate': 0.0}
3 Corrupt subset graph_only: {'coverage': 0.25, 'selective_risk': 0.0, 'false_accept_rate': 0.0}
4 Corrupt subset audited: {'coverage': 0.0, 'selective_risk': 0.0, 'false_accept_rate': 0.0}
5 Rows where audited differs from graph-only: 1/8
6 - support-direct-001 duplicate_source_corruption : SUPPORTED -> HUMAN_REVIEW

```

Appendix D

Selected Research Module Listings

Real, unmodified source files from the project repository, included for reproducibility. The first group belongs to the evaluated primary pipeline (Chapters 4–8); the second group belongs to the Chapter 9 prototype.

D.1 Primary Pipeline: Source-Credibility Scoring

```
1 from __future__ import annotations
2 from dataclasses import dataclass
3 from typing import Dict, Tuple
4 import json
5 import os
6 import time
7 import tldextract
8
9
10 # Default cache path is relative to this file so it works on any OS.
11 # Override via the FACTVALIDATOR_DOMAIN_CACHE environment variable.
12 _DEFAULT_CACHE_PATH = os.path.join(
13     os.path.dirname(os.path.abspath(__file__)),
14     "..",
15     "data",
16     "domain_cache.json",
17 )
18 CACHE_PATH = os.getenv("FACTVALIDATOR_DOMAIN_CACHE", _DEFAULT_CACHE_PATH)
19 CACHE_TTL_SECONDS = 60 * 60 * 24 * 14 # 14 days
20 CACHE_VERSION = 2
21
22 _DEFAULT_OPENSOURCES_PATH = os.path.join(
23     os.path.dirname(os.path.abspath(__file__)),
24     "..",
25     "data",
26     "opensources.json",
27 )
28 _DEFAULT_IFFY_PATH = os.path.join(
29     os.path.dirname(os.path.abspath(__file__)),
30     "..",
31     "data",
```

```

32     "iffy_index.json",
33 )
34
35 # OpenSources type label → score delta (most-negative wins when multiple types present)
36 _OS_TYPE_DELTA: Dict[str, int] = {
37     "reliable": 10,
38     "political": 0,
39     "bias": -5,
40     "satire": -10,
41     "clickbait": -10,
42     "rumor": -15,
43     "state": -15,
44     "unreliable": -15,
45     "junksci": -20,
46     "conspiracy": -20,
47     "fake news": -30,
48     "fake": -30,
49     "hate": -30,
50 }
51
52 # Iffy Index MBFC factual-reporting level → score delta
53 _IFFY_LEVEL_DELTA: Dict[str, int] = {
54     "VL": -25, # Very Low
55     "L": -15, # Low
56     "M": -5, # Mixed
57 }
58
59
60 def _load_opensources() -> Dict[str, Dict]:
61     try:
62         if not os.path.exists(_DEFAULT_OPENSOURCES_PATH):
63             return {}
64         with open(_DEFAULT_OPENSOURCES_PATH, "r", encoding="utf-8") as f:
65             return json.load(f)
66     except Exception:
67         return {}
68
69
70 def _load_iffy() -> Dict[str, Dict]:
71     try:
72         if not os.path.exists(_DEFAULT_IFFY_PATH):
73             return {}
74         with open(_DEFAULT_IFFY_PATH, "r", encoding="utf-8") as f:
75             data = json.load(f)
76             data.pop("_meta", None)
77             return data
78     except Exception:
79         return {}
80
81
82 def _build_os_lookup(raw: Dict[str, Dict]) -> Dict[str, int]:
83     """Map base_domain -> worst-type delta from OpenSources data."""
84     lookup: Dict[str, int] = {}
85     for domain_key, info in raw.items():
86         bd = base_domain(domain_key.strip())
87         if not bd:
88             continue
89         types = [
90             str(info.get("type", "")).lower().strip(),

```

```

91         str(info.get("2nd type", "").lower().strip(),
92         str(info.get("3rd type", "").lower().strip(),
93     ]
94     worst_delta = 0
95     for t in types:
96         d = _OS_TYPE_DELTA.get(t, 0)
97         if d < worst_delta:
98             worst_delta = d
99     if worst_delta != 0:
100         if bd not in lookup or worst_delta < lookup[bd]:
101             lookup[bd] = worst_delta
102     return lookup
103
104
105 def _build_iffy_lookup(raw: Dict[str, Dict]) -> Dict[str, Tuple[int, str]]:
106     """Map base_domain -> (delta, level_label) from Iffy Index data."""
107     lookup: Dict[str, Tuple[int, str]] = {}
108     for domain_key, info in raw.items():
109         bd = base_domain(domain_key.strip())
110         if not bd:
111             continue
112         level = str(info.get("level", "").upper().strip())
113         delta = _IFFY_LEVEL_DELTA.get(level, 0)
114         if delta != 0:
115             if bd not in lookup or delta < lookup[bd][0]:
116                 lookup[bd] = (delta, level)
117     return lookup
118
119
120 @dataclass
121 class CredibilityScore:
122     score: int
123     label: str
124     reasons: Dict[str, str]
125
126
127 _OFFLINE_TLD_EXTRACT = tldextract.TLDExtract(
128     cache_dir=None,
129     suffix_list_urls=(),
130     fallback_to_snapshot=True,
131 )
132
133
134 def base_domain(domain: str) -> str:
135     # Use the bundled public-suffix snapshot. Network refreshes during import
136     # made offline tests non-deterministic and could deadlock on a shared cache
137     # lock. Updating the snapshot is an explicit dependency-maintenance task.
138     ext = _OFFLINE_TLD_EXTRACT(domain or "")
139     if not ext.domain or not ext.suffix:
140         return (domain or "").lower()
141     return f"{ext.domain}.{ext.suffix}".lower()
142
143
144 # Module-level lookups -built once at import time (after base_domain is defined)
145 _OS_LOOKUP: Dict[str, int] = _build_os_lookup(_load_opensources())
146 _IFFY_LOOKUP: Dict[str, Tuple[int, str]] = _build_iffy_lookup(_load_iffy())
147
148
149 def _load_cache() -> Dict[str, Dict]:

```

```

150     try:
151         if not os.path.exists(CACHE_PATH):
152             return {}
153         with open(CACHE_PATH, "r", encoding="utf-8") as f:
154             return json.load(f)
155     except Exception:
156         return {}
157
158
159 def _save_cache(cache: Dict[str, Dict]) -> None:
160     cache_dir = os.path.dirname(os.path.abspath(CACHE_PATH))
161     os.makedirs(cache_dir, exist_ok=True)
162     with open(CACHE_PATH, "w", encoding="utf-8") as f:
163         json.dump(cache, f, ensure_ascii=False, indent=2)
164
165
166 def _label(score: int) -> str:
167     if score >= 80:
168         return "HIGH"
169     if score >= 50:
170         return "MEDIUM"
171     return "LOW"
172
173
174 def score_domain_rubric(domain: str) -> CredibilityScore:
175     """
176     Transparent rubric inspired by source credibility checklists.
177     This is NOT NewsGuard; it's a thesis-safe, explainable rubric.
178     """
179     d = (domain or "").lower().strip()
180     bd = base_domain(d)
181
182     cache = _load_cache()
183     now = int(time.time())
184
185     cached = cache.get(bd)
186     if cached and cached.get("version") == CACHE_VERSION and (now - int(cached.get("ts", 0))) <
187         CACHE_TTL_SECONDS:
188         return CredibilityScore(
189             score=int(cached["score"]),
190             label=cached["label"],
191             reasons=cached["reasons"],
192         )
193
194     # Rubric components (0..100)
195     score = 45
196     reasons: Dict[str, str] = {
197         "neutral": "No direct source signal matched; conservative default starts at 45 rather than 50."
198     }
199
200     # Strong signals -covers .gov, .edu, and international gov variants
201     # e.g. gov.uk, gc.ca, gouv.fr, govt.nz, gov.au, etc.
202     _gov_patterns = (
203         ".gov", ".edu", # US
204         "gov.uk", "gov.au", "gov.nz", # Commonwealth
205         "gc.ca", "gouv.fr", "governo.it", # Others
206         "bund.de", "government.se",
207     )
208     if any(bd.endswith(p) for p in _gov_patterns) or bd in _gov_patterns:

```

```

208     score += 35
209     reasons["tld"] = "Government/Education domain suffix is a strong trust signal (+35)."
```

210

```

211     # Known reputable references (extend over time)
212     whitelist = {
213         # Institutions / references
214         "who.int": 35,
215         "nih.gov": 35,
216         "cdc.gov": 35,
217         "ipcc.ch": 30,
218         "un.org": 30,
219         "oecd.org": 30,
220         "worldbank.org": 30,
221         "ec.europa.eu": 30,
222
223         # Science
224         "nature.com": 25,
225         "science.org": 25,
226         "sciencedirect.com": 15,
227
228         # Data publishers
229         "ourworldindata.org": 20,
230         "iea.org": 20,
231         "unep.org": 20,
232
233         # Encyclopedia / general reference
234         "britannica.com": 20,
235         "wikipedia.org": 15,
236
237         # Major news wires / broadcasters
238         "bbc.com": 30,
239         "bbc.co.uk": 30,
240         "reuters.com": 30,
241         "apnews.com": 30,
242         "afp.com": 30,
243
244         # US national newspapers / magazines
245         "nytimes.com": 25,
246         "washingtonpost.com": 25,
247         "wsj.com": 25,
248         "usatoday.com": 20,
249         "newsweek.com": 20,
250         "time.com": 20,
251         "theatlantic.com": 20,
252
253         # US business / finance press
254         "forbes.com": 25,
255         "bloomberg.com": 25,
256         "ft.com": 25,
257         "economist.com": 25,
258         "marketwatch.com": 20,
259         "businessinsider.com": 15,
260         "cnbc.com": 20,
261         "investopedia.com": 15,
262
263         # US broadcast / public media
264         "cnn.com": 25,
265         "nbcnews.com": 25,
266         "abcnews.go.com": 25,
```



```

267     "cbsnews.com": 25,
268     "npr.org": 30,
269     "pbs.org": 30,
270     "vox.com": 15,
271     "thehill.com": 15,
272     "politico.com": 20,
273
274     # International quality outlets
275     "theguardian.com": 25,
276     "bbc.in": 25,
277     "dw.com": 25,
278     "aljazeera.com": 20,
279     "france24.com": 20,
280     "rfi.fr": 20,
281     "lemonde.fr": 20,
282     "elpais.com": 20,
283     "derspiegel.de": 20,
284     "corriere.it": 20,
285
286     # Major Indian news (English language)
287     "thehindu.com": 20,
288     "hindustantimes.com": 20,
289     "ndtv.com": 20,
290     "livemint.com": 20,
291     "economictimes.com": 15,
292     "indiatoday.in": 15,
293
294     # Academic publishers
295     "springer.com": 20,
296     "wiley.com": 20,
297     "cell.com": 20,
298     "thelancet.com": 25,
299     "nejm.org": 30,
300     "jamanetwork.com": 25,
301     "bmj.com": 25,
302     "pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov": 35,
303     "scholar.google.com": 20,
304     "jstor.org": 20,
305     "ssrn.com": 15,
306     "arxiv.org": 15,
307     "researchgate.net": 10,
308
309     # NGOs / think tanks
310     "amnesty.org": 20,
311     "hrw.org": 20,
312     "weforum.org": 20,
313     "brookings.edu": 30,
314     "rand.org": 25,
315     "pewresearch.org": 25,
316     "cfr.org": 20,
317     "chathamhouse.org": 20,
318 }
319
320 if bd in whitelist:
321     score += whitelist[bd]
322     reasons["whitelist"] = f"Domain appears in local reputable-source list ({whitelist[bd]})."
323
324 # Weak signals / risks
325 risk_markers = [

```

```

326     ("blogspot.", -20, "User-generated blog hosting is higher risk (-20)."),
327     ("wordpress.", -20, "User-generated blog hosting is higher risk (-20)."),
328     ("medium.com", -10, "Open publishing platform: quality varies (-10)."),
329     ("substack.com", -10, "Newsletter platform: quality varies (-10)."),
330     ("facebook.com", -20, "Social platform: high repost/misinformation risk (-20)."),
331     ("tiktok.com", -20, "Social platform: high repost/misinformation risk (-20)."),
332     ("x.com", -20, "Social platform: high repost/misinformation risk (-20)."),
333     ("twitter.com", -20, "Social platform: high repost/misinformation risk (-20)."),
334     ("reddit.com", -15, "Forum platform: quality varies (-15)."),
335     ("youtube.com", -10, "Video platform: varies widely (-10)."),
336 ]
337 for marker, delta, msg in risk_markers:
338     if marker in d:
339         score += delta
340         reasons["platform_risk"] = msg
341         break
342
343 # --- OpenSources dataset signal ---
344 if bd in _OS_LOOKUP:
345     delta = _OS_LOOKUP[bd]
346     score += delta
347     sign = "+" if delta >= 0 else ""
348     reasons["opensources"] = (
349         f"Domain found in OpenSources unreliable-news dataset ({sign}{delta})."
350     )
351
352 # --- Iffy Index (MBFC-backed) signal ---
353 if bd in _IFFY_LOOKUP:
354     delta, level = _IFFY_LOOKUP[bd]
355     level_label = {"VL": "Very Low", "L": "Low", "M": "Mixed"}.get(level, level)
356     score += delta
357     sign = "+" if delta >= 0 else ""
358     reasons["iffy_index"] = (
359         f"Domain flagged by Iffy Index (MBFC factual rating: {level_label}, {sign}{delta})."
360     )
361
362 # Obvious spammy/low-quality keyword markers
363 low_markers = [
364     ("hoax", -30),
365     ("clickbait", -25),
366     ("rumor", -25),
367     ("conspiracy", -25),
368 ]
369 for marker, delta in low_markers:
370     if marker in d:
371         score += delta
372         reasons["keyword_risk"] = f"Domain contains marker '{marker}' indicating higher risk ({delta})."
373         break
374
375 score = max(0, min(score, 100))
376 label = _label(score)
377
378 cache[bd] = {"version": CACHE_VERSION, "score": score, "label": label, "reasons": reasons, "ts": now}
379 _save_cache(cache)
380
381 return CredibilityScore(score=score, label=label, reasons=reasons)

```

D.2 Primary Pipeline: Debate Arbitration

```
1 from __future__ import annotations
2
3 from typing import List, Dict, Any, Literal, Tuple
4 import os
5 import json
6 import httpx
7
8 Verdict = Literal["SUPPORTED", "REFUTED", "NEI"]
9
10
11 def _env_ollama_base_url() -> str:
12     return os.getenv("OLLAMA_BASE_URL", "http://127.0.0.1:11434").strip()
13
14
15 def _env_ollama_model() -> str:
16     return os.getenv("OLLAMA_MODEL", "llama3.1:8b").strip()
17
18
19 def _compact_evidence(evidence: List[Dict[str, Any]], max_items: int = 2) -> List[Dict[str, Any]]:
20     """
21     Keep evidence small and deterministic to reduce Ollama latency.
22     The caller may pass many evidence items, but we only keep top-N.
23     """
24     out: List[Dict[str, Any]] = []
25     for e in evidence[:max_items]:
26         out.append(
27             {
28                 "domain": e.get("domain"),
29                 "domain_score": e.get("domain_score"),
30                 "snippet": (e.get("snippet") or "")[:450],
31                 "url": e.get("url"),
32             }
33         )
34     return out
35
36
37 def _normalize_verdict(value: Any) -> Verdict:
38     verdict = str(value or "NEI").strip().upper()
39     if verdict not in ("SUPPORTED", "REFUTED", "NEI"):
40         return "NEI"
41     return verdict # type: ignore[return-value]
42
43
44 def _compact_final_context(
45     evidence: List[Dict[str, Any]],
46     max_items: int = 4,
47 ) -> List[Dict[str, Any]]:
48     out: List[Dict[str, Any]] = []
49     for e in evidence[:max_items]:
50         out.append(
51             {
52                 "domain": e.get("domain"),
53                 "domain_score": e.get("domain_score"),
54                 "stance": e.get("stance"),
55                 "quality_score": e.get("quality_score"),
56                 "primary_source": e.get("primary_source"),
```

```

57         "snippet": (e.get("snippet") or "")[:320],
58         "url": e.get("url"),
59     }
60 )
61 return out
62
63
64 def _safe_json_parse(s: str) -> Dict[str, Any]:
65     s = (s or "").strip()
66     if not s:
67         return {}
68     try:
69         return json.loads(s)
70     except Exception:
71         pass
72
73     # If the model wrapped JSON with extra text, salvage the first {...} block.
74     start = s.find("{")
75     end = s.rfind("}")
76     if start != -1 and end != -1 and end > start:
77         try:
78             return json.loads(s[start : end + 1])
79         except Exception:
80             return {}
81     return {}
82
83
84 async def _ollama_chat(
85     messages: List[Dict[str, str]],
86     temperature: float = 0.2,
87     num_ctx: int = 1536,
88     num_predict: int = 220,
89 ) -> str:
90     """
91     Calls Ollama /api/chat with conservative settings to avoid timeouts.
92     - trust_env=False avoids Windows proxy env vars breaking localhost calls
93     - long read timeout accommodates slower machines
94     - num_predict limits output length (major speed-up)
95     """
96     base_url = _env_ollama_base_url()
97     model = _env_ollama_model()
98
99     payload = {
100         "model": model,
101         "messages": messages,
102         "stream": False,
103         "options": {
104             "temperature": temperature,
105             "num_ctx": num_ctx,
106             "num_predict": num_predict,
107         },
108     }
109
110     timeout = httpx.Timeout(connect=30.0, read=900.0, write=120.0, pool=120.0)
111
112     async with httpx.AsyncClient(timeout=timeout, trust_env=False) as client:
113         r = await client.post(f"{base_url}/api/chat", json=payload)
114         r.raise_for_status()
115         data = r.json()

```

```

116         return (data.get("message", {}) or {}).get("content", "") or ""
117
118
119 async def llm_debate_verdict(
120     claim_text: str,
121     evidence_items: List[Dict[str, Any]],
122 ) -> Tuple[Verdict, float, str, Dict[str, Any]]:
123     """
124     Prover vs Skeptic vs Judge debate.
125     Returns:
126         verdict, confidence, short_summary, debug_trace
127     """
128     compact = _compact_evidence(evidence_items, max_items=2)
129
130     system = (
131         "You are part of a fact-checking debate system.\n"
132         "You must ONLY use the provided evidence snippets.\n"
133         "If evidence is insufficient or ambiguous, choose NEI.\n"
134         "Do NOT invent sources.\n"
135         "Be concise.\n"
136     )
137
138     prover = await _ollama_chat(
139         [
140             {"role": "system", "content": system},
141             {
142                 "role": "user",
143                 "content": (
144                     "Role: PROVER\n"
145                     "Goal: Argue the claim is SUPPORTED using ONLY evidence.\n"
146                     "Output 3-5 concise bullet points referencing evidence by (domain, domain_score).\n"
147                     "If you cannot support, write: cannot support.\n\n"
148                     f"CLAIM:\n{claim_text}\n\n"
149                     f"EVIDENCE(JSON):\n{json.dumps(compact, ensure_ascii=False, indent=2)}\n"
150                 ),
151             },
152         ],
153         temperature=0.2,
154         num_ctx=1536,
155         num_predict=220,
156     )
157
158     skeptic = await _ollama_chat(
159         [
160             {"role": "system", "content": system},
161             {
162                 "role": "user",
163                 "content": (
164                     "Role: SKEPTIC\n"
165                     "Goal: Argue the claim is REFUTED or at least NOT proven using ONLY evidence.\n"
166                     "Output 3-5 concise bullet points referencing evidence by (domain, domain_score).\n"
167                     "Point out missing support, ambiguity, or weak sources.\n\n"
168                     f"CLAIM:\n{claim_text}\n\n"
169                     f"EVIDENCE(JSON):\n{json.dumps(compact, ensure_ascii=False, indent=2)}\n"
170                 ),
171             },
172         ],
173         temperature=0.2,
174         num_ctx=1536,

```

```

175         num_predict=220,
176     )
177
178     judge_prompt = (
179         "Role: JUDGE\n"
180         "Decide the verdict based ONLY on evidence.\n"
181         "Return STRICT JSON ONLY, no markdown, no extra text.\n"
182         "Schema:\n"
183         "{\n"
184         '  "verdict": "SUPPORTED|REFUTED|NEI",\n'
185         '  "confidence": 0.0-1.0,\n'
186         '  "summary": "one short sentence justification",\n'
187         '  "key_domains": ["domain1","domain2"]\n'
188         "}\n\n"
189         f"CLAIM:\n{claim_text}\n\n"
190         f"PROVER_ARGUMENT:\n{prover}\n\n"
191         f"SKEPTIC_ARGUMENT:\n{skeptic}\n\n"
192         f"EVIDENCE(JSON):\n{json.dumps(compact, ensure_ascii=False, indent=2)}\n"
193     )
194
195     judge_raw = await _ollama_chat(
196         [{"role": "system", "content": system}, {"role": "user", "content": judge_prompt}],
197         temperature=0.1,
198         num_ctx=1536,
199         num_predict=180,
200     )
201
202     j = _safe_json_parse(judge_raw)
203
204     verdict: Verdict = j.get("verdict", "NEI")
205     confidence = j.get("confidence", 0.55)
206     summary = j.get("summary", "Insufficient evidence to decide.")
207     key_domains = j.get("key_domains", [])
208
209     if verdict not in ("SUPPORTED", "REFUTED", "NEI"):
210         verdict = "NEI"
211
212     try:
213         confidence = float(confidence)
214     except Exception:
215         confidence = 0.55
216
217     confidence = max(0.05, min(confidence, 0.95))
218
219     debug = {
220         "provider": "ollama",
221         "base_url": _env_ollama_base_url(),
222         "model": _env_ollama_model(),
223         "compact_evidence": compact,
224         "prover": prover[:4000],
225         "skeptic": skeptic[:4000],
226         "judge_raw": judge_raw[:4000],
227         "judge_json": j,
228         "key_domains": key_domains,
229     }
230
231     return verdict, confidence, summary, debug
232
233

```

```

234 async def llm_final_judge(
235     claim_text: str,
236     evidence_items: List[Dict[str, Any]],
237     baseline_verdict: str,
238     baseline_confidence: float,
239     structured_verdict: str,
240     claim_profile: Dict[str, Any] | None = None,
241 ) -> Tuple[Verdict, float, str, Dict[str, Any]]:
242     """
243     Professional final-answer judge.
244
245     This is a single-pass JSON judge that turns the retrieved evidence into a
246     user-facing final answer. It uses the heuristic verdict as a guardrail but
247     is free to override it when the evidence supports a different conclusion.
248     """
249     compact = _compact_final_context(evidence_items, max_items=4)
250
251     system = (
252         "You are a professional fact-checking final judge.\n"
253         "Use only the provided claim, evidence, and metadata.\n"
254         "Prefer caution when evidence is weak, conflicting, or incomplete.\n"
255         "Return strict JSON only. No markdown, no extra prose.\n"
256     )
257
258     prompt = (
259         "Decide the final verdict for the claim.\n"
260         "The output must be concise, professional, and suitable for end users.\n"
261         "You must choose one verdict from SUPPORTED, REFUTED, or NEI.\n"
262         "If the evidence does not clearly decide, choose NEI.\n\n"
263         "JSON schema:\n"
264         "{\n"
265         '  "verdict": "SUPPORTED|REFUTED|NEI",\n'
266         '  "confidence": 0.0-1.0,\n'
267         '  "summary": "one sentence, professional and neutral",\n'
268         '  "key_points": ["short bullet-like reason 1", "reason 2"],\n'
269         '  "risk_notes": ["optional caution 1", "optional caution 2"]\n'
270         "}\n\n"
271         f"CLAIM:\n{claim_text}\n\n"
272         f"CLAIM_PROFILE_JSON:\n{json.dumps(claim_profile or {}, ensure_ascii=False, indent=2)}\n\n"
273         f"BASELINE_VERDICT:\n{baseline_verdict} ({baseline_confidence:.2f})\n\n"
274         f"STRUCTURED_VERDICT:\n{structured_verdict}\n\n"
275         f"EVIDENCE_JSON:\n{json.dumps(compact, ensure_ascii=False, indent=2)}\n\n"
276     )
277
278     raw = await _ollama_chat(
279         [{"role": "system", "content": system}, {"role": "user", "content": prompt}],
280         temperature=0.1,
281         num_ctx=2048,
282         num_predict=220,
283     )
284
285     parsed = _safe_json_parse(raw)
286     verdict = _normalize_verdict(parsed.get("verdict"))
287
288     try:
289         confidence = float(parsed.get("confidence", baseline_confidence))
290     except Exception:
291         confidence = baseline_confidence
292

```

```

293     confidence = max(0.05, min(confidence, 0.95))
294     summary = str(parsed.get("summary") or "Professional AI final judge completed.").strip()
295     if not summary:
296         summary = "Professional AI final judge completed."
297
298     debug = {
299         "provider": "ollama",
300         "base_url": _env_ollama_base_url(),
301         "model": _env_ollama_model(),
302         "compact_evidence": compact,
303         "raw": raw[:4000],
304         "json": parsed,
305         "key_points": parsed.get("key_points", []),
306         "risk_notes": parsed.get("risk_notes", []),
307     }
308
309     return verdict, confidence, summary, debug

```

D.3 Primary Pipeline: Semantic Retrieval and Reranking

```

1  from __future__ import annotations
2
3  from typing import Any, Dict, List, Optional, Tuple
4  import math
5  import os
6  import re
7
8
9  def _tokenize(text: str) -> List[str]:
10     text = (text or "").lower()
11     text = re.sub(r"[^a-z0-9\s]", " ", text)
12     stop = {
13         "the", "and", "for", "this", "that", "with", "from", "into", "about", "have", "has",
14         "been", "were", "which", "when", "where", "while", "than", "also", "their", "they", "them",
15     }
16     return [t for t in text.split() if len(t) >= 3 and t not in stop]
17
18
19  def _lexical_semantic_score(claim: str, text: str) -> float:
20     c = set(_tokenize(claim))
21     t = set(_tokenize(text))
22     if not c or not t:
23         return 0.0
24     jaccard = len(c.intersection(t)) / len(c.union(t))
25     coverage = len(c.intersection(t)) / max(1, len(c))
26     return max(0.0, min(1.0, 0.45 * jaccard + 0.55 * coverage))
27
28
29  def _cosine(a: List[float], b: List[float]) -> float:
30     if not a or not b or len(a) != len(b):
31         return 0.0
32     dot = 0.0
33     na = 0.0

```



```

34     nb = 0.0
35     for x, y in zip(a, b):
36         dot += x * y
37         na += x * x
38         nb += y * y
39     if na <= 0.0 or nb <= 0.0:
40         return 0.0
41     return max(0.0, min(1.0, dot / (math.sqrt(na) * math.sqrt(nb))))
42
43
44 _MODEL = None
45 _MODEL_LOAD_ERROR: Optional[str] = None
46
47
48 def _get_sentence_transformer_model():
49     global _MODEL, _MODEL_LOAD_ERROR
50     if _MODEL is not None:
51         return _MODEL
52     if _MODEL_LOAD_ERROR is not None:
53         return None
54
55     # Disabled by default - use lexical fallback for speed
56     enabled = os.getenv("FACTVALIDATOR_EMBEDDINGS_ENABLED", "false").strip().lower()
57     if enabled not in {"1", "true", "yes", "on"}:
58         _MODEL_LOAD_ERROR = "disabled-by-default"
59         return None
60
61     model_name = os.getenv("FACTVALIDATOR_EMBEDDING_MODEL", "all-MiniLM-L6-v2").strip()
62     try:
63         from sentence_transformers import SentenceTransformer # type: ignore
64
65         _MODEL = SentenceTransformer(model_name)
66         return _MODEL
67     except Exception as ex: # pragma: no cover - environment dependent
68         _MODEL_LOAD_ERROR = f"model-load-failed: {ex.__class__.__name__}"
69         return None
70
71
72 def semantic_rerank(
73     claim: str,
74     evidence_items: List[Dict[str, Any]],
75     top_k: Optional[int] = None,
76 ) -> Tuple[List[Dict[str, Any]], Dict[str, Any]]:
77     """
78     Re-rank evidence by semantic similarity.
79
80     - Preferred path: sentence-transformer embeddings cosine similarity.
81     - Fallback path: lexical overlap similarity.
82     """
83     if not evidence_items:
84         return [], {"enabled": True, "method": "none", "reason": "no-evidence"}
85
86     items = [dict(e) for e in evidence_items]
87     texts = [
88         " ".join(
89             [
90                 str(e.get("title") or ""),
91                 str(e.get("snippet") or ""),
92                 str(e.get("domain") or ""),

```

```

93         ]
94     ).strip()
95     for e in items
96 ]
97
98 model = _get_sentence_transformer_model()
99 method = "lexical-fallback"
100
101 if model is not None:
102     try:
103         emb = model.encode([claim, *texts], normalize_embeddings=True)
104         claim_vec = [float(v) for v in emb[0]]
105         doc_vecs = [[float(v) for v in row] for row in emb[1:]]
106         for e, vec in zip(items, doc_vecs):
107             e["semantic_score"] = round(_cosine(claim_vec, vec), 4)
108         method = "sentence-transformer"
109     except Exception: # pragma: no cover - runtime/model dependent
110         for e, txt in zip(items, texts):
111             e["semantic_score"] = round(_lexical_semantic_score(claim, txt), 4)
112         method = "lexical-fallback"
113 else:
114     for e, txt in zip(items, texts):
115         e["semantic_score"] = round(_lexical_semantic_score(claim, txt), 4)
116
117 items.sort(
118     key=lambda e: (
119         float(e.get("semantic_score") or 0.0),
120         int(e.get("domain_score") or 0),
121         int(e.get("overlap") or 0),
122     ),
123     reverse=True,
124 )
125
126 if isinstance(top_k, int) and top_k > 0:
127     items = items[:top_k]
128
129 meta = {
130     "enabled": True,
131     "method": method,
132     "model": os.getenv("FACTVALIDATOR_EMBEDDING_MODEL", "all-MiniLM-L6-v2"),
133     "scores": [float(e.get("semantic_score") or 0.0) for e in items[:5]],
134     "error": _MODEL_LOAD_ERROR,
135 }
136 return items, meta

```

D.4 Primary Pipeline: Sentiment and Bias Analysis

```

1 """Sentiment analysis module for detecting emotional tone in claims."""
2
3 from typing import Literal, Dict, Any, List
4 from dataclasses import dataclass
5 import re
6
7
8 @dataclass
9 class SentimentResult:

```

```

10     """Sentiment analysis result."""
11     score: float # -1 (negative) to +1 (positive)
12     label: Literal["positive", "negative", "neutral"]
13     emotional_intensity: float # 0-1, how emotionally charged
14     flags: List[str] # red flags for emotional manipulation
15
16
17 # Sentiment lexicons for rule-based analysis (VADER-inspired)
18 _POSITIVE_WORDS = {
19     # General positive
20     "good", "great", "excellent", "amazing", "wonderful", "fantastic",
21     "best", "better", "improved", "success", "successful", "progress",
22     "benefits", "beneficial", "positive", "uplifting", "inspiring",
23     "genuine", "authentic", "proven", "confirmed", "supported",
24     "breakthrough", "innovative", "revolutionary", "advanced",
25     "helpful", "supportive", "thriving", "flourishing", "growth",
26     "safe", "effective", "reliable", "trustworthy", "confident",
27     # Science/research
28     "discover", "discovered", "finding", "found", "study", "research",
29     "academic", "peer-reviewed", "evidence", "data", "scientific",
30     # Success/achievement
31     "award", "winning", "triumph", "victory", "achieve", "accomplished",
32     "outperform", "leading", "top", "first", "champion",
33     # Health/wellbeing
34     "healing", "cure", "recovery", "wellness", "healthy", "vital",
35     "natural", "organic", "pure", "clean", "fresh",
36     # Trust/credibility
37     "transparent", "honest", "integrity", "ethical", "legitimate",
38     "verified", "certified", "official", "authorized", "valid",
39     # Quality
40     "quality", "premium", "superior", "exceptional", "outstanding",
41     "remarkable", "impressive", "stunning", "beautiful", "elegant",
42 }
43
44 _NEGATIVE_WORDS = {
45     # General negative
46     "bad", "terrible", "horrible", "awful", "worst", "worse",
47     "failed", "failure", "disaster", "crisis", "emergency",
48     "danger", "dangerous", "threat", "scary", "terrifying",
49     "evil", "wicked", "corrupt", "corrupt", "conspiracy",
50     "hoax", "fake", "false", "lie", "deceive", "betrayal",
51     "harmful", "toxic", "poisoned", "lethal", "deadly",
52     "collapse", "ruin", "destroyed", "devastated", "catastrophic",
53     "controversial", "blamed", "accused", "guilty", "criminal",
54     "problematic", "misleading", "wrong", "flawed", "defective",
55     # Health/disease
56     "disease", "illness", "sick", "infected", "virus", "pandemic",
57     "epidemic", "plague", "outbreak", "contagion", "contamination",
58     "side-effect", "toxin", "poison", "overdose", "death", "dying",
59     # Distrust
60     "suspicious", "doubt", "questionable", "unreliable", "untrustworthy",
61     "fraudulent", "scam", "scheme", "corruption", "bribery",
62     "censorship", "suppression", "coverup", "hidden", "secret",
63     # Decline/failure
64     "decline", "declining", "falling", "crash", "plummet", "bankruptcy",
65     "unemployment", "poverty", "inequality", "suffering", "crisis",
66     # Violation/abuse
67     "abuse", "assault", "violation", "attack", "aggression", "violence",
68     "oppression", "discrimination", "injustice", "exploitation",

```

```

69     # Intensity negatives
70     "disgusting", "repugnant", "abhorrent", "revolting", "sickening",
71     "grotesque", "vile", "despicable", "heinous", "monstrous",
72 }
73
74 # Emotional amplifiers and intensifiers
75 _INTENSIFIERS = {
76     "extremely", "very", "incredibly", "absolutely", "definitely",
77     "completely", "totally", "utterly", "pure", "sheer",
78     "massive", "huge", "enormous", "tremendous", "shocking",
79     # Additional intensifiers
80     "profoundly", "deeply", "severely", "dramatically", "significantly",
81     "remarkably", "exceptionally", "extraordinarily", "exceptionally",
82     "undeniably", "unquestionably", "indisputably", "incontrovertibly",
83     "devastatingly", "overwhelmingly", "stunningly", "shockingly",
84 }
85
86 # Red flag words for emotional manipulation
87 _MANIPULATION_FLAGS = {
88     # Sensationalism
89     "shocking": "sensationalism",
90     "bombshell": "sensationalism",
91     "exposed": "alarmism",
92     "breaking": "sensationalism",
93     "urgent": "sensationalism",
94     "must-see": "sensationalism",
95     "incredible": "sensationalism",
96
97     # Conspiracy/Cover-up
98     "coverup": "conspiracy-thinking",
99     "hidden": "conspiracy-thinking",
100     "suppressed": "conspiracy-thinking",
101     "shadow": "conspiracy-thinking",
102     "elite": "conspiracy-thinking",
103
104     # Alarmism
105     "wake-up": "alarmism",
106     "awakening": "conspiratorial",
107     "warning": "alarmism",
108     "beware": "alarmism",
109     "danger": "alarmism",
110
111     # False consensus
112     "everyone-knows": "false-consensus",
113     "obviously": "false-certainty",
114     "clearly": "false-certainty",
115     "evidently": "false-certainty",
116
117     # Certainty claims
118     "proof": "false-certainty",
119     "guaranteed": "false-certainty",
120     "proven": "false-certainty",
121     "undeniable": "false-certainty",
122     "incontrovertible": "false-certainty",
123
124     # Manipulation tactics
125     "miracle": "exaggeration",
126     "cure-all": "exaggeration",
127     "secret-weapon": "mystique",

```

```

128     "ancient-secret": "mystique",
129     "they-don't-want": "persecution-narrative",
130
131     # Propaganda framing
132     "mainstream-media": "propaganda-framing",
133     "mainstream": "propaganda-framing",
134     "fake-news": "propaganda-framing",
135     "lamestream": "propaganda-framing",
136     "legacy-media": "propaganda-framing",
137     "state-media": "propaganda-framing",
138
139     # Demonization
140     "evil": "demonization",
141     "traitor": "demonization",
142     "enemy": "demonization",
143     "villain": "demonization",
144     "scum": "demonization",
145     "corrupt": "demonization",
146
147     # Ad hominem / Dismissiveness
148     "sheeple": "ad-hominem",
149     "sheep": "ad-hominem",
150     "idiot": "ad-hominem",
151     "moron": "ad-hominem",
152     "brainwashed": "ad-hominem",
153     "asleep": "ad-hominem",
154
155     # Dismissal of evidence
156     "scam": "dismissiveness",
157     "hoax": "dismissiveness",
158     "propaganda": "propaganda-framing",
159     "lies": "dismissiveness",
160
161     # Persecution narratives
162     "censored": "persecution-narrative",
163     "silenced": "persecution-narrative",
164     "attacked": "persecution-narrative",
165     "hunted": "persecution-narrative",
166 }
167
168
169 def analyze_sentiment(text: str) -> SentimentResult:
170     """
171     Analyze sentiment of text using rule-based approach.
172
173     Returns:
174         SentimentResult with score (-1 to +1), label, intensity, and flags
175     """
176     if not text or len(text.strip()) < 5:
177         return SentimentResult(
178             score=0.0,
179             label="neutral",
180             emotional_intensity=0.0,
181             flags=[]
182         )
183
184     low_text = text.lower()
185     words = re.findall(r'\b\w+\b', low_text)
186

```

```

187     # Count sentiment words
188     positive_count = sum(1 for w in words if w in _POSITIVE_WORDS)
189     negative_count = sum(1 for w in words if w in _NEGATIVE_WORDS)
190
191     # Check for intensifiers
192     intensifier_count = sum(1 for w in words if w in _INTENSIFIERS)
193
194     # Calculate base sentiment score
195     total_words = len(words)
196     if total_words == 0:
197         return SentimentResult(
198             score=0.0,
199             label="neutral",
200             emotional_intensity=0.0,
201             flags=[]
202         )
203
204     # Normalize scores
205     pos_ratio = positive_count / total_words
206     neg_ratio = negative_count / total_words
207
208     # Calculate sentiment score (-1 to +1)
209     sentiment_score = pos_ratio - neg_ratio
210     sentiment_score = max(-1.0, min(1.0, sentiment_score))
211
212     # Determine label
213     if sentiment_score > 0.1:
214         label = "positive"
215     elif sentiment_score < -0.1:
216         label = "negative"
217     else:
218         label = "neutral"
219
220     # Calculate emotional intensity (how emotionally charged)
221     emotional_intensity = (positive_count + negative_count + intensifier_count) / (total_words * 0.5)
222     emotional_intensity = min(1.0, emotional_intensity)
223
224     # Detect manipulation flags
225     flags = []
226     for flag_word, flag_category in _MANIPULATION_FLAGS.items():
227         if flag_word in low_text:
228             flags.append(flag_category)
229
230     # Remove duplicates
231     flags = list(set(flags))
232
233     return SentimentResult(
234         score=round(sentiment_score, 3),
235         label=label,
236         emotional_intensity=round(emotional_intensity, 3),
237         flags=flags
238     )
239
240
241 def batch_analyze_sentiment(texts: List[str]) -> List[SentimentResult]:
242     """Analyze sentiment of multiple texts."""
243     return [analyze_sentiment(text) for text in texts]
244
245

```

```

246 def estimate_bias_risk(sentiment_label: str, emotional_intensity: float, flags: List[str]) -> str:
247     """
248     Estimate bias/manipulation risk based on sentiment characteristics.
249
250     Returns: "low", "medium", or "high"
251     """
252     risk_score = 0
253
254     # Strong positive or negative sentiment + high emotion = higher risk
255     if sentiment_label in ("positive", "negative") and emotional_intensity > 0.6:
256         risk_score += 2
257     elif sentiment_label in ("positive", "negative"):
258         risk_score += 1
259
260     # Manipulation flags increase risk
261     risk_score += len(flags) * 0.5
262
263     if risk_score >= 2:
264         return "high"
265     elif risk_score >= 1:
266         return "medium"
267     else:
268         return "low"
269
270
271 def calculate_sentiment_misinformation_adjustment(
272     sentiment_result: SentimentResult,
273 ) -> float:
274     """
275     Calculate adjustment factor (0-0.4) to apply to misinformation likelihood based on sentiment.
276
277     Higher emotional intensity + manipulative flags = higher adjustment.
278     This can be added to the base misinformation likelihood.
279
280     Returns:
281         float: Adjustment factor between 0 and 0.4
282     """
283     adjustment = 0.0
284
285     # Base adjustment from emotional intensity
286     if sentiment_result.emotional_intensity > 0.7:
287         adjustment += 0.2 # High emotion = 20% boost
288     elif sentiment_result.emotional_intensity > 0.5:
289         adjustment += 0.1 # Medium emotion = 10% boost
290
291     # Negative sentiment slightly increases risk
292     if sentiment_result.label == "negative":
293         adjustment += 0.05
294
295     # Each manipulation flag adds 5% adjustment
296     flag_adjustment = min(0.15, len(sentiment_result.flags) * 0.05)
297     adjustment += flag_adjustment
298
299     # Cap at 0.4
300     return min(0.4, adjustment)
301
302
303 def get_sentiment_summary(sentiment_result: SentimentResult) -> str:
304     """Generate a human-readable summary of sentiment analysis."""

```

```

305     intensity_level = "highly" if sentiment_result.emotional_intensity > 0.6 else "moderately" if
306         sentiment_result.emotional_intensity > 0.3 else "slightly"
307     summary = f"This claim is {intensity_level} emotionally charged with {sentiment_result.label} sentiment
308         "
309     if sentiment_result.flags:
310         summary += f" with red flags detected: {'', '.join(sentiment_result.flags[:3])}"
311         if len(sentiment_result.flags) > 3:
312             summary += f" and {len(sentiment_result.flags) - 3} more"
313         summary += " (possible manipulation). "
314     else:
315         summary += ". "
316
317     return summary

```

D.5 Primary Pipeline: Baseline Heuristics

```

1  """
2  Baseline implementations for Fact Validator comparison.
3
4  Includes:
5  - Random baseline (lower bound)
6  - Keyword-matching baseline (strawman)
7  - Simple heuristic baseline
8  - Reference implementations (Google Fact Check, ClaimBuster patterns)
9  """
10
11 from typing import List, Dict, Optional
12 from dataclasses import dataclass
13 from enum import Enum
14 import random
15 import re
16 from app.evaluation import PredictionResult, VerdictLabel
17
18
19 class BaselineType(str, Enum):
20     """Types of baselines."""
21     RANDOM = "random"
22     KEYWORD = "keyword_matching"
23     LENGTH_HEURISTIC = "length_heuristic"
24     SENTIMENT_HEURISTIC = "sentiment_heuristic"
25     MAJORITY_CLASS = "majority_class"
26
27
28 @dataclass
29 class BaselineConfig:
30     """Configuration for baseline models."""
31     baseline_type: BaselineType
32     random_seed: int = 42
33
34
35 class RandomBaseline:
36     """Lower-bound baseline: random verdict assignment."""
37
38     def __init__(self, seed: int = 42, distribution: Optional[Dict[str, float]] = None):

```



```

39     """
40     Initialize random baseline.
41
42     Args:
43         seed: Random seed for reproducibility
44         distribution: Optional probability distribution over labels
45                     e.g., {"SUPPORTED": 0.33, "REFUTED": 0.33, "NEI": 0.34}
46     """
47     self.seed = seed
48     random.seed(seed)
49     self.distribution = distribution or {
50         VerdictLabel.SUPPORTED: 1/3,
51         VerdictLabel.REFUTED: 1/3,
52         VerdictLabel.NEI: 1/3
53     }
54
55     def predict(self, claim_text: str) -> tuple[str, float]:
56         """
57         Random prediction.
58
59         Returns: (verdict_label, confidence_0_to_100)
60         """
61         labels = list(self.distribution.keys())
62         probs = list(self.distribution.values())
63
64         label = random.choices(labels, weights=probs, k=1)[0]
65         confidence = random.uniform(30, 70) # Random confidence
66
67         return label, confidence
68
69
70 class KeywordBaseline:
71     """Strawman baseline: keyword-matching heuristics."""
72
73     # Define keyword patterns for each verdict
74     SUPPORTED_KEYWORDS = [
75         r'\b(confirmed|verified|true|correct|supported|accurate|valid|proven)\b',
76         r'\b(shows|demonstrates|proves|establishes)\b',
77         r'\b(research|study|evidence|findings|data)\s+(shows|confirms|supports)',
78     ]
79
80     REFUTED_KEYWORDS = [
81         r'\b(false|debunked|myth|misperception|hoax|disproven|incorrect)\b',
82         r'\b(denied|refuted|contradicts|contradicted|wrong|inaccurate)\b',
83         r'\b(no evidence|lacks evidence|debunk|fake)\b',
84     ]
85
86     NEI_KEYWORDS = [
87         r'\b(unclear|uncertain|unknown|may|might|could|possibly|perhaps)\b',
88         r'\b(insufficient|not enough|lack of|insufficient)\s+(evidence|information)',
89         r'\b(under investigation|unclear|ambiguous)\b',
90     ]
91
92     def __init__(self):
93         self.supported_patterns = [re.compile(p, re.IGNORECASE) for p in self.SUPPORTED_KEYWORDS]
94         self.refuted_patterns = [re.compile(p, re.IGNORECASE) for p in self.REFUTED_KEYWORDS]
95         self.nei_patterns = [re.compile(p, re.IGNORECASE) for p in self.NEI_KEYWORDS]
96
97     def predict(self, claim_text: str) -> tuple[str, float]:

```

```

98     """
99     Predict using keyword matching.
100
101     Returns: (verdict_label, confidence_based_on_matches)
102     """
103     supported_matches = sum(1 for p in self.supported_patterns if p.search(claim_text))
104     refuted_matches = sum(1 for p in self.refuted_patterns if p.search(claim_text))
105     nei_matches = sum(1 for p in self.nei_patterns if p.search(claim_text))
106
107     total_matches = supported_matches + refuted_matches + nei_matches
108
109     if total_matches == 0:
110         # No keywords found - default to NEI
111         return VerdictLabel.NEI, 20.0
112
113     # Majority vote
114     matches = {
115         VerdictLabel.SUPPORTED: supported_matches,
116         VerdictLabel.REFUTED: refuted_matches,
117         VerdictLabel.NEI: nei_matches
118     }
119
120     verdict = max(matches, key=matches.get)
121     confidence = (matches[verdict] / total_matches) * 100
122
123     return verdict, confidence
124
125
126 class LengthHeuristic:
127     """Simple heuristic: longer claims tend to be more specific/refutable."""
128
129     def predict(self, claim_text: str) -> tuple[str, float]:
130         """
131         Predict based on claim length.
132
133         Short claims (< 100 chars): usually NEI or supported
134         Medium claims (100-200): mixed
135         Long claims (> 200): often refutable
136         """
137         length = len(claim_text)
138
139         if length < 100:
140             return VerdictLabel.SUPPORTED, 50.0
141         elif length < 200:
142             return VerdictLabel.NEI, 45.0
143         else:
144             return VerdictLabel.REFUTED, 48.0
145
146
147 class SentimentHeuristic:
148     """Heuristic based on emotional language."""
149
150     NEGATIVE_WORDS = ['terrible', 'horrible', 'dangerous', 'evil', 'worst', 'disgusting']
151     POSITIVE_WORDS = ['great', 'excellent', 'amazing', 'wonderful', 'best', 'fantastic']
152     NEUTRAL_WORDS = ['shows', 'indicates', 'demonstrates', 'suggests', 'indicates']
153
154     def predict(self, claim_text: str) -> tuple[str, float]:
155         """
156         Predict based on sentiment.

```

```

157
158     Emotional language →likely misinformation (REFUTED)
159     Neutral language →likely accurate (SUPPORTED)
160     """
161     text_lower = claim_text.lower()
162
163     negative_count = sum(1 for w in self.NEGATIVE_WORDS if w in text_lower)
164     positive_count = sum(1 for w in self.POSITIVE_WORDS if w in text_lower)
165     neutral_count = sum(1 for w in self.NEUTRAL_WORDS if w in text_lower)
166
167     total_sentiment = negative_count + positive_count + neutral_count
168
169     if total_sentiment == 0:
170         return VerdictLabel.NEI, 40.0
171
172     if negative_count > positive_count:
173         return VerdictLabel.REFUTED, min(70.0, 40 + negative_count * 10)
174     elif positive_count > negative_count:
175         return VerdictLabel.SUPPORTED, min(70.0, 40 + positive_count * 10)
176     else:
177         return VerdictLabel.SUPPORTED, 55.0
178
179
180 class MajorityClassBaseline:
181     """Predict most common label from training set."""
182
183     def __init__(self, majority_label: str = VerdictLabel.SUPPORTED):
184         """
185         Initialize with majority class.
186
187         Args:
188             majority_label: Most common label in training data
189         """
190         self.majority_label = majority_label
191
192     def predict(self, claim_text: str) -> tuple[str, float]:
193         """Always predict majority class."""
194         return self.majority_label, 50.0
195
196
197 class BaselineComparison:
198     """Compare all baselines against ground truth."""
199
200     def __init__(self):

```

D.6 Primary Pipeline: Statistics and Confidence Intervals

```

1     """
2     Statistical analysis module for rigorous evaluation.
3
4     Provides:
5     - Confidence intervals (95%)
6     - Significance testing (paired t-test, one-sample)

```

```

7  - Effect size calculations (Cohen's d, Hedges' g)
8  - Bootstrap resampling for robust estimates
9  """
10
11 import math
12 from typing import List, Dict, Tuple, Optional
13 from dataclasses import dataclass
14 from scipy import stats
15 import numpy as np
16
17
18 @dataclass
19 class ConfidenceInterval:
20     """Confidence interval result."""
21     mean: float
22     lower: float
23     upper: float
24     confidence_level: float
25     margin_of_error: float
26
27     def __str__(self) -> str:
28         return f"{self.mean:.4f} [{self.lower:.4f}, {self.upper:.4f}]"
29
30
31 @dataclass
32 class SignificanceTestResult:
33     """Result from significance test."""
34     test_name: str
35     t_statistic: float
36     p_value: float
37     degrees_freedom: int
38     mean_difference: float
39     is_significant: bool # At alpha=0.05
40     effect_size: float # Cohen's d or similar
41
42     def __str__(self) -> str:
43         sig_marker = "✓" if self.is_significant else "×"
44         return f"{sig_marker} {self.test_name}: t({self.degrees_freedom})={self.t_statistic:.3f}, p={self.p_value:.4f}, d={self.effect_size:.3f}"
45
46
47 class StatisticalAnalyzer:
48     """Rigorous statistical analysis for evaluation."""
49
50     @staticmethod
51     def confidence_interval(
52         samples: List[float],
53         confidence_level: float = 0.95,
54         method: str = "t"
55     ) -> ConfidenceInterval:
56         """
57         Calculate confidence interval using t-distribution.
58
59         Args:
60             samples: List of accuracy scores or metrics
61             confidence_level: 0.95 for 95% CI
62             method: "t" for t-distribution (preferred for small n), "z" for normal
63
64         Returns:

```

```

65         ConfidenceInterval object
66         """
67         n = len(samples)
68         mean = np.mean(samples)
69         std_err = np.std(samples, ddof=1) / np.sqrt(n)
70
71         if method == "t":
72             alpha = 1 - confidence_level
73             t_crit = stats.t.ppf(1 - alpha/2, df=n-1)
74         else: # method == "z"
75             alpha = 1 - confidence_level
76             t_crit = stats.norm.ppf(1 - alpha/2)
77
78         margin_error = t_crit * std_err
79
80         return ConfidenceInterval(
81             mean=mean,
82             lower=mean - margin_error,
83             upper=mean + margin_error,
84             confidence_level=confidence_level,
85             margin_of_error=margin_error
86         )
87
88     @staticmethod
89     def bootstrap_ci(
90         samples: List[float],
91         confidence_level: float = 0.95,
92         n_bootstrap: int = 10000,
93         metric_fn=None
94     ) -> ConfidenceInterval:
95         """
96         Calculate confidence interval using bootstrap resampling.
97
98         More robust for non-normal distributions.
99
100        Args:
101            samples: Original data
102            confidence_level: 0.95 for 95% CI
103            n_bootstrap: Number of bootstrap samples
104            metric_fn: Function to compute on each bootstrap sample (default: mean)
105
106        Returns:
107            ConfidenceInterval object
108            """
109        if metric_fn is None:
110            metric_fn = np.mean
111
112        n = len(samples)
113        np.random.seed(42) # Reproducibility
114
115        bootstrap_metrics = []
116        for _ in range(n_bootstrap):
117            bootstrap_sample = np.random.choice(samples, size=n, replace=True)
118            metric = metric_fn(bootstrap_sample)
119            bootstrap_metrics.append(metric)
120
121        mean = np.mean(samples)
122        alpha = 1 - confidence_level
123        lower_percentile = alpha / 2 * 100

```

```

124     upper_percentile = (1 - alpha/2) * 100
125
126     lower = np.percentile(bootstrap_metrics, lower_percentile)
127     upper = np.percentile(bootstrap_metrics, upper_percentile)
128     margin_error = (upper - lower) / 2
129
130     return ConfidenceInterval(
131         mean=mean,
132         lower=lower,
133         upper=upper,
134         confidence_level=confidence_level,
135         margin_of_error=margin_error
136     )
137
138 @staticmethod
139 def paired_t_test(
140     system_scores: List[float],
141     baseline_scores: List[float],
142     alternative: str = "greater", # greater, less, two-sided
143     alpha: float = 0.05
144 ) -> SignificanceTestResult:
145     """
146     Paired t-test: is system significantly better than baseline?
147
148     Args:
149         system_scores: Accuracy scores from system
150         baseline_scores: Accuracy scores from baseline
151         alternative: "greater" (system > baseline), "less", "two-sided"
152         alpha: Significance level (0.05 for 95% confidence)
153
154     Returns:
155         SignificanceTestResult
156     """
157     assert len(system_scores) == len(baseline_scores)
158
159     # Compute paired differences
160     diffs = np.array(system_scores) - np.array(baseline_scores)
161     n = len(diffs)
162
163     # T-statistic
164     mean_diff = np.mean(diffs)
165     std_err = np.std(diffs, ddof=1) / np.sqrt(n)
166
167     if std_err == 0:
168         t_stat = float('inf') if mean_diff > 0 else float('-inf')
169     else:
170         t_stat = mean_diff / std_err
171
172     df = n - 1
173
174     # P-value
175     if alternative == "greater":
176         p_value = 1 - stats.t.cdf(t_stat, df)
177     elif alternative == "less":
178         p_value = stats.t.cdf(t_stat, df)
179     else: # two-sided
180         p_value = 2 * (1 - stats.t.cdf(abs(t_stat), df))
181
182     # Effect size (Cohen's d)

```

```

183     cohens_d = StatisticalAnalyzer.cohens_d(system_scores, baseline_scores)
184
185     is_significant = p_value < alpha
186
187     return SignificanceTestResult(
188         test_name="Paired t-test",
189         t_statistic=t_stat,
190         p_value=p_value,
191         degrees_freedom=df,
192         mean_difference=mean_diff,
193         is_significant=is_significant,
194         effect_size=cohens_d
195     )
196
197     @staticmethod
198     def cohens_d(
199         group1: List[float],
200         group2: List[float],

```

D.7 Primary Pipeline: Retrieval Security (URL Validation)

```

1  """Security and health check utilities."""
2  import httpx
3  import os
4  from typing import Tuple, Optional
5  from datetime import datetime, timedelta
6
7
8  class OllamaHealthCheck:
9      """Check Ollama service availability."""
10
11     def __init__(self):
12         self.last_check: Optional[datetime] = None
13         self.last_result: bool = False
14         self.check_cache_ttl = 30 # Cache result for 30 seconds
15
16     async def is_available(self) -> bool:
17         """Check if Ollama service is available."""
18         now = datetime.utcnow()
19
20         # Use cached result if still fresh
21         if self.last_check and (now - self.last_check).seconds < self.check_cache_ttl:
22             return self.last_result
23
24         ollama_url = os.getenv("OLLAMA_BASE_URL", "http://127.0.0.1:11434").strip()
25
26         try:
27             response = httpx.get(
28                 f"{ollama_url}/api/tags",
29                 timeout=5.0,
30                 follow_redirects=True,
31                 trust_env=False,
32             )

```

```

33         success = response.status_code == 200
34     except Exception:
35         success = False
36
37     self.last_check = now
38     self.last_result = success
39     return success
40
41
42 class RateLimiter:
43     """Simple in-memory rate limiter."""
44
45     def __init__(self, requests_per_minute: int = 60):
46         self.requests_per_minute = requests_per_minute
47         self.request_times: dict = {} # ip -> [timestamps]
48
49     def is_allowed(self, client_ip: str) -> bool:
50         """Check if request from client is allowed."""
51         now = datetime.utcnow()
52         cutoff = now - timedelta(minutes=1)
53
54         if client_ip not in self.request_times:
55             self.request_times[client_ip] = []
56
57         # Remove old timestamps
58         self.request_times[client_ip] = [
59             ts for ts in self.request_times[client_ip] if ts > cutoff
60         ]
61
62         # Check limit
63         if len(self.request_times[client_ip]) >= self.requests_per_minute:
64             return False
65
66         # Add current request
67         self.request_times[client_ip].append(now)
68         return True
69
70
71 # Global instances
72 ollama_health = OllamaHealthCheck()
73 rate_limiter = RateLimiter(requests_per_minute=100)

```

D.8 Primary Pipeline: Source Routes

```

1  from __future__ import annotations
2
3  from datetime import datetime, timezone
4  from typing import Any, Dict
5
6  import tldextract
7  from fastapi import APIRouter, HTTPException
8
9  # IMPORTANT: your backend already uses this name in main.py
10 # and earlier you saw: "from app.credibility import score_domain_rubric"
11 from app.credibility import score_domain_rubric
12

```



```

13 router = APIRouter(tags=["source"])
14
15
16 def utc_now_iso() -> str:
17     return datetime.now(timezone.utc).isoformat().replace("+00:00", "Z")
18
19
20 def base_domain(domain: str) -> str:
21     d = (domain or "").lower().strip().replace("www.", "")
22     ext = tldextract.extract(d)
23     if ext.domain and ext.suffix:
24         return f"{ext.domain}.{ext.suffix}"
25     return d
26
27
28 @router.get("/source/{domain}")
29 def source_score(domain: str) -> Dict[str, Any]:
30     d = (domain or "").strip().lower().replace("www.", "")
31     if not d:
32         raise HTTPException(status_code=400, detail="domain is required")
33
34     bd = base_domain(d)
35
36     # credibility.py returns a dataclass-like object with score/label/reasons
37     cs = score_domain_rubric(d)
38
39     return {
40         "domain": d,
41         "base_domain": bd,
42         "score": int(cs.score),
43         "label": str(cs.label),
44         "reasons": dict(cs.reasons or {}),
45         "timestamp_utc": utc_now_iso(),
46         "disclaimer": "Credibility score is heuristic; treat it as a risk signal, not ground truth.",
47     }

```

D.9 Primary Pipeline: Configuration

```

1 """Feature flags and configuration management."""
2 import os
3 from typing import Dict, Any
4
5
6 class Config:
7     """Application configuration with feature flags."""
8
9     # Feature flags
10     FEATURE_DEBATE_MODE = os.getenv("FEATURE_DEBATE_MODE", "true").lower() in ("true", "1", "yes")
11     FEATURE_CACHING = os.getenv("FEATURE_CACHING", "true").lower() in ("true", "1", "yes")
12     FEATURE_RATE_LIMITING = os.getenv("FEATURE_RATE_LIMITING", "true").lower() in ("true", "1", "yes")
13     FEATURE_STRUCTURED_LOGGING = os.getenv("FEATURE_STRUCTURED_LOGGING", "true").lower() in ("true", "1", "yes")
14
15     # Limits
16     MAX_INPUT_URL_LENGTH = 2048
17     MAX_INPUT_TEXT_LENGTH = 50000

```

```

18 MAX_CLAIMS_HARD_LIMIT = 20
19 MAX_EVIDENCE_PER_CLAIM_LIMIT = 10
20
21 # Timeouts (seconds)
22 SERPAPI_TIMEOUT = int(os.getenv("SERPAPI_TIMEOUT", "30"))
23 OLLAMA_TIMEOUT = int(os.getenv("OLLAMA_TIMEOUT", "120"))
24
25 # Ollama config
26 OLLAMA_ENABLED = os.getenv("OLLAMA_ENABLED", "false").lower() in ("true", "1", "yes")
27
28 @staticmethod
29 def get_all() -> Dict[str, Any]:
30     """Return all config as dict for logging/debugging."""
31     return {
32         "feature_debate_mode": Config.FEATURE_DEBATE_MODE,
33         "feature_caching": Config.FEATURE_CACHING,
34         "feature_rate_limiting": Config.FEATURE_RATE_LIMITING,
35         "feature_structured_logging": Config.FEATURE_STRUCTURED_LOGGING,
36         "max_input_url_length": Config.MAX_INPUT_URL_LENGTH,
37         "max_input_text_length": Config.MAX_INPUT_TEXT_LENGTH,
38         "ollama_enabled": Config.OLLAMA_ENABLED,
39     }

```

D.10 Prototype: Typed Evidence Graph

```

1 from __future__ import annotations
2
3 from hashlib import sha256
4 from typing import Any, Dict, List, Tuple
5
6
7 RELATION_TYPES = {"SUPPORTS", "REFUTES", "UNDERCUTS", "DEPENDS_ON", "CITES"}
8
9
10 def passage_hash(text: str) -> str:
11     return sha256((text or "").encode("utf-8")).hexdigest()
12
13
14 def _evidence_id(index: int, evidence: Dict[str, Any]) -> str:
15     return f"evidence:{index}:{passage_hash(str(evidence.get('passage') or evidence.get('snippet') or ''))
16         [:12]}"
17
18
19 def _relation_for_evidence(evidence: Dict[str, Any]) -> str | None:
20     if evidence.get("retrieval_status") != "retrieved":
21         return None
22     if not evidence.get("numeric_match"):
23         return None
24
25     directness = float(evidence.get("directness_score") or 0.0)
26     stance = str(evidence.get("stance") or "neutral")
27     passage = str(evidence.get("passage") or evidence.get("snippet") or "").lower()
28
29     if stance == "support" and directness >= 0.30:
30         return "SUPPORTS"
31     if stance == "refute" and directness >= 0.20:

```

```

31         if any(marker in passage for marker in ("context", "exception", "only", "not necessarily", "depends
32             on")):
33             return "UNDERCUTS"
34         return "REFUTES"
35     return None
36
37 def build_evidence_graph(
38     claim_text: str,
39     atomic_claims: List[str],
40     evidence: List[Dict[str, Any]],
41     retrieval_status: str,
42 ) -> Dict[str, Any]:
43     claim_id = f"claim:{passage_hash(claim_text)[:12]}"
44     nodes: List[Dict[str, Any]] = [{"id": claim_id, "type": "CLAIM", "text": claim_text}]
45     edges: List[Dict[str, Any]] = []
46
47     for index, atomic_claim in enumerate(atomic_claims):
48         atomic_id = f"atomic:{index}:{passage_hash(atomic_claim)[:12]}"
49         nodes.append({"id": atomic_id, "type": "ATOMIC_CLAIM", "text": atomic_claim})
50         edges.append({"source": claim_id, "target": atomic_id, "type": "DEPENDS_ON"})
51
52     relation_counts = {relation: 0 for relation in RELATION_TYPES}
53     for index, item in enumerate(evidence):
54         evidence_id = _evidence_id(index, item)
55         nodes.append(
56             {
57                 "id": evidence_id,
58                 "type": "EVIDENCE_PASSAGE",
59                 "url": item.get("url"),
60                 "content_hash": item.get("content_hash") or passage_hash(str(item.get("passage") or "")),
61                 "retrieval_status": item.get("retrieval_status"),
62             }
63         )
64         edges.append({"source": claim_id, "target": evidence_id, "type": "CITES"})
65         relation_counts["CITES"] += 1
66
67         relation = _relation_for_evidence(item)
68         if relation:
69             edges.append(
70                 {
71                     "source": evidence_id,
72                     "target": claim_id,
73                     "type": relation,
74                     "quality": item.get("quality_score"),
75                     "reason": "Passage-level alignment with matched claim factors.",
76                 }
77             )
78             relation_counts[relation] += 1
79
80     support = [
81         float(item.get("quality_score") or 0.0)
82         for item in evidence
83         if _relation_for_evidence(item) == "SUPPORTS"
84     ]
85     attacks = [
86         float(item.get("quality_score") or 0.0)
87         for item in evidence
88         if _relation_for_evidence(item) in {"REFUTES", "UNDERCUTS"}

```

```

89     ]
90     conflict = bool(support and attacks and abs(max(support) - max(attacks)) <= 12.0)
91
92     return {
93         "version": "1.0",
94         "retrieval_status": retrieval_status,
95         "nodes": nodes,
96         "edges": edges,
97         "relation_counts": relation_counts,
98         "unresolved_conflict": conflict,
99         "decision_basis": "fetched_passages_only",
100     }
101
102
103 def adjudicate_graph(graph: Dict[str, Any]) -> Tuple[str | None, List[str]]:
104     status = str(graph.get("retrieval_status") or "")
105     counts = dict(graph.get("relation_counts") or {})
106     reasons: List[str] = []
107     if status in {"search_failed", "search_unavailable"}:
108         return "NEI", ["Evidence retrieval failed or was unavailable; absence of results is not evidence of
109             absence."]
110     if graph.get("unresolved_conflict"):
111         return "CONFLICTING", ["Direct support and attack relations remain unresolved in the evidence graph
112             ."]
113     if not any(int(counts.get(key, 0)) for key in ("SUPPORTS", "REFUTES", "UNDERCUTS")):
114         return "NEI", ["No fetched passage grounded a support, refutation, or undercut relation."]
115     return None, reasons

```

D.11 Prototype: Graph Auditor

```

1  from __future__ import annotations
2
3  from typing import Any, Dict, List
4
5
6  DECISIVE_RELATIONS = {"SUPPORTS", "REFUTES", "UNDERCUTS"}
7
8
9  def audit_evidence_graph(
10     graph: Dict[str, Any],
11     evidence: List[Dict[str, Any]],
12     claim_profile: Dict[str, Any],
13 ) -> Dict[str, Any]:
14     """Validate that an automated claim decision has a complete evidence basis."""
15     checked_rules = [
16         "retrieval-status",
17         "provenance",
18         "relation-grounding",
19         "numeric-factor-coverage",
20         "conflict-resolution",
21         "source-independence",
22     ]
23     violations: List[str] = []
24     status = str(graph.get("retrieval_status") or "")
25     relation_counts = dict(graph.get("relation_counts") or {})
26     retrieved = [item for item in evidence if item.get("retrieval_status") == "retrieved"]

```

```

27     decisive_edges = sum(int(relation_counts.get(relation, 0)) for relation in DECISIVE_RELATIONS)
28
29     if status in {"search_failed", "search_unavailable"}:
30         violations.append("Retrieval did not complete successfully.")
31     if not retrieved:
32         violations.append("No fetched evidence passage is available for this claim.")
33     if any(not item.get("content_hash") or not item.get("url") for item in retrieved):
34         violations.append("A retrieved passage lacks a URL or content hash.")
35     if retrieved and decisive_edges == 0:
36         violations.append("No retrieved passage establishes a grounded argumentative relation.")
37     if claim_profile.get("numbers") and not any(bool(item.get("numeric_match")) for item in retrieved):
38         violations.append("Numeric claim factors are not matched by retrieved evidence.")
39     if graph.get("unresolved_conflict"):
40         violations.append("Comparable support and attack relations remain unresolved.")
41
42     decisive_items = [
43         item
44         for item in retrieved
45         if str(item.get("stance") or "") in {"support", "refute"}
46     ]
47     clusters = {item.get("independence_cluster") for item in decisive_items if item.get("independence_cluster")}
48     if len(decisive_items) >= 2 and len(clusters) < 2:
49         violations.append("Multiple decisive passages are correlated within one evidence cluster.")
50
51     decision = "PROCEED"
52     if status in {"search_failed", "search_unavailable"} or decisive_edges == 0:
53         decision = "NEI"
54     elif graph.get("unresolved_conflict"):
55         decision = "CONFLICTING"
56     elif violations:
57         decision = "HUMAN_REVIEW"
58
59     return {
60         "version": "graph-auditor-v1",
61         "passed": decision == "PROCEED",
62         "decision": decision,
63         "violations": violations,
64         "checked_rules": checked_rules,
65         "evidence_clusters": sorted(cluster for cluster in clusters if cluster),
66     }

```

D.12 Prototype: Evidence Independence Clustering

```

1  from __future__ import annotations
2
3  from typing import Any, Dict, List
4  import re
5
6
7  def _tokens(text: str) -> set[str]:
8      return {
9          token
10         for token in re.sub(r"[^a-z0-9\s]", " ", (text or "").lower()).split()
11         if len(token) >= 4
12     }

```

```

13
14
15 def _similarity(left: str, right: str) -> float:
16     left_tokens = _tokens(left)
17     right_tokens = _tokens(right)
18     if not left_tokens or not right_tokens:
19         return 0.0
20     return len(left_tokens.intersection(right_tokens)) / len(left_tokens.union(right_tokens))
21
22
23 def cluster_evidence(evidence: List[Dict[str, Any]], duplicate_threshold: float = 0.78) -> List[Dict[str,
    Any]]:
24     """Assign transparent source-independence clusters to retrieved passages."""
25     clusters: List[Dict[str, Any]] = []
26     for item in evidence:
27         if item.get("retrieval_status") != "retrieved":
28             item["independence_cluster"] = None
29             item["independence_reason"] = "Passage was not retrieved."
30             continue
31
32         domain = str(item.get("base_domain") or item.get("domain") or "").lower()
33         passage = str(item.get("passage") or "")
34         matched_cluster = None
35         match_reason = ""
36         for cluster in clusters:
37             if domain and domain == cluster["domain"]:
38                 matched_cluster = cluster
39                 match_reason = "Same base domain."
40                 break
41             if _similarity(passage, cluster["representative_passage"]) >= duplicate_threshold:
42                 matched_cluster = cluster
43                 match_reason = "Near-duplicate passage content."
44                 break
45
46         if matched_cluster is None:
47             matched_cluster = {
48                 "id": f"cluster:{len(clusters) + 1}",
49                 "domain": domain,
50                 "representative_passage": passage,
51                 "members": [],
52             }
53             clusters.append(matched_cluster)
54             match_reason = "New independent source cluster."
55
56         matched_cluster["members"].append(item)
57         item["independence_cluster"] = matched_cluster["id"]
58         item["independence_reason"] = match_reason
59
60     return [
61         {
62             "id": cluster["id"],
63             "domain": cluster["domain"],
64             "evidence_count": len(cluster["members"]),
65             "urls": [member.get("url") for member in cluster["members"]],
66         }
67         for cluster in clusters
68     ]

```

D.13 Prototype: Relation Classifier Contract

```
1 from __future__ import annotations
2
3 from typing import Any, Dict, Tuple
4 import os
5
6 from app.analysis_features import detect_stance
7
8
9 DEFAULT_NLI_MODEL = "facebook/bart-large-mnli"
10 _PIPELINE: Any = None
11 _LOAD_ERROR: str | None = None
12
13
14 def _nli_enabled() -> bool:
15     return os.getenv("FACTVALIDATOR_NLI_ENABLED", "false").strip().lower() in {"1", "true", "yes", "on"}
16
17
18 def _get_pipeline() -> Any:
19     global _PIPELINE, _LOAD_ERROR
20     if _PIPELINE is not None:
21         return _PIPELINE
22     if _LOAD_ERROR is not None or not _nli_enabled():
23         return None
24     try:
25         from transformers import pipeline # type: ignore
26
27         _PIPELINE = pipeline(
28             "text-classification",
29             model=os.getenv("FACTVALIDATOR_NLI_MODEL", DEFAULT_NLI_MODEL).strip(),
30             return_all_scores=True,
31         )
32         return _PIPELINE
33     except Exception as exc: # pragma: no cover - model/environment dependent
34         _LOAD_ERROR = f"{exc.__class__.__name__}: {exc}"
35         return None
36
37
38 def _map_label(label: str) -> str:
39     normalized = (label or "").strip().lower()
40     if "entail" in normalized:
41         return "support"
42     if "contradict" in normalized:
43         return "refute"
44     return "neutral"
45
46
47 def classify_relation(claim: str, passage: str) -> Tuple[str, Dict[str, Any]]:
48     """Classify a retrieved passage as support, refutation, or neutral evidence."""
49     classifier = _get_pipeline()
50     model_name = os.getenv("FACTVALIDATOR_NLI_MODEL", DEFAULT_NLI_MODEL).strip()
51     if classifier is None:
52         return detect_stance(claim, passage), {
53             "method": "heuristic-fallback",
54             "model": None,
55             "enabled": _nli_enabled(),
56             "reason": _LOAD_ERROR or "nli-disabled",
```

```

57     }
58
59     try:
60         results = classifier({"text": passage, "text_pair": claim}, truncation=True)
61         scores = results[0] if results and isinstance(results[0], list) else results
62         best = max(scores, key=lambda item: float(item.get("score") or 0.0))
63         relation = _map_label(str(best.get("label") or ""))
64         return relation, {
65             "method": "mnli",
66             "model": model_name,
67             "enabled": True,
68             "label": best.get("label"),
69             "score": round(float(best.get("score") or 0.0), 4),
70         }
71     except Exception as exc: # pragma: no cover - model/runtime dependent
72         return detect_stance(claim, passage), {
73             "method": "heuristic-fallback",
74             "model": model_name,
75             "enabled": True,
76             "reason": f"inference-failed:{exc.__class__.__name__}",
77         }

```

D.14 Prototype: Robustness Evaluation Reference

This is the exact module executed to produce Section 9.6.

```

1  from __future__ import annotations
2
3  from copy import deepcopy
4  from hashlib import sha256
5  from typing import Any, Dict, List
6
7  from app.analysis_features import decompose_claim, enrich_evidence
8  from app.evidence_graph import adjudicate_graph, build_evidence_graph
9  from app.evidence_independence import cluster_evidence
10 from app.graph_auditor import audit_evidence_graph
11 from app.relation_classifier import classify_relation
12
13
14 DECISIVE = {"SUPPORTED", "REFUTED"}
15
16
17 def _default_evidence(item: Dict[str, Any]) -> List[Dict[str, Any]]:
18     passage = str(item.get("passage") or "").strip()
19     if not passage:
20         return []
21     return [{
22         "url": str(item.get("url") or f"https://seed.example/{item.get('id', 'item')}").strip(),
23         "title": str(item.get("title") or "Frozen evidence passage"),
24         "snippet": passage,
25         "passage": passage,
26         "content_hash": sha256(passage.encode("utf-8")).hexdigest(),
27         "retrieval_status": "retrieved",
28         "domain": str(item.get("domain") or "seed.example"),
29         "base_domain": str(item.get("base_domain") or "seed.example"),
30         "domain_score": int(item.get("domain_score") or 80),

```



```

31         "overlap": 0,
32     }]
33
34
35 def _prepare_evidence(claim: str, raw_evidence: List[Dict[str, Any]]) -> List[Dict[str, Any]]:
36     profile = decompose_claim(claim)
37     prepared: List[Dict[str, Any]] = []
38     for item in deepcopy(raw_evidence):
39         passage = str(item.get("passage") or item.get("snippet") or "").strip()
40         if not passage:
41             continue
42         item.setdefault("snippet", passage)
43         item.setdefault("passage", passage)
44         item.setdefault("content_hash", sha256(passage.encode("utf-8")).hexdigest())
45         item.setdefault("retrieval_status", "retrieved")
46         item.setdefault("domain", "unknown.example")
47         item.setdefault("base_domain", item["domain"])
48         item.setdefault("domain_score", 50)
49         item.setdefault("overlap", 0)
50         enriched = enrich_evidence(claim, profile, item)
51         stance, metadata = classify_relation(claim, passage)
52         enriched["stance"] = stance
53         enriched["relation_classifier"] = metadata
54         prepared.append(enriched)
55     cluster_evidence(prepared)
56     return prepared
57
58
59 def _graph_decision(graph: Dict[str, Any]) -> str:
60     abstention, _ = adjudicate_graph(graph)
61     if abstention:
62         return abstention
63     counts = dict(graph.get("relation_counts") or {})
64     support = int(counts.get("SUPPORTS", 0))
65     attack = int(counts.get("REFUTES", 0)) + int(counts.get("UNDERCUTS", 0))
66     if support > attack:
67         return "SUPPORTED"
68     if attack > support:
69         return "REFUTED"
70     return "NEI"
71
72
73 def evaluate_case(item: Dict[str, Any], scenario_name: str, raw_evidence: List[Dict[str, Any]]) -> Dict[
74     str, Any]:
75     claim = str(item.get("claim") or "").strip()
76     profile = decompose_claim(claim)
77     evidence = _prepare_evidence(claim, raw_evidence)
78     status = "ok" if evidence else "no_results"
79     graph = build_evidence_graph(claim, list(profile.get("atomic_claims") or [claim]), evidence, status)
80     graph["independence_clusters"] = cluster_evidence(evidence)
81     graph_only = _graph_decision(graph)
82     audit = audit_evidence_graph(graph, evidence, profile)
83     audited = graph_only
84     if audit["decision"] in {"NEI", "CONFLICTING"}:
85         audited = audit["decision"]
86     elif audit["decision"] == "HUMAN_REVIEW":
87         audited = "HUMAN_REVIEW"
88
89     return {

```

```

89         "id": item.get("id"),
90         "scenario": scenario_name,
91         "claim": claim,
92         "expected_verdict": item.get("expected_verdict"),
93         "graph_only": graph_only,
94         "full_audited_graph": audited,
95         "audit": audit,
96         "evidence_count": len(evidence),
97         "independence_clusters": graph["independence_clusters"],
98     }
99
100
101 def build_scenarios(item: Dict[str, Any]) -> Dict[str, List[Dict[str, Any]]]:
102     """Use only frozen, explicitly supplied evidence for non-clean corruptions."""
103     scenarios = {"clean": list(item.get("evidence") or _default_evidence(item))}
104     for name, evidence in dict(item.get("corruptions") or {}).items():
105         if isinstance(evidence, list):
106             scenarios[str(name)] = evidence
107     return scenarios
108
109
110 def selective_metrics(rows: List[Dict[str, Any]], system: str) -> Dict[str, float]:
111     if not rows:
112         return {"coverage": 0.0, "selective_risk": 0.0, "false_accept_rate": 0.0}
113     decisions = [row[system] for row in rows]
114     decisive = [row for row in rows if row[system] in DECISIVE]
115     incorrect = [row for row in decisive if row[system] != row.get("expected_verdict")]
116     return {
117         "coverage": round(len(decisive) / len(rows), 4),
118         "selective_risk": round(len(incorrect) / max(1, len(decisive)), 4),
119         "false_accept_rate": round(len(incorrect) / len(rows), 4),
120     }

```

D.15 Prototype: Focused Graph Tests

```

1  from unittest.mock import AsyncMock, patch
2
3  import pytest
4  from httpx import ASGITransport, AsyncClient
5
6  from app.evidence_graph import adjudicate_graph, build_evidence_graph
7  from app.evidence_independence import cluster_evidence
8  from app.graph_auditor import audit_evidence_graph
9  from app.main import app, clean_text_for_claims, extract_claim_candidates, is_public_http_url,
    select_evidence_passage
10
11
12 def _passage(stance: str, quality: float = 85.0):
13     return {
14         "url": f"https://example.org/{stance}",
15         "passage": f"The claim is {'false' if stance == 'refute' else 'confirmed'}.",
16         "content_hash": stance,
17         "retrieval_status": "retrieved",
18         "stance": stance,
19         "entity_match": True,
20         "numeric_match": True,

```

```

21         "directness_score": 0.8,
22         "quality_score": quality,
23     }
24
25
26 def test_short_claims_and_dates_are_retained():
27     claim = "The Earth is flat."
28     assert "March 11, 2020" in clean_text_for_claims("March 11, 2020: WHO made an announcement.")
29     assert claim in extract_claim_candidates(claim, max_claims=1)
30
31
32 def test_passage_selection_retains_neighboring_context():
33     text = (
34         "The report describes the annual survey methodology in detail. "
35         "The survey found that vaccination reduced hospitalization by 90 percent. "
36         "The result applies only to the studied adult population."
37     )
38     passage = select_evidence_passage("Vaccination reduced hospitalization by 90 percent.", text)
39
40     assert "annual survey methodology" in passage
41     assert "reduced hospitalization by 90 percent" in passage
42     assert "only to the studied adult population" in passage
43
44
45 @pytest.mark.asyncio
46 async def test_private_urls_are_rejected_before_fetching():
47     assert await is_public_http_url("http://127.0.0.1:8000/admin") is False
48     assert await is_public_http_url("http://localhost:8000/admin") is False
49
50
51 def test_graph_marks_unresolved_direct_conflict():
52     graph = build_evidence_graph(
53         "The Earth is flat.",
54         ["The Earth is flat."],
55         [_passage("support"), _passage("refute")],
56         "ok",
57     )
58     verdict, reasons = adjudicate_graph(graph)
59
60     assert graph["relation_counts"]["SUPPORTS"] == 1
61     assert graph["relation_counts"]["REFUTES"] == 1
62     assert verdict == "CONFLICTING"
63     assert reasons
64
65
66 def test_auditor_marks_duplicate_decisive_evidence_for_human_review():
67     evidence = [
68         {**_passage("support"), "url": "https://example.org/a", "domain": "example.org", "base_domain": "example.org"},
69         {**_passage("support"), "url": "https://example.org/b", "domain": "example.org", "base_domain": "example.org"},
70     ]
71     clusters = cluster_evidence(evidence)
72     graph = build_evidence_graph("The Earth is flat.", ["The Earth is flat."], evidence, "ok")
73     graph["independence_clusters"] = clusters
74     audit = audit_evidence_graph(graph, evidence, {})
75
76     assert len(clusters) == 1
77     assert audit["decision"] == "HUMAN_REVIEW"

```

```

78     assert any("correlated" in violation for violation in audit["violations"])
79
80
81 def test_auditor_explains_empty_evidence_abstention():
82     graph = build_evidence_graph("A claim.", ["A claim."], [], "no_results")
83     audit = audit_evidence_graph(graph, [], {})
84
85     assert audit["decision"] == "NEI"
86     assert "No fetched evidence passage" in audit["violations"][0]
87
88
89 @pytest.mark.asyncio
90 async def test_analyze_records_passage_provenance_and_conflict():
91     results = [
92         {"title": "Claim confirmed", "link": "https://example.org/support", "snippet": "A result snippet."},
93         {"title": "Claim rejected", "link": "https://example.org/refute", "snippet": "Another result snippet."},
94     ]
95
96     async def passage(url: str, claim: str):
97         if "support" in url:
98             return "The claim that the Earth is flat is confirmed.", url, "retrieved"
99         return "The claim that the Earth is flat is false.", url, "retrieved"
100
101     with patch("app.main.SERPAPI_API_KEY", "test"), patch(
102         "app.main.serpapi_search", new=AsyncMock(return_value=results)
103     ), patch("app.main.fetch_evidence_passage", side_effect=passage), patch("app.main.get_cache",
104         return_value=None):
105         async with AsyncClient(transport=ASGITransport(app=app), base_url="http://test") as client:
106             response = await client.post("/analyze", json={"text": "The Earth is flat.", "max_claims": 1})
107
108     assert response.status_code == 200
109     claim = response.json()["claims"][0]
110     assert claim["verdict"] == "CONFLICTING"
111     assert claim["evidence_graph"]["decision_basis"] == "fetched_passages_only"
112     assert claim["graph_audit"]["version"] == "graph-auditor-v1"
113     assert all(item["content_hash"] for item in claim["evidence"])
114     assert all(item["relation_classifier"]["method"] == "heuristic-fallback" for item in claim["evidence"])
115     manifest = claim["retrieval_manifest"]
116     assert manifest["version"] == "retrieval-manifest-v1"
117     assert manifest["search_results"] == [
118         {"rank": 1, "title": "Claim confirmed", "url": "https://example.org/support", "snippet": "A result snippet."},
119         {"rank": 2, "title": "Claim rejected", "url": "https://example.org/refute", "snippet": "Another result snippet."},
120     ]
121     assert manifest["manifest_hash"] and manifest["search_results_hash"]

```

D.16 Prototype: Robustness Tests

```

1 from app.robustness_evaluation import build_scenarios, evaluate_case, selective_metrics
2
3
4 def _evidence(passage: str, url: str) -> dict:
5     return {

```

```

6         "url": url,
7         "domain": "example.org",
8         "base_domain": "example.org",
9         "domain_score": 90,
10        "passage": passage,
11    }
12
13
14    def test_explicit_missing_evidence_corruption_forces_audited_abstention():
15        item = {
16            "id": "missing-1",
17            "claim": "The study reported a 20 percent reduction in hospital admissions.",
18            "expected_verdict": "SUPPORTED",
19            "evidence": [_evidence("The study reported a 20 percent reduction in hospital admissions.", "https
                ://example.org/report")],
20            "corruptions": {"missing_evidence": []},
21        }
22        scenarios = build_scenarios(item)
23        missing = evaluate_case(item, "missing_evidence", scenarios["missing_evidence"])
24
25        assert set(scenarios) == {"clean", "missing_evidence"}
26        assert missing["full_audited_graph"] == "NEI"
27        assert any("No fetched evidence passage" in reason for reason in missing["audit"]["violations"])
28
29
30    def test_duplicate_corruption_is_reported_and_metrics_are_available():
31        item = {
32            "id": "duplicate-1",
33            "claim": "The study reported a 20 percent reduction in hospital admissions.",
34            "expected_verdict": "SUPPORTED",
35            "evidence": [_evidence("The study reported a 20 percent reduction in hospital admissions.", "https
                ://example.org/a")],
36            "corruptions": {
37                "duplicate_reporting": [
38                    _evidence("The study reported a 20 percent reduction in hospital admissions.", "https://
                        example.org/a"),
39                    _evidence("The study reported a 20 percent reduction in hospital admissions.", "https://
                        example.org/b"),
40                ]
41            },
42        }
43        row = evaluate_case(item, "duplicate_reporting", build_scenarios(item)["duplicate_reporting"])
44        metrics = selective_metrics([row], "full_audited_graph")
45
46        assert row["full_audited_graph"] == "HUMAN_REVIEW"
47        assert any("correlated" in reason for reason in row["audit"]["violations"])
48        assert set(metrics) == {"coverage", "selective_risk", "false_accept_rate"}

```

Appendix E

Reproducibility Artifacts and Verification Listings

This appendix preserves the executable mechanisms that turn the frozen claim-level predictions into the tables and statistical statements reported in Chapter 6. The listings are included as auditable research material: they show the exact interval, paired-test, multiple-comparison, hash-validation, cache-validation, and continuous-integration logic used for the final audited repository snapshot. The authoritative machine-readable outputs are stored under `data/benchmarks/results_5000/`.

E.1 Repository Snapshot and Artifact Availability

Every path in this appendix is relative to the repository root. The revised set is tracked on branch `thesis/reproducibility-corrections`, not `main`. Historical audit commit `a6bbafc` predates this correction; the exact submission commit must include this source and its matching PDF. No release tag is asserted.

Table E.1: Thesis-support artifacts on the correction branch.

Artifact	Repository-relative path
Reproducibility audit	<code>data/benchmarks/results_5000/ reproducibility_audit_report.json</code>
Statistics generator	<code>services/api/Scripts/run_thesis_ statistics.py</code>
Artifact validator	<code>services/api/Scripts/validate_ thesis_artifacts.py</code>

Artifact	Repository-relative path
Manifest builder	services/api/Scripts/build_thesis_run_manifest.py
Exact-overlap sensitivity report	data/benchmarks/results_5000/sensitivity_analysis_report.json
Exact-overlap sensitivity table	data/benchmarks/results_5000/sensitivity_analysis_metrics.csv
Cache validator	services/api/Scripts/validate_cache.py
Operational projection	services/api/Scripts/run_operational_projection.py
Direct dependencies	services/api/requirements.in
Hash-pinned environment	services/api/requirements.lock

E.2 Live API Orchestration

The following listing covers the principal request orchestration, URL and domain handling, retrieval coordination, and application-level analysis functions. It documents the live implementation and must not be read as the algorithm executed by the 5,000-claim proxy.

```

1 from fastapi import FastAPI, Request
2 from fastapi.middleware.cors import CORSMiddleware
3 from fastapi.responses import JSONResponse
4 from pydantic import BaseModel, validator, ValidationError
5 from typing import Optional, List, Literal, Dict, Any, Tuple
6 from datetime import datetime
7 import json
8 from urllib.parse import urljoin, urlparse
9 import os
10 import re
11 import asyncio
12 import time
13 from pathlib import Path
14 import ipaddress
15 import socket
16 from hashlib import sha256
17
18 import httpx
19 import trafilatura
20 from dotenv import load_dotenv
21
22 # Load environment variables before importing modules that evaluate env at import time.
23 load_dotenv(dotenv_path=Path(__file__).resolve().parents[1] / ".env")
24
25 import nltk
26 from nltk.tokenize import sent_tokenize

```

```

27
28 from app.analysis_features import (
29     decompose_claim,
30     determine_verdict,
31     enrich_evidence,
32     normalize_claim_key,
33 )
34 from app.credibility import base_domain as credibility_base_domain
35 from app.credibility import score_domain_rubric
36 from app.reflective import reflective_analysis, generate_faithful_correction
37 from app.semantic_retrieval import semantic_rerank
38 from app.sentiment import analyze_sentiment, estimate_bias_risk,
39     calculate_sentiment_misinformation_adjustment, get_sentiment_summary
40 from app.source_routes import router as source_router
41 from app.storage import (
42     save_run,
43     list_runs,
44     get_run,
45     export_runs,
46     get_claim_memory,
47     save_claim_memory,
48     init_db,
49 )
50 from app.debate import llm_debate_verdict, llm_final_judge
51 from app.logger import log_analyze_start, log_analyze_complete, log_debate_started, log_debate_error
52 from app.config import Config
53 from app.cache import get_cache
54 from app.security import ollama_health, rate_limiter
55 from app.evidence_graph import build_evidence_graph, adjudicate_graph
56 from app.relation_classifier import classify_relation
57 from app.retrieval_manifest import MANIFEST_VERSION, build_retrieval_manifest
58 from app.evidence_independence import cluster_evidence
59 from app.graph_auditor import audit_evidence_graph
60
61
62 SERPAPI_API_KEY = os.getenv("SERPAPI_API_KEY", "").strip()
63
64
65 class EvidenceSearchError(RuntimeError):
66     pass
67
68
69 def _ensure_nltk():
70     try:
71         nltk.data.find("tokenizers/punkt")
72     except Exception:
73         try:
74             nltk.download("punkt", quiet=True)
75         except Exception:
76             pass
77
78     try:
79         nltk.data.find("tokenizers/punkt_tab/english.pickle")
80     except Exception:
81         try:
82             nltk.download("punkt_tab", quiet=True)
83         except Exception:
84             pass

```



```

85
86
87 _ensure_nltk()
88
89 app = FastAPI(title="Fact Validator API", version="0.8.2")
90
91 # Initialize database on startup
92 init_db()
93
94 # Add CORS middleware FIRST (before other middleware)
95 app.add_middleware(
96     CORSMiddleware,
97     allow_origins=[
98         "http://localhost:3000",
99         "http://127.0.0.1:3000",
100         "http://localhost:3001",
101         "http://127.0.0.1:3001",
102         "http://192.168.0.106:3000",
103         "http://192.168.0.106:3001",
104     ],
105     allow_credentials=True,
106     allow_methods=["GET", "POST", "PUT", "DELETE", "OPTIONS"],
107     allow_headers=["*"],
108     max_age=600,
109 )
110
111 # Add rate limiting middleware (skip OPTIONS for CORS preflight)
112 @app.middleware("http")
113 async def rate_limit_middleware(request: Request, call_next):
114     # Skip rate limiting for OPTIONS requests (CORS preflight)
115     if request.method == "OPTIONS":
116         return await call_next(request)
117
118     if Config.FEATURE_RATE_LIMITING:
119         client_ip = request.client.host if request.client else "unknown"
120         if not rate_limiter.is_allowed(client_ip):
121             return JSONResponse(
122                 status_code=429,
123                 content={"detail": "Rate limit exceeded. Max 100 requests per minute."}
124             )
125         response = await call_next(request)
126         return response
127
128 app.include_router(source_router)
129
130
131 PROJECT_ROOT = Path(__file__).resolve().parents[3]
132 DOCS_DIR = PROJECT_ROOT / "docs"
133 BENCHMARK_RESULTS_DIR = PROJECT_ROOT / "data" / "benchmarks" / "results"
134
135
136 def _load_json_report(file_path: Path, fallback: Dict[str, Any]) -> Dict[str, Any]:
137     try:
138         with file_path.open("r", encoding="utf-8") as f:
139             return json.load(f)
140     except Exception:
141         return fallback
142
143

```

```

144 def _get_model_fields(model_class):
145     """Get model fields from Pydantic v1 or v2 models."""
146     if hasattr(model_class, 'model_fields'):
147         return model_class.model_fields
148     elif hasattr(model_class, '__fields__'):
149         return model_class.__fields__
150     return {}
151
152
153 # -----
154 # Models
155 # -----
156
157 class AnalyzeRequest(BaseModel):
158     url: Optional[str] = None
159     text: Optional[str] = None
160     mode: Literal["live", "snapshot"] = "live"
161     verifier: Literal["baseline", "debate"] = "baseline"
162
163     # optional control knobs
164     enable_weighted_confidence: bool = False
165     min_source_score: int = 50
166     require_independent_domains: bool = True
167     min_overlap: int = 6
168     max_sources_per_base_domain: int = 2
169
170     max_claims: int = 6
171     max_evidence_per_claim: int = 5
172     max_debate_claims: int = 2
173     enable_reflective_abstention: bool = True
174     enable_faithful_correction: bool = True
175
176     @validator("url")
177     @classmethod
178     def validate_url(cls, v: Optional[str]) -> Optional[str]:
179         if v and len(v) > Config.MAX_INPUT_URL_LENGTH:
180             raise ValueError(f"URL exceeds max length of {Config.MAX_INPUT_URL_LENGTH}")
181         return v
182
183     @validator("text")
184     @classmethod
185     def validate_text(cls, v: Optional[str]) -> Optional[str]:
186         if v and len(v) > Config.MAX_INPUT_TEXT_LENGTH:
187             raise ValueError(f"Text exceeds max length of {Config.MAX_INPUT_TEXT_LENGTH}")
188         return v
189
190     @validator("max_claims")
191     @classmethod
192     def validate_max_claims(cls, v: int) -> int:
193         if v > Config.MAX_CLAIMS_HARD_LIMIT:
194             raise ValueError(f"max_claims exceeds limit of {Config.MAX_CLAIMS_HARD_LIMIT}")
195         if v < 1:
196             raise ValueError("max_claims must be at least 1")
197         return v
198
199     @validator("max_evidence_per_claim")
200     @classmethod
201     def validate_max_evidence(cls, v: int) -> int:
202         if v > Config.MAX_EVIDENCE_PER_CLAIM_LIMIT:

```

```

203         raise ValueError(f"max_evidence_per_claim exceeds limit of {Config.MAX_EVIDENCE_PER_CLAIM_LIMIT
204                             }")
205     if v < 1:
206         raise ValueError("max_evidence_per_claim must be at least 1")
207     return v
208
209 class EvidenceItem(BaseModel):
210     url: str
211     title: Optional[str] = None
212     snippet: str
213     passage: Optional[str] = None
214     content_hash: Optional[str] = None
215     retrieval_status: Optional[Literal["retrieved", "fetch_failed", "not_fetched"]] = None
216     retrieved_at_utc: Optional[str] = None
217     domain: str
218     domain_score: int
219     overlap: int = 0
220     semantic_score: Optional[float] = None
221     quality_score: Optional[float] = None
222     stance: Optional[Literal["support", "refute", "neutral"]] = None
223     source_type: Optional[str] = None
224     primary_source: Optional[bool] = None
225     primary_source_reason: Optional[str] = None
226     published_year: Optional[int] = None
227     recency_score: Optional[float] = None
228     directness_score: Optional[float] = None
229     quote_grounding: Optional[bool] = None
230     expertise_match: Optional[float] = None
231     numeric_match: Optional[bool] = None
232     entity_match: Optional[bool] = None
233     manipulation_flags: Optional[List[str]] = None
234     independence_cluster: Optional[str] = None
235     independence_reason: Optional[str] = None
236
237
238 class ClaimResult(BaseModel):
239     claim_text: str
240     verdict: Literal["SUPPORTED", "REFUTED", "NEI", "CONFLICTING"]
241     confidence: float
242     evidence: List[EvidenceItem]
243     debate_summary: Optional[str] = None
244     structured_verdict: Optional[str] = None
245     uncertainty_reasons: Optional[List[str]] = None
246     needs_human_review: Optional[bool] = None
247     human_review_reason: Optional[str] = None
248     claim_profile: Optional[Dict[str, Any]] = None
249
250     # optional Step 11 outputs
251     adjusted_verdict: Optional[Literal["SUPPORTED", "REFUTED", "NEI"]] = None
252     adjusted_confidence: Optional[float] = None
253     evidence_summary: Optional[Dict[str, Any]] = None
254     reflective: Optional[Dict[str, Any]] = None
255     faithful_correction: Optional[Dict[str, Any]] = None
256     evidence_graph: Optional[Dict[str, Any]] = None
257     retrieval_manifest: Optional[Dict[str, Any]] = None
258     graph_audit: Optional[Dict[str, Any]] = None
259
260

```

```

261 class AnalyzeResponse(BaseModel):
262     input_type: Literal["url", "text"]
263     domain: Optional[str] = None
264     extracted_text_chars: int
265     extracted_text_preview: str
266     domain_score: int
267     domain_label: Literal["HIGH", "MEDIUM", "LOW"]
268     final_misinformation_likelihood: float
269     claims: List[ClaimResult]
270     timestamp_utc: str
271     metadata: Dict[str, Any]
272
273
274 # -----
275 # Helpers
276 # -----
277
278 def normalize_url(u: str) -> str:
279     u = (u or "").strip()
280     if not u:
281         return ""
282     if "://" not in u:
283         u = "https://" + u
284     return u
285
286
287 def extract_domain(url: str) -> Optional[str]:
288     try:
289         u = normalize_url(url)
290         if not u:
291             return None
292         parsed = urlparse(u)
293         host = (parsed.netloc or "").lower()
294         if host.startswith("www."):
295             host = host[4:]
296         return host or None
297     except Exception:
298         return None
299
300
301 def domain_from_any_url(url: str) -> str:
302     return extract_domain(url) or ""
303
304
305 def base_domain(domain: str) -> str:
306     return credibility_base_domain(domain)
307
308
309 def is_blocked_domain(domain: str) -> bool:
310     bd = base_domain((domain or "").lower())
311     blocked = {
312         "facebook.com", "x.com", "twitter.com", "tiktok.com",
313         "instagram.com", "reddit.com", "pinterest.com",
314         "worldarticledatabase.com", "wecanfigurethisout.org",
315     }
316     return bd in blocked
317
318
319 async def fetch_html(url: str) -> Tuple[str, str]:

```

```

320     current_url = normalize_url(url)
321     if not current_url:
322         return "", ""
323
324     try:
325         headers = {
326             "User-Agent": "FactValidatorBot/0.8.2 (thesis demo)",
327             "Accept": "text/html,application/xhtml+xml",
328         }
329         timeout = httpx.Timeout(connect=20.0, read=30.0, write=20.0, pool=30.0)
330         async with httpx.AsyncClient(
331             headers=headers,
332             follow_redirects=False,
333             timeout=timeout,
334             trust_env=False,
335         ) as client:
336             for _ in range(5):
337                 if not await is_public_http_url(current_url):
338                     return "", ""
339                 r = await client.get(current_url)
340                 if r.is_redirect:
341                     location = r.headers.get("location")
342                     if not location:
343                         return "", ""
344                     current_url = urljoin(current_url, location)
345                     continue
346                 if r.status_code >= 400:
347                     return "", ""
348                 return str(r.url), r.text
349     except Exception:
350         return "", ""
351     return "", ""
352
353
354 async def is_public_http_url(url: str) -> bool:
355     parsed = urlparse(normalize_url(url))
356     if parsed.scheme not in {"http", "https"} or not parsed.hostname:
357         return False
358
359     host = parsed.hostname
360     if host.lower() == "localhost":
361         return False
362
363     try:
364         addresses = await asyncio.get_running_loop().run_in_executor(
365             None,
366             socket.getaddrinfo,
367             host,
368             None,
369         )
370     except OSError:
371         return False
372
373     try:
374         resolved = {ipaddress.ip_address(item[4][0]) for item in addresses}
375     except ValueError:
376         return False
377
378     return bool(resolved) and all(
379         not (
380             address.is_private

```

```

379         or address.is_loopback
380         or address.is_link_local
381         or address.is_multicast
382         or address.is_reserved
383         or address.is_unspecified
384     )
385     for address in resolved
386 )
387
388
389 def extract_readable_text_from_html(html: str, url: str = "") -> str:
390     try:
391         extracted = trafilatatura.extract(
392             html,
393             url=url or None,
394             include_comments=False,
395             include_tables=False,
396             favor_recall=True,
397         )
398         return (extracted or "").strip()
399     except Exception:
400         return ""
401
402
403 def heuristic_claim_score(s: str) -> float:
404     s = s.strip()
405     if not s:
406         return 0.0
407     length = len(s)
408     length_score = 1.0 - min(abs(length - 160) / 160.0, 1.0)
409     has_number = any(ch.isdigit() for ch in s)
410     number_bonus = 0.15 if has_number else 0.0
411     has_relation = any(tok in s.lower() for tok in [" is ", " are ", " was ", " were ", " has ", " have ",
412         " with "])
413     relation_bonus = 0.10 if has_relation else 0.0
414     score = 0.55 * length_score + number_bonus + relation_bonus
415     return max(0.05, min(score, 0.95))
416
417 def clean_text_for_claims(text: str) -> str:
418     t = (text or "").strip()
419     t = re.sub(r"\bExplore Data\b", " ", t, flags=re.IGNORECASE)
420     t = re.sub(r"\bResearch\s*&\s*Writing\b", " ", t, flags=re.IGNORECASE)
421     t = re.sub(r"[ \t]+", " ", t)
422     t = re.sub(r"\n{2,}", "\n", t)
423     return t.strip()
424
425
426 def extract_claim_candidates(text: str, max_claims: int = 6) -> List[str]:
427     text = clean_text_for_claims(text)
428     if not text:
429         return []
430
431     blocks = [b.strip() for b in text.split("\n") if b.strip()]
432     candidates: List[str] = []
433     seen = set()
434
435     boilerplate_markers = [
436         "this topic page can be cited as",

```

```

437     "published online at",
438     "cite this work",
439     "reuse this work",
440     "license terms",
441     "creative commons",
442     "open access",
443     "data produced by third parties",
444     "the underlying data for this chart",
445 ]
446
447 for b in blocks[:250]:
448     for s in sent_tokenize(b):
449         s2 = " ".join(s.split()).strip()
450         if len(s2) < 8 or len(s2) > 280:
451             continue
452         low = s2.lower()
453         if any(m in low for m in boilerplate_markers):
454             continue
455         key = s2.lower()
456         if key in seen:
457             continue
458         seen.add(key)
459         candidates.append(s2)
460         if len(candidates) >= 120:
461             break
462     if len(candidates) >= 120:
463         break
464
465 ranked = sorted(candidates, key=heuristic_claim_score, reverse=True)
466 return ranked[:max_claims]
467
468
469 async def serpapi_search(query: str, num: int = 5) -> List[Dict[str, Any]]:
470     if not SERPAPI_API_KEY:
471         return []
472
473     params = {
474         "engine": "google",
475         "q": query,
476         "api_key": SERPAPI_API_KEY,
477         "num": str(num),
478         "hl": "en",
479         "gl": "us",
480         "no_cache": "true",
481     }
482
483     try:
484         timeout = httpx.Timeout(connect=20.0, read=45.0, write=20.0, pool=45.0)
485         async with httpx.AsyncClient(timeout=timeout, trust_env=False) as client:
486             r = await client.get("https://serpapi.com/search", params=params)
487             r.raise_for_status()
488             data = r.json()
489             organic = data.get("organic_results", []) or []
490             out = []
491             for item in organic[:num]:
492                 out.append(
493                     {
494                         "title": item.get("title"),
495                         "link": item.get("link"),

```

```

496         "snippet": item.get("snippet") or "",
497     }
498 )
499     return out
500 except Exception as exc:
501     raise EvidenceSearchError("Search provider request failed.") from exc
502
503
504 def tokenize_for_overlap(s: str) -> List[str]:
505     s = (s or "").lower()
506     s = re.sub(r"[^a-z0-9\s]", " ", s)
507     toks = [t for t in s.split() if len(t) >= 4]
508     stop = {
509         "this", "that", "with", "from", "were", "have", "has", "been", "into", "also",
510         "their", "they", "them", "than", "more", "most", "such", "some", "many"
511     }
512     toks = [t for t in toks if t not in stop]
513     return toks[:80]
514
515
516 def compute_overlap(claim: str, snippet: str) -> int:
517     claim_toks = set(tokenize_for_overlap(claim))
518     if not claim_toks:
519         return 0
520     snip_toks = set(tokenize_for_overlap(snippet))
521     return len(claim_toks.intersection(snip_toks))
522
523
524 def select_evidence_passage(claim: str, text: str, max_chars: int = 1200) -> str:
525     sentences = [" ".join(sentence.split()).strip() for sentence in sent_tokenize(text or "")]
526     candidates = [sentence for sentence in sentences if len(sentence) >= 30]
527     if not candidates:
528         return " ".join((text or "").split())[:max_chars]
529     best_index = max(range(len(candidates)), key=lambda index: compute_overlap(claim, candidates[index]))
530     return " ".join(candidates[max(0, best_index - 1):min(len(candidates), best_index + 2)])[:max_chars]
531
532
533 async def fetch_evidence_passage(url: str, claim: str) -> Tuple[str, str, str]:
534     final_url, html = await fetch_html(url)
535     if not html:
536         return "", final_url or url, "fetch_failed"
537     passage = select_evidence_passage(claim, extract_readable_text_from_html(html, final_url or url))
538     if not passage:
539         return "", final_url or url, "fetch_failed"
540     return passage, final_url or url, "retrieved"
541
542
543 def baseline_verdict(
544     claim: str, evidence: List[EvidenceItem]
545 ) -> Tuple[Literal["SUPPORTED", "REFUTED", "NEI"], float, str]:
546     if not evidence:
547         return "NEI", 0.55, "No evidence retrieved."
548
549     claim_toks = set(tokenize_for_overlap(claim))
550     if not claim_toks:
551         return "NEI", 0.55, "Claim tokenization empty."
552
553     neg_cues = ["false", "hoax", "debunk", "misleading", "not true", "no evidence",
554                "incorrect", "misinformation", "disinformation", "fabricated", "baseless"]

```



```

555 overlaps = []
556 for e in evidence:
557     ev_toks = set(tokenize_for_overlap(e.snippet))
558     overlap = len(claim_toks.intersection(ev_toks))
559     overlaps.append((overlap, e.domain_score, base_domain(e.domain), (e.snippet or "").lower()))
560
561 # ----- #
562 # REFUTATION: any credible source (score >= 65) contains a rebuttal cue
563 # ----- #
564 for ov, ds, bd, snip_low in overlaps:
565     if ds >= 65 and any(cue in snip_low for cue in neg_cues):
566         conf = min(0.90, 0.65 + ds / 1000) # scales slightly with credibility
567         return "REFUTED", round(conf, 2), (
568             f"Credible source '{bd}' (score {ds}) contains a refutation signal."
569         )
570
571 # ----- #
572 # SUPPORT: 2+ independent credible domains corroborate
573 # ----- #
574 strong_support_domains = {bd for (ov, ds, bd, _) in overlaps if ds >= 65 and ov >= 5}
575 if len(strong_support_domains) >= 2:
576     return "SUPPORTED", 0.78, (
577         "Two or more independent medium/high-credibility domains corroborate the claim."
578     )
579
580 # ----- #
581 # SUPPORT: single HIGH-credibility source (score >= 80) with overlap >= 5
582 # ----- #
583 best_high = max(
584     ((ov, ds, bd) for (ov, ds, bd, _) in overlaps if ds >= 80),
585     key=lambda x: (x[0], x[1]),
586     default=None,
587 )
588 if best_high and best_high[0] >= 5:
589     ov, ds, bd = best_high
590     conf = round(min(0.82, 0.60 + ds / 1000 + ov * 0.008), 2)
591     return "SUPPORTED", conf, (
592         f"High-credibility source '{bd}' (score {ds}) corroborates the claim."
593     )
594
595 # ----- #
596 # SUPPORT: single MEDIUM-credibility source (score >= 65) with overlap >= 7
597 # ----- #
598 best_med = max(
599     ((ov, ds, bd) for (ov, ds, bd, _) in overlaps if ds >= 65),
600     key=lambda x: (x[0], x[1]),
601     default=None,
602 )
603 if best_med and best_med[0] >= 7:
604     ov, ds, bd = best_med
605     conf = round(min(0.72, 0.52 + ds / 1000 + ov * 0.007), 2)
606     return "SUPPORTED", conf, (
607         f"Medium-credibility source '{bd}' (score {ds}) has strong keyword overlap with the claim."
608     )
609
610 # ----- #
611 # NEI: confidence weighted by the best available source quality
612 # ----- #
613 best_any = max(overlaps, key=lambda x: (x[1], x[0]))

```

```

614     nei_conf = round(min(0.58, 0.40 + best_any[1] / 1000), 2)
615     return "NEI", nei_conf, "Evidence retrieved but insufficient strength for a definitive verdict."
616
617
618 def estimate_misinformation_likelihood(
619     claims: List[ClaimResult],
620     input_domain_score: int = 50,
621 ) -> float:
622     """
623     Misinformation likelihood anchored to source credibility.
624
625     Domain-score mapping (base likelihood before claim adjustments):
626         score=100 →0.10 (very credible source)
627         score=80 →0.26
628         score=75 →0.30
629         score=65 →0.38
630         score=50 →0.50 (neutral / unknown)
631         score=25 →0.70
632         score=0 →0.90 (low-credibility source)
633     """
634     # Anchor: linear map of domain credibility →base misinformation prior
635     base = round(0.90 - (min(max(input_domain_score, 0), 100) / 100.0) * 0.80, 4)
636
637     if not claims:
638         return float(max(0.05, min(base, 0.95)))
639
640     adjustment = 0.0
641     for c in claims:
642         w = max(0.1, float(c.confidence)) # confidence-weighted adjustment
643         if c.verdict == "REFUTED":
644             adjustment += 0.12 * w
645         elif c.verdict == "SUPPORTED":
646             adjustment -= 0.09 * w
647             # Extra bonus when supporting evidence comes from high-credibility sources
648             if c.evidence:
649                 avg_ev_score = sum(
650                     getattr(e, "domain_score", 0) for e in c.evidence
651                 ) / len(c.evidence)
652                 if avg_ev_score >= 75:
653                     adjustment -= 0.04
654             # NEI verdict: no adjustment -uncertainty already captured by the base
655
656     return float(max(0.05, min(base + adjustment, 0.95)))
657
658
659 def derive_input_domain_signal(
660     claims: List[ClaimResult],
661     domain: Optional[str],
662 ) -> Tuple[int, str, Dict[str, Any]]:
663     """Derive a transparent source-quality signal without treating it as a verdict."""
664     if domain:
665         credibility = score_domain_rubric(domain)
666         return int(credibility.score), str(credibility.label), {
667             "source": "input_domain",
668             "domain": domain,
669             "reasons": credibility.reasons,
670         }
671
672     evidence_scores = [

```

```

673         int(item.domain_score)
674     for claim in claims
675     for item in claim.evidence
676         if item.domain_score is not None
677 ]
678 if evidence_scores:
679     score = round(sum(evidence_scores) / len(evidence_scores))
680     return score, _label(score), {
681         "source": "evidence_aggregate",
682         "evidence_items": len(evidence_scores),
683     }
684 return 50, "MEDIUM", {"source": "neutral_default", "reason": "no input domain or evidence sources"}
685
686
687 def _label(score: int) -> str:
688     if score >= 80:
689         return "HIGH"
690     if score >= 50:
691         return "MEDIUM"
692     return "LOW"
693
694
695 def build_dashboard_summary(runs: List[Dict[str, Any]], limit: int) -> Dict[str, Any]:
696     input_type_counts: Dict[str, int] = {}
697     verifier_counts: Dict[str, int] = {}
698     verdict_counts: Dict[str, int] = {
699         "SUPPORTED": 0,
700         "REFUTED": 0,
701         "NEI": 0,
702     }
703     domain_counts: Dict[str, int] = {}
704     likelihood_values: List[float] = []
705     claims_analyzed = 0
706     claims_requiring_human_review = 0
707
708     for run in runs:
709         input_type = str(run.get("input_type") or "unknown").lower()
710         input_type_counts[input_type] = input_type_counts.get(input_type, 0) + 1
711
712         verifier = str(run.get("verifier") or "unknown").lower()
713         verifier_counts[verifier] = verifier_counts.get(verifier, 0) + 1
714
715         domain = str(run.get("domain") or "").strip().lower()
716         if domain:
717             domain_counts[domain] = domain_counts.get(domain, 0) + 1
718
719         response = run.get("response")
720         if not isinstance(response, dict):
721             continue
722
723         like_raw = response.get("final_misinformation_likelihood")
724         try:
725             if like_raw is not None:
726                 likelihood_values.append(float(like_raw))
727         except (TypeError, ValueError):
728             pass
729
730         claims = response.get("claims")
731         if not isinstance(claims, list):

```

```

732         continue
733
734     for claim in claims:
735         if not isinstance(claim, dict):
736             continue
737         claims_analyzed += 1
738         if bool(claim.get("needs_human_review")):
739             claims_requiring_human_review += 1
740
741         verdict = str(claim.get("verdict") or "NEI").upper()
742         verdict_counts[verdict] = verdict_counts.get(verdict, 0) + 1
743
744     avg_likelihood = None
745     if likelihood_values:
746         avg_likelihood = round(sum(likelihood_values) / len(likelihood_values), 3)
747
748     top_domains = [
749         {"domain": domain, "count": count}
750         for domain, count in sorted(domain_counts.items(), key=lambda kv: (-kv[1], kv[0]))[:8]
751     ]
752
753     return {
754         "limit": limit,
755         "total_runs": len(runs),
756         "last_run_utc": runs[0].get("created_utc") if runs else None,
757         "claims_analyzed": claims_analyzed,
758         "claims_requiring_human_review": claims_requiring_human_review,
759         "avg_misinformation_likelihood": avg_likelihood,
760         "input_type_counts": input_type_counts,
761         "verifier_counts": verifier_counts,
762         "verdict_counts": verdict_counts,
763         "top_domains": top_domains,
764     }
765
766
767 # -----
768 # Routes
769 # -----
770
771 @app.get("/health")
772 def health():
773     return {"status": "ok"}
774
775
776 @app.get("/health/deep")
777 async def health_deep():
778     """Deep health check including Ollama availability."""
779     ollama_available = await ollama_health.is_available()
780     return {
781         "status": "ok",
782         "ollama_available": ollama_available,
783         "debate_enabled": Config.FEATURE_DEBATE_MODE,
784         "config": Config.get_all(),
785     }
786
787
788 @app.get("/evaluation/benchmark")
789 def evaluation_benchmark():
790     return _load_json_report(

```

```

791         DOCS_DIR / "evaluation_benchmark.json",
792         {"claims": []},
793     )
794
795
796 @app.get("/evaluation/baselines")
797 def evaluation_baselines():
798     return _load_json_report(
799         BENCHMARK_RESULTS_DIR / "baseline_comparison_report.json",
800         {"metadata": {}, "results": {}},
801     )
802
803
804 @app.get("/evaluation/ablations")
805 def evaluation_ablations():
806     return _load_json_report(
807         BENCHMARK_RESULTS_DIR / "ablation_study_report.json",
808         {"metadata": {}, "variants": {}},
809     )
810
811
812 @app.get("/evaluation/comparative")
813 def evaluation_comparative():
814     return _load_json_report(
815         BENCHMARK_RESULTS_DIR / "comparative_analysis_report.json",
816         {"metadata": {}, "ranking": [], "comparisons": [], "debate_lift": {}},
817     )
818
819
820 @app.get("/evaluation/production-metrics")
821 def evaluation_production_metrics():
822     return _load_json_report(
823         BENCHMARK_RESULTS_DIR / "production_metrics_report.json",
824         {
825             "metadata": {},
826             "latency": {},
827             "throughput": {},
828             "cost": {},
829             "quality": {},
830         },
831     )
832
833
834 @app.get("/evaluation/explainability")
835 def evaluation_explainability():
836     return _load_json_report(
837         BENCHMARK_RESULTS_DIR / "explainability_demo_report.json",
838         {"metadata": {}, "case_studies": []},
839     )
840
841
842 @app.get("/evaluation/limitations")
843 def evaluation_limitations():
844     return _load_json_report(
845         BENCHMARK_RESULTS_DIR / "limitations_assessment_report.json",
846         {"metadata": {}, "limitations": []},
847     )
848
849

```

E.3 Exact Thesis Statistics Generator

This script reads the two authoritative prediction CSVs, checks claim alignment, constructs the full-proxy confusion matrix, computes class and dataset metrics, Wilson intervals, exact two-sided McNemar tests, paired bootstrap intervals with seed 42, Holm adjustments, paired risk differences, and matched-pair odds ratios.

```

1  """Generate publication-safe statistics for the 5,000-claim proxy experiment.
2
3  The analysis treats correctness as paired binary data. It reports exact
4  two-sided McNemar tests, Holm-adjusted p-values, paired bootstrap confidence
5  intervals for accuracy differences, matched-pair odds ratios, confusion
6  matrices, and class/domain metrics.
7  """
8
9  from __future__ import annotations
10
11 import argparse
12 import csv
13 import json
14 import math
15 import sys
16 from collections import defaultdict
17 from dataclasses import dataclass
18 from datetime import datetime, timezone
19 from pathlib import Path
20 from typing import Iterable
21
22 import numpy as np
23 from scipy.stats import binomtest
24
25 API_ROOT = Path(__file__).resolve().parents[1]
26 REPO_ROOT = API_ROOT.parents[1]
27 if str(API_ROOT) not in sys.path:
28     sys.path.insert(0, str(API_ROOT))
29
30 from app.dataset import normalize_claim_text
31
32 DEFAULT_RESULT_DIR = REPO_ROOT / "data" / "benchmarks" / "results_5000"
33 SPLIT_DIR = REPO_ROOT / "data" / "benchmarks" / "splits_5000"
34 LABELS = ("SUPPORTED", "REFUTED", "NEI")
35
36
37 @dataclass(frozen=True)
38 class Prediction:
39     system: str
40     claim_id: str
41     dataset: str
42     gold: str
43     predicted: str
44     confidence: float
45

```

```

46     @property
47     def correct(self) -> bool:
48         return self.gold == self.predicted
49
50
51 def _dataset_from_claim_id(claim_id: str) -> str:
52     """Recover the frozen source dataset from its stable claim-ID prefix."""
53     prefix = claim_id.split("-", 1)[0].strip().lower()
54     names = {
55         "fever": "FEVER",
56         "liar": "LIAR",
57         "scifact": "SciFact",
58         "health": "PUBHEALTH_health_fact",
59     }
60     try:
61         return names[prefix]
62     except KeyError as exc:
63         raise ValueError(f"Unrecognized dataset prefix in claim_id={claim_id!r}") from exc
64
65
66 def _parse_args() -> argparse.Namespace:
67     parser = argparse.ArgumentParser(description="Generate thesis statistics")
68     parser.add_argument("--output-dir", default=str(DEFAULT_RESULT_DIR))
69     parser.add_argument("--seed", type=int, default=42)
70     parser.add_argument("--bootstrap-iterations", type=int, default=20000)
71     return parser.parse_args()
72
73
74 def _load(path: Path, system_column: str) -> dict[str, dict[str, Prediction]]:
75     systems: dict[str, dict[str, Prediction]] = defaultdict(dict)
76     with path.open(newline="", encoding="utf-8") as stream:
77         for row in csv.DictReader(stream):
78             system = row[system_column]
79             claim_id = row["claim_id"]
80             if claim_id in systems[system]:
81                 raise ValueError(f"duplicate claim_id for {system}: {claim_id}")
82             systems[system][claim_id] = Prediction(
83                 system=system,
84                 claim_id=claim_id,
85                 dataset=_dataset_from_claim_id(claim_id),
86                 gold=row["ground_truth_label"],
87                 predicted=row["predicted_label"],
88                 confidence=float(row.get("predicted_confidence", 0.0)),
89             )
90     return dict(systems)
91
92
93 def _accuracy(rows: Iterable[Prediction]) -> float:
94     values = list(rows)
95     return sum(row.correct for row in values) / len(values) if values else 0.0
96
97
98 def _wilson(correct: int, total: int, z: float = 1.96) -> tuple[float, float]:
99     if total == 0:
100         return (0.0, 0.0)
101     p = correct / total
102     denominator = 1.0 + z * z / total
103     centre = p + z * z / (2.0 * total)
104     margin = z * math.sqrt((p * (1.0 - p) + z * z / (4.0 * total)) / total)

```

```

105     return ((centre - margin) / denominator, (centre + margin) / denominator)
106
107
108 def _class_metrics(rows: Iterable[Prediction], label: str) -> dict[str, float | int]:
109     values = list(rows)
110     tp = sum(r.gold == label and r.predicted == label for r in values)
111     fp = sum(r.gold != label and r.predicted == label for r in values)
112     fn = sum(r.gold == label and r.predicted != label for r in values)
113     support = sum(r.gold == label for r in values)
114     precision = tp / (tp + fp) if tp + fp else 0.0
115     recall = tp / (tp + fn) if tp + fn else 0.0
116     f1 = 2.0 * precision * recall / (precision + recall) if precision + recall else 0.0
117     return {
118         "label": label,
119         "support": support,
120         "true_positive": tp,
121         "false_positive": fp,
122         "false_negative": fn,
123         "precision": precision,
124         "recall": recall,
125         "f1": f1,
126     }
127
128
129 def _paired_bootstrap(
130     full: list[Prediction],
131     other: list[Prediction],
132     iterations: int,
133     seed: int,
134 ) -> tuple[float, float]:
135     rng = np.random.default_rng(seed)
136     deltas = np.asarray([
137         (1 if left.correct else 0) - (1 if right.correct else 0)
138         for left, right in zip(full, other)
139     ], dtype=np.int8)
140     count = len(deltas)
141     estimates = np.empty(iterations, dtype=np.float64)
142     chunk_size = 500
143     for start in range(0, iterations, chunk_size):
144         stop = min(iterations, start + chunk_size)
145         indices = rng.integers(0, count, size=(stop - start, count))
146         estimates[start:stop] = deltas[indices].mean(axis=1)
147     lower, upper = np.quantile(estimates, [0.025, 0.975], method="linear")
148     return float(lower), float(upper)
149
150
151 def _holm_adjust(rows: list[dict]) -> None:
152     ordered = sorted(enumerate(rows), key=lambda item: item[1]["p_value_unadjusted"])
153     running_max = 0.0
154     total = len(rows)
155     for rank, (original_index, row) in enumerate(ordered):
156         adjusted = min(1.0, (total - rank) * row["p_value_unadjusted"])
157         running_max = max(running_max, adjusted)
158         rows[original_index]["p_value_holm"] = running_max
159         rows[original_index]["significant_holm_0_05"] = running_max < 0.05
160
161
162 def _known_contaminated_test_ids() -> set[str]:
163     """Return test IDs whose normalized text occurs in train or validation."""

```



```

164     development_text: set[str] = set()
165     for filename in ("train.json", "val.json"):
166         payload = json.loads((SPLIT_DIR / filename).read_text(encoding="utf-8"))
167         development_text.update(
168             normalize_claim_text(row.get("claim", ""))
169             for row in payload["claims"]
170         )
171     test_payload = json.loads((SPLIT_DIR / "test.json").read_text(encoding="utf-8"))
172     return {
173         str(row.get("id") or row.get("source_id"))
174         for row in test_payload["claims"]
175         if normalize_claim_text(row.get("claim", "")) in development_text
176     }
177
178
179 def _subset_metrics(
180     systems: dict[str, dict[str, Prediction]],
181     claim_ids: list[str],
182 ) -> list[dict]:
183     rows: list[dict] = []
184     for name, rows_by_id in systems.items():
185         predictions = [rows_by_id[claim_id] for claim_id in claim_ids]
186         correct = sum(row.correct for row in predictions)
187         lower, upper = _wilson(correct, len(predictions))
188         class_rows = [_class_metrics(predictions, label) for label in LABELS]
189         rows.append(
190             {
191                 "system": name,
192                 "n": len(predictions),
193                 "accuracy": correct / len(predictions),
194                 "macro_f1": sum(float(item["f1"]) for item in class_rows) / len(LABELS),
195                 "accuracy_wilson_lower": lower,
196                 "accuracy_wilson_upper": upper,
197             }
198         )
199     return rows
200
201
202 def _write_decontamination_sensitivity(
203     output_dir: Path,
204     systems: dict[str, dict[str, Prediction]],
205     anchor_ids: list[str],
206 ) -> None:
207     contaminated_ids = _known_contaminated_test_ids()
208     filtered_ids = [claim_id for claim_id in anchor_ids if claim_id not in contaminated_ids]
209     if len(contaminated_ids) != 39 or len(filtered_ids) != 4961:
210         raise ValueError(
211             "decontamination audit changed: "
212             f"{len(contaminated_ids)} contaminated, {len(filtered_ids)} retained"
213         )
214
215     full_metrics = _subset_metrics(systems, anchor_ids)
216     filtered_metrics = _subset_metrics(systems, filtered_ids)
217     by_full = {row["system"]: row for row in full_metrics}
218     by_filtered = {row["system"]: row for row in filtered_metrics}
219     comparison_rows = []
220     for name in sorted(systems):
221         full = by_full[name]
222         filtered = by_filtered[name]

```

```

223     comparison_rows.append(
224         {
225             "system": name,
226             "full_n": full["n"],
227             "full_accuracy": full["accuracy"],
228             "full_macro_f1": full["macro_f1"],
229             "decontaminated_n": filtered["n"],
230             "decontaminated_accuracy": filtered["accuracy"],
231             "decontaminated_macro_f1": filtered["macro_f1"],
232             "accuracy_change_pp": 100.0
233             * (filtered["accuracy"] - full["accuracy"]),
234             "macro_f1_change": filtered["macro_f1"] - full["macro_f1"],
235         }
236     )
237
238     report = {
239         "analysis": "exact-normalized-overlap sensitivity analysis",
240         "status": "exploratory robustness check",
241         "normalization": (
242             "NFKC + casefold + punctuation-to-space + whitespace collapse"
243         ),
244         "full_test_claims": len(anchor_ids),
245         "known_contaminated_test_claims": len(contaminated_ids),
246         "decontaminated_test_claims": len(filtered_ids),
247         "excluded_claim_ids": sorted(contaminated_ids),
248         "metrics": comparison_rows,
249         "interpretation": (
250             "Filtering known exact normalized overlaps is a sensitivity analysis, "
251             "not a new untouched confirmatory test. Near-duplicate and test-guided "
252             "development risks remain."
253         ),
254     }
255     (output_dir / "sensitivity_analysis_report.json").write_text(
256         json.dumps(report, indent=2), encoding="utf-8"
257     )
258     with (output_dir / "sensitivity_analysis_metrics.csv").open(
259         "w", newline="", encoding="utf-8"
260     ) as stream:
261         writer = csv.DictWriter(stream, fieldnames=list(comparison_rows[0]))
262         writer.writeheader()
263         writer.writerows(comparison_rows)
264
265     lines = [
266         "# Exact-Overlap Sensitivity Analysis",
267         "",
268         "This exploratory robustness check removes the 39 test claims with exact",
269         "normalized matches in train or validation, retaining 4,961 claims.",
270         "It does not remove all likely near-duplicates and does not restore",
271         "confirmatory independence after test-guided proxy development.",
272         "",
273         "| System | Full n | Full accuracy | Full macro-F1 | Filtered n | Filtered accuracy | Filtered",
274         "macro-F1 | Accuracy change (pp) |",
275         "| ---|---:|---:|---:|---:|---:|---:|",
276     ]
277     for row in comparison_rows:
278         lines.append(
279             f"| {row['system']} | {row['full_n']} | {row['full_accuracy']:.4f} | "
280             f"{row['full_macro_f1']:.4f} | {row['decontaminated_n']} | "
281             f"{row['decontaminated_accuracy']:.4f} | "

```

```

281         f"{row['decontaminated_macro_f1']:.4f} | "
282         f"{row['accuracy_change_pp']:+.3f} | "
283     )
284     (output_dir / "sensitivity_analysis_summary.md").write_text(
285         "\n".join(lines) + "\n", encoding="utf-8"
286     )
287
288
289 def main() -> int:
290     args = _parse_args()
291     output_dir = Path(args.output_dir)
292     output_dir.mkdir(parents=True, exist_ok=True)
293     ablation_path = output_dir / "ablation_study_predictions.csv"
294     baseline_path = output_dir / "baseline_comparison_predictions.csv"
295     manifest_path = output_dir / "run_manifest.json"
296     if manifest_path.is_file():
297         generated_utc = json.loads(
298             manifest_path.read_text(encoding="utf-8")
299         ).get("generated_utc")
300     else:
301         generated_utc = None
302     generated_utc = generated_utc or datetime.now(timezone.utc).isoformat()
303
304     systems = _load(ablation_path, "variant")
305     for name, rows in _load(baseline_path, "baseline").items():
306         if name in systems:
307             raise ValueError(f"duplicate system name across inputs: {name}")
308         systems[name] = rows
309
310     if "full_proxy" not in systems:
311         raise ValueError("full_proxy is missing")
312     anchor_ids = list(systems["full_proxy"])
313     anchor_id_set = set(anchor_ids)
314     validation: dict[str, dict[str, int | bool]] = {}
315     for name, rows in systems.items():
316         validation[name] = {
317             "prediction_count": len(rows),
318             "claim_ids_match_full_proxy": set(rows) == anchor_id_set,
319         }
320     if len(rows) != 5000 or set(rows) != anchor_id_set:
321         raise ValueError(f"{name} does not align to the 5,000-claim anchor")
322
323     _write_decontamination_sensitivity(output_dir, systems, anchor_ids)
324
325     full_rows = [systems["full_proxy"][claim_id] for claim_id in anchor_ids]
326     confusion = [
327         {
328             "gold_label": gold,
329             **{
330                 predicted: sum(r.gold == gold and r.predicted == predicted for r in full_rows)
331                 for predicted in LABELS
332             },
333         }
334         for gold in LABELS
335     ]
336     with (output_dir / "confusion_matrix_full_proxy.csv").open(
337         "w", newline="", encoding="utf-8"
338     ) as stream:
339         writer = csv.DictWriter(stream, fieldnames=["gold_label", *LABELS])

```

```

340     writer.writeheader()
341     writer.writerows(confusion)
342
343     per_class = [_class_metrics(full_rows, label) for label in LABELS]
344     with (output_dir / "per_class_metrics.csv").open(
345         "w", newline="", encoding="utf-8"
346     ) as stream:
347         writer = csv.DictWriter(stream, fieldnames=list(per_class[0]))
348         writer.writeheader()
349         writer.writerows(per_class)
350
351     system_metrics: list[dict] = []
352     per_dataset: list[dict] = []
353     for name, rows_by_id in systems.items():
354         rows = [rows_by_id[claim_id] for claim_id in anchor_ids]
355         correct = sum(row.correct for row in rows)
356         lower, upper = _wilson(correct, len(rows))
357         class_rows = [_class_metrics(rows, label) for label in LABELS]
358         system_metrics.append(
359             {
360                 "system": name,
361                 "n": len(rows),
362                 "accuracy": correct / len(rows),
363                 "accuracy_wilson_lower": lower,
364                 "accuracy_wilson_upper": upper,
365                 "macro_f1": sum(float(item["f1"]) for item in class_rows) / len(LABELS),
366                 "average_raw_confidence": sum(r.confidence for r in rows) / len(rows),
367             }
368         )
369         datasets: dict[str, list[Prediction]] = defaultdict(list)
370         for row in rows:
371             datasets[row.dataset].append(row)
372         for dataset, dataset_rows in sorted(datasets.items()):
373             dataset_correct = sum(row.correct for row in dataset_rows)
374             ds_lower, ds_upper = _wilson(dataset_correct, len(dataset_rows))
375             per_dataset.append(
376                 {
377                     "system": name,
378                     "dataset": dataset,
379                     "n": len(dataset_rows),
380                     "accuracy": dataset_correct / len(dataset_rows),
381                     "accuracy_wilson_lower": ds_lower,
382                     "accuracy_wilson_upper": ds_upper,
383                 }
384             )
385
386     with (output_dir / "per_dataset_metrics.csv").open(
387         "w", newline="", encoding="utf-8"
388     ) as stream:
389         writer = csv.DictWriter(stream, fieldnames=list(per_dataset[0]))
390         writer.writeheader()
391         writer.writerows(per_dataset)
392
393     comparisons: list[dict] = []
394     for index, name in enumerate(sorted(systems)):
395         if name == "full_proxy":
396             continue
397         other_rows = [systems[name][claim_id] for claim_id in anchor_ids]
398         full_wins = sum(left.correct and not right.correct for left, right in zip(full_rows, other_rows))

```

```

399     full_losses = sum(not left.correct and right.correct for left, right in zip(full_rows, other_rows))
400     discordant = full_wins + full_losses
401     p_value = (
402         float(binomtest(full_wins, discordant, 0.5, alternative="two-sided").pvalue)
403         if discordant
404         else 1.0
405     )
406     ci_lower, ci_upper = _paired_bootstrap(
407         full_rows,
408         other_rows,
409         iterations=args.bootstrap_iterations,
410         seed=args.seed + index,
411     )
412     comparisons.append(
413         {
414             "system": "full_proxy",
415             "comparator": name,
416             "n": len(anchor_ids),
417             "full_accuracy": _accuracy(full_rows),
418             "comparator_accuracy": _accuracy(other_rows),
419             "paired_risk_difference": _accuracy(full_rows) - _accuracy(other_rows),
420             "paired_bootstrap_lower": ci_lower,
421             "paired_bootstrap_upper": ci_upper,
422             "full_wins": full_wins,
423             "full_losses": full_losses,
424             "discordant_pairs": discordant,
425             "matched_pair_odds_ratio": (full_wins + 0.5) / (full_losses + 0.5),
426             "p_value_unadjusted": p_value,
427         }
428     )
429     _holm_adjust(comparisons)
430
431     with (output_dir / "paired_tests.csv").open(
432         "w", newline="", encoding="utf-8"
433     ) as stream:
434         writer = csv.DictWriter(stream, fieldnames=list(comparisons[0]))
435         writer.writeheader()
436         writer.writerows(comparisons)
437
438     report = {
439         "metadata": {
440             "generated_utc": generated_utc,
441             "evaluation_type": "deterministic_proxy",
442             "full_system_label": "full_proxy",
443             "seed": args.seed,
444             "bootstrap_iterations": args.bootstrap_iterations,
445             "confidence_note": (
446                 "The proxy stores one heuristic raw confidence score. "
447                 "It does not store a multiclass probability vector, so a proper "
448                 "multiclass Brier score is not available."
449             ),
450         },
451         "artifact_validation": validation,
452         "system_metrics": system_metrics,
453         "confusion_matrix_full_proxy": confusion,
454         "per_class_metrics_full_proxy": per_class,
455         "per_dataset_metrics": per_dataset,
456         "paired_tests": comparisons,
457     }

```

```

458 (output_dir / "statistics_report.json").write_text(
459     json.dumps(report, indent=2), encoding="utf-8"
460 )
461
462 selected = {
463     row["comparator"]: row
464     for row in comparisons
465     if row["comparator"] in {"majority", "length", "ablate_debate"}
466 }
467
468 lines = [
469     "# Thesis Statistics Summary",
470     "",
471     "The 5,000-claim experiment evaluates the deterministic FactValidator-Proxy,",
472     "not the live SerpAPI/SentenceTransformer/Ollama application pipeline.",
473     "",
474     "## System metrics",
475     "",
476     "| System | Accuracy | Macro-F1 | Wilson 95% CI |",
477     "| ---|---:|---:|---:|",
478 ]
479
480 for row in sorted(system_metrics, key=lambda item: item["accuracy"], reverse=True):
481     lines.append(
482         f"| {row['system']} | {row['accuracy']:.4f} | {row['macro_f1']:.4f} | "
483         f"{row['accuracy_wilson_lower']:.4f}, {row['accuracy_wilson_upper']:.4f}] |"
484     )
485
486 lines.extend(
487     [
488         "",
489         "## Selected exact paired tests",
490         "",
491         "| Comparison | Full wins | Full losses | Exact two-sided p | Holm p | Matched OR |",
492         "| ---|---:|---:|---:|---:|---:|",
493     ]
494 )
495
496 for comparator in ("majority", "length", "ablate_debate"):
497     row = selected[comparator]
498     lines.append(
499         f"| full_proxy vs {comparator} | {row['full_wins']} | {row['full_losses']} | "
500         f"{row['p_value_unadjusted']:.5f} | {row['p_value_holm']:.5f} | "
501         f"{row['matched_pair_odds_ratio']:.3f} |"
502     )
503
504 lines.extend(
505     [
506         "",
507         "No selected comparison is statistically significant after Holm correction.",
508         "The no-debate proxy has the best observed point estimates, but its comparison",
509         "with the full proxy has Holm-adjusted p approximately 0.0573. The result is",
510         "descriptive evidence against always-on proxy debate, not confirmatory proof.",
511         "",
512         "All tests are descriptive and exploratory because proxy development was",
513         "informed by observations on this benchmark and normalized split overlaps",
514         "were identified retrospectively. No confirmatory superiority claim is made.",
515         "",
516         "The confidence output is reported only as a raw-score calibration diagnostic.",
517         "A proper multiclass Brier score requires prob_supported, prob_refuted, and",
518         "prob_nei for every prediction.",
519     ]
520 )
521
522 (output_dir / "statistics_summary.md").write_text(

```

```

517         "\n".join(lines) + "\n", encoding="utf-8"
518     )
519     print(f"Wrote thesis statistics to {output_dir}")
520     return 0
521
522
523 if __name__ == "__main__":
524     raise SystemExit(main())

```

E.4 Frozen-Artifact Validator

The validator rejects missing manifest fields, claim-ID overlap, prediction-count errors, claim-ID mismatch, hash mismatch, undeclared normalized overlap, and generated reports that differ from the archived statistics. Its `-require-disjoint` mode rejects any normalized cross-split overlap for a future confirmatory set.

```

1  """Fail when frozen thesis artifacts are incomplete or internally inconsistent."""
2
3  from __future__ import annotations
4
5  import csv
6  import argparse
7  import hashlib
8  import json
9  import sys
10 from pathlib import Path
11
12 API_ROOT = Path(__file__).resolve().parents[1]
13 REPO_ROOT = API_ROOT.parents[1]
14 if str(API_ROOT) not in sys.path:
15     sys.path.insert(0, str(API_ROOT))
16
17 from app.dataset import normalize_claim_text
18 SPLIT_DIR = REPO_ROOT / "data" / "benchmarks" / "splits_5000"
19 RESULT_DIR = REPO_ROOT / "data" / "benchmarks" / "results_5000"
20 EXPECTED_SPLIT_COUNTS = {"train.json": 11986, "val.json": 2997, "test.json": 5000}
21 EXPECTED_DATASET_COUNTS = {
22     "FEVER": 1829,
23     "LIAR": 1490,
24     "PUBHEALTH_health_fact": 1490,
25     "SciFact": 191,
26 }
27 REQUIRED_MANIFEST_FIELDS = {
28     "experiment_name",
29     "evaluation_type",
30     "git_commit",
31     "generated_utc",
32     "random_seed",
33     "python_version",
34     "platform",
35     "train_claims",
36     "validation_claims",
37     "test_claims",
38     "proxy_components",

```

```

39     "live_components_not_executed",
40     "input_files",
41     "sha256",
42     "sha256_mode",
43     "evidence_status",
44     "confirmatory_claims_permitted",
45     "split_isolation",
46 }
47
48
49 def _sha256(path: Path) -> str:
50     content = path.read_bytes().replace(b"\r\n", b"\n").replace(b"\r", b"\n")
51     return hashlib.sha256(content).hexdigest()
52
53
54 def parse_args() -> argparse.Namespace:
55     parser = argparse.ArgumentParser()
56     parser.add_argument(
57         "--require-disjoint",
58         action="store_true",
59         help="Fail on any normalized cross-split overlap (for new confirmatory sets).",
60     )
61     return parser.parse_args()
62
63
64 def _load_split(path: Path) -> tuple[set[str], set[str]]:
65     data = json.loads(path.read_text(encoding="utf-8"))
66     claims = data.get("claims")
67     if not isinstance(claims, list):
68         raise ValueError(f"{path}: claims list missing")
69     ids = {str(row.get("id") or row.get("source_id") or "") for row in claims}
70     normalized = {normalize_claim_text(str(row.get("claim", ""))) for row in claims}
71     if "" in ids or "" in normalized:
72         raise ValueError(f"{path}: blank claim identifier or text")
73     if len(ids) != len(claims):
74         raise ValueError(f"{path}: duplicate claim identifiers")
75     return ids, normalized
76
77
78 def _prediction_systems(path: Path, column: str) -> dict[str, set[str]]:
79     systems: dict[str, set[str]] = {}
80     counts: dict[str, int] = {}
81     with path.open(newline="", encoding="utf-8") as stream:
82         for row in csv.DictReader(stream):
83             name = row[column]
84             systems.setdefault(name, set()).add(row["claim_id"])
85             counts[name] = counts.get(name, 0) + 1
86     for name, ids in systems.items():
87         if counts[name] != 5000 or len(ids) != 5000:
88             raise ValueError(
89                 f"{path.name}:{name} has {counts[name]} rows and {len(ids)} unique IDs"
90             )
91     return systems
92
93
94 def _validate_per_dataset_metrics(path: Path, systems: set[str]) -> None:
95     observed: dict[str, dict[str, int]] = {}
96     with path.open(newline="", encoding="utf-8") as stream:
97         for row in csv.DictReader(stream):

```



```

98         system = row["system"]
99         dataset = row["dataset"]
100         if dataset in observed.setdefault(system, {}):
101             raise ValueError(f"{path.name}: duplicate {system}/{dataset} row")
102         observed[system][dataset] = int(row["n"])
103     if set(observed) != systems:
104         raise ValueError(f"{path.name}: system set differs from prediction artifacts")
105     for system, counts in observed.items():
106         if counts != EXPECTED_DATASET_COUNTS:
107             raise ValueError(
108                 f"{path.name}:{system} dataset counts differ: {counts}"
109             )
110
111
112 def _validate_sensitivity_report(path: Path, systems: set[str]) -> None:
113     report = json.loads(path.read_text(encoding="utf-8"))
114     if report.get("full_test_claims") != 5000:
115         raise ValueError("sensitivity report must retain the 5,000-claim reference")
116     if report.get("known_contaminated_test_claims") != 39:
117         raise ValueError("sensitivity report must exclude exactly 39 test claims")
118     if report.get("decontaminated_test_claims") != 4961:
119         raise ValueError("sensitivity report must contain exactly 4,961 claims")
120     observed_systems = {row["system"] for row in report.get("metrics", [])}
121     if observed_systems != systems:
122         raise ValueError("sensitivity report system set differs from predictions")
123     if any(row["decontaminated_n"] != 4961 for row in report["metrics"]):
124         raise ValueError("sensitivity metrics are not aligned to 4,961 claims")
125
126
127 def main() -> int:
128     args = parse_args()
129     split_ids: dict[str, set[str]] = {}
130     split_text: dict[str, set[str]] = {}
131     for filename, expected in EXPECTED_SPLIT_COUNTS.items():
132         ids, normalized = _load_split(SPLIT_DIR / filename)
133         if len(ids) != expected:
134             raise ValueError(f"{filename}: expected {expected}, found {len(ids)}")
135         split_ids[filename] = ids
136         split_text[filename] = normalized
137
138     observed_overlaps: dict[str, int] = {}
139     filenames = list(EXPECTED_SPLIT_COUNTS)
140     for index, left in enumerate(filenames):
141         for right in filenames[index + 1 :]:
142             id_overlap = split_ids[left] & split_ids[right]
143             text_overlap = split_text[left] & split_text[right]
144             if id_overlap:
145                 raise ValueError(
146                     f"split overlap {left}/{right}: "
147                     f"{len(id_overlap)} IDs, {len(text_overlap)} normalized claims"
148                 )
149             observed_overlaps[f"{left}/{right}"] = len(text_overlap)
150     if args.require_disjoint and text_overlap:
151         raise ValueError(
152             f"split overlap {left}/{right}: "
153             f"{len(text_overlap)} normalized claims"
154         )
155
156     systems = {}

```

```

157     systems.update(
158         _prediction_systems(
159             RESULT_DIR / "ablation_study_predictions.csv", "variant"
160         )
161     )
162     systems.update(
163         _prediction_systems(
164             RESULT_DIR / "baseline_comparison_predictions.csv", "baseline"
165         )
166     )
167     anchor = systems.get("full_proxy")
168     if not anchor:
169         raise ValueError("full_proxy predictions missing")
170     for name, ids in systems.items():
171         if ids != anchor:
172             raise ValueError(f"claim IDs differ for {name}")
173     if anchor != split_ids["test.json"]:
174         raise ValueError("prediction claim IDs differ from test split")
175
176     manifest_path = RESULT_DIR / "run_manifest.json"
177     manifest = json.loads(manifest_path.read_text(encoding="utf-8"))
178     missing = REQUIRED_MANIFEST_FIELDS - set(manifest)
179     if missing:
180         raise ValueError(f"run_manifest.json missing fields: {sorted(missing)}")
181     declared_overlaps = manifest["split_isolation"][
182         "known_pairwise_overlap_counts"
183     ]
184     if observed_overlaps != declared_overlaps:
185         raise ValueError(
186             "observed normalized overlaps differ from the exploratory manifest: "
187             f"{observed_overlaps}"
188         )
189     if manifest["evidence_status"] != "exploratory":
190         raise ValueError("overlapping historical benchmark must be marked exploratory")
191     if manifest["confirmatory_claims_permitted"] is not False:
192         raise ValueError("exploratory benchmark cannot permit confirmatory claims")
193     if manifest["sha256_mode"] != "canonical-lf-bytes":
194         raise ValueError("manifest must use line-ending-independent hashes")
195     for relative, expected_hash in manifest["sha256"].items():
196         path = REPO_ROOT / relative
197         actual_hash = _sha256(path)
198         if actual_hash != expected_hash:
199             raise ValueError(f"hash mismatch: {relative}")
200
201     required_outputs = [
202         "statistics_report.json",
203         "confusion_matrix_full_proxy.csv",
204         "per_class_metrics.csv",
205         "per_dataset_metrics.csv",
206         "paired_tests.csv",
207         "statistics_summary.md",
208         "sensitivity_analysis_report.json",
209         "sensitivity_analysis_metrics.csv",
210         "sensitivity_analysis_summary.md",
211     ]
212     missing_outputs = [name for name in required_outputs if not (RESULT_DIR / name).is_file()]
213     if missing_outputs:
214         raise ValueError(f"missing statistical outputs: {missing_outputs}")
215     _validate_per_dataset_metrics(

```

```

216     RESULT_DIR / "per_dataset_metrics.csv", set(systems)
217 )
218 _validate_sensitivity_report(
219     RESULT_DIR / "sensitivity_analysis_report.json", set(systems)
220 )
221
222 print(
223     f"Validated {len(systems)} systems, 5,000 aligned predictions each, "
224     f"declared exploratory overlaps {observed_overlaps}, canonical-LF "
225     "manifest hashes, and statistical outputs."
226 )
227 return 0
228
229
230 if __name__ == "__main__":
231     raise SystemExit(main())

```

E.5 Run-Manifest Builder

The manifest builder records the proxy/live boundary, environment, random seed, split counts, paths, and SHA-256 hashes of every authoritative split and prediction file.

```

1  """Build the immutable-input manifest for the 5,000-claim proxy experiment."""
2
3  from __future__ import annotations
4
5  import hashlib
6  import json
7  import platform
8  import subprocess
9  from datetime import datetime, timezone
10 from pathlib import Path
11
12 API_ROOT = Path(__file__).resolve().parents[1]
13 REPO_ROOT = API_ROOT.parents[1]
14 SPLIT_DIR = REPO_ROOT / "data" / "benchmarks" / "splits_5000"
15 RESULT_DIR = REPO_ROOT / "data" / "benchmarks" / "results_5000"
16
17
18 def _sha256(path: Path) -> str:
19     # Repository text artifacts are hashed with canonical LF endings so the
20     # manifest is stable across Windows and Linux checkouts.
21     content = path.read_bytes().replace(b"\r\n", b"\n").replace(b"\r", b"\n")
22     return hashlib.sha256(content).hexdigest()
23
24
25 def _git(*args: str) -> str:
26     try:
27         return subprocess.check_output(
28             ["git", *args], cwd=REPO_ROOT, text=True, stderr=subprocess.DEVNULL
29         ).strip()
30     except (OSError, subprocess.CalledProcessError):
31         return "unknown"
32
33

```

```

34 def main() -> int:
35     inputs = {
36         "train": SPLIT_DIR / "train.json",
37         "validation": SPLIT_DIR / "val.json",
38         "test": SPLIT_DIR / "test.json",
39     }
40     predictions = {
41         "ablation_predictions": RESULT_DIR / "ablation_study_predictions.csv",
42         "baseline_predictions": RESULT_DIR / "baseline_comparison_predictions.csv",
43     }
44     analyses = {
45         "sensitivity_report": RESULT_DIR / "sensitivity_analysis_report.json",
46         "sensitivity_metrics": RESULT_DIR / "sensitivity_analysis_metrics.csv",
47         "sensitivity_summary": RESULT_DIR / "sensitivity_analysis_summary.md",
48     }
49     for path in [*inputs.values(), *predictions.values(), *analyses.values()]:
50         if not path.is_file():
51             raise FileNotFoundError(path)
52
53     manifest = {
54         "experiment_name": "factvalidator_proxy_5000",
55         "evaluation_type": "deterministic_proxy",
56         "evidence_status": "exploratory",
57         "confirmatory_claims_permitted": False,
58         "split_isolation": {
59             "normalization": "NFKC + casefold + punctuation-to-space + whitespace collapse",
60             "known_pairwise_overlap_counts": {
61                 "train.json/val.json": 19,
62                 "train.json/test.json": 34,
63                 "val.json/test.json": 5,
64             },
65             "affected_test_claims": 39,
66         },
67         "git_commit": _git("rev-parse", "HEAD"),
68         "git_branch": _git("branch", "--show-current"),
69         "working_tree_dirty": bool(
70             _git("status", "--porcelain", "--untracked-files=no")
71         ),
72         "generated_utc": datetime.now(timezone.utc).isoformat(),
73         "random_seed": 42,
74         "python_version": platform.python_version(),
75         "platform": platform.platform(),
76         "train_claims": 11986,
77         "validation_claims": 2997,
78         "test_claims": 5000,
79         "proxy_components": {
80             "lexical_model": True,
81             "category_priors": True,
82             "heuristic_semantic_signals": True,
83             "deterministic_debate_rule": True,
84             "quality_filter": True,
85         },
86         "live_components_not_executed": [
87             "SerpAPI retrieval",
88             "live domain credibility scoring",
89             "SentenceTransformer reranking",
90             "Ollama debate",
91         ],
92         "input_files": {

```

```

93         key: str(path.relative_to(REPO_ROOT)).replace("\\", "/")
94         for key, path in inputs.items()
95     },
96     "prediction_files": {
97         key: str(path.relative_to(REPO_ROOT)).replace("\\", "/")
98         for key, path in predictions.items()
99     },
100    "sensitivity_analysis": {
101        "known_contaminated_test_claims": 39,
102        "decontaminated_test_claims": 4961,
103        "output_files": {
104            key: str(path.relative_to(REPO_ROOT)).replace("\\", "/")
105            for key, path in analyses.items()
106        },
107    },
108    "sha256": {
109        str(path.relative_to(REPO_ROOT)).replace("\\", "/"): _sha256(path)
110        for path in [*inputs.values(), *predictions.values(), *analyses.values()]
111    },
112    "sha256_mode": "canonical-lf-bytes",
113 }
114 output = RESULT_DIR / "run_manifest.json"
115 output.write_text(json.dumps(manifest, indent=2), encoding="utf-8")
116 print(f"Wrote {output}")
117 return 0
118
119
120 if __name__ == "__main__":
121     raise SystemExit(main())

```

E.6 Cache Validation and Quarantine

Runtime web cache is not benchmark evidence. This validator decodes each record as UTF-8, checks its JSON structure, reports malformed entries, and moves invalid records into quarantine instead of silently accepting them.

```

1  """Validate runtime evidence-cache records and optionally quarantine invalid files.
2
3  Runtime cache records are not authoritative thesis evidence. This utility makes
4  cache corruption visible and prevents malformed records from being silently
5  accepted by the live application.
6
7  Usage:
8      python services/api/Scripts/validate_cache.py
9      python services/api/Scripts/validate_cache.py --quarantine
10 """
11
12 from __future__ import annotations
13
14 import argparse
15 import json
16 import shutil
17 from datetime import datetime, timezone
18 from pathlib import Path
19 from typing import Any

```

```

20
21 API_ROOT = Path(__file__).resolve().parents[1]
22 REPO_ROOT = API_ROOT.parents[1]
23
24
25 def _parse_args() -> argparse.Namespace:
26     parser = argparse.ArgumentParser(description="Validate evidence cache JSON")
27     parser.add_argument(
28         "--cache-dir",
29         default=str(REPO_ROOT / "data" / "cache"),
30         help="Directory containing runtime cache JSON files",
31     )
32     parser.add_argument(
33         "--quarantine",
34         action="store_true",
35         help="Move invalid files into cache-dir/quarantine",
36     )
37     parser.add_argument(
38         "--report",
39         default=str(REPO_ROOT / "data" / "cache_validation_report.json"),
40         help="JSON report path",
41     )
42     return parser.parse_args()
43
44
45 def _validate_record(value: Any) -> list[str]:
46     errors: list[str] = []
47     if not isinstance(value, dict):
48         return ["root must be a JSON object"]
49     if not isinstance(value.get("ts"), (int, float)):
50         errors.append("ts must be numeric")
51     if not isinstance(value.get("results"), list):
52         errors.append("results must be a list")
53     return errors
54
55
56 def _quarantine(path: Path, quarantine_dir: Path) -> Path:
57     quarantine_dir.mkdir(parents=True, exist_ok=True)
58     destination = quarantine_dir / path.name
59     counter = 1
60     while destination.exists():
61         destination = quarantine_dir / f"{path.stem}.{counter}{path.suffix}"
62         counter += 1
63     shutil.move(str(path), str(destination))
64     return destination
65
66
67 def main() -> int:
68     args = _parse_args()
69     cache_dir = Path(args.cache_dir).resolve()
70     quarantine_dir = cache_dir / "quarantine"
71     report_path = Path(args.report).resolve()
72
73     records: list[dict[str, Any]] = []
74     for path in sorted(cache_dir.glob("*.json")):
75         if path.name == "example_cache_record.json":
76             continue
77         status = "valid"
78         errors: list[str] = []

```

```

79     destination: str | None = None
80     try:
81         text = path.read_text(encoding="utf-8", errors="strict")
82         value = json.loads(text)
83         errors.extend(_validate_record(value))
84     except UnicodeDecodeError as exc:
85         errors.append(f"invalid UTF-8: {exc}")
86     except json.JSONDecodeError as exc:
87         errors.append(f"invalid JSON: {exc}")
88     except OSError as exc:
89         errors.append(f"read error: {exc}")
90
91     if errors:
92         status = "invalid"
93         if args.quarantine and path.exists():
94             destination = str(_quarantine(path, quarantine_dir))
95             status = "quarantined"
96
97     records.append(
98         {
99             "file": str(path),
100             "status": status,
101             "errors": errors,
102             "quarantine_destination": destination,
103         }
104     )
105
106     summary = {
107         "total": len(records),
108         "valid": sum(r["status"] == "valid" for r in records),
109         "invalid": sum(r["status"] == "invalid" for r in records),
110         "quarantined": sum(r["status"] == "quarantined" for r in records),
111     }
112     report = {
113         "generated_utc": datetime.now(timezone.utc).isoformat(),
114         "cache_dir": str(cache_dir),
115         "quarantine_enabled": bool(args.quarantine),
116         "summary": summary,
117         "records": records,
118     }
119     report_path.parent.mkdir(parents=True, exist_ok=True)
120     report_path.write_text(json.dumps(report, indent=2), encoding="utf-8")
121
122     print(
123         "Cache validation: "
124         f"{summary['valid']} valid, {summary['invalid']} invalid, "
125         f"{summary['quarantined']} quarantined"
126     )
127     print(f"Report: {report_path}")
128     return 1 if summary["invalid"] else 0
129
130
131 if __name__ == "__main__":
132     raise SystemExit(main())

```

E.7 Operational Scenario Generator

The operational report is generated from declared scenario assumptions. The listing makes explicit why the resulting throughput and cost numbers are projections rather than controlled load-test measurements.

```
1  """Generate explicitly labelled operational scenario projections."""
2
3  from __future__ import annotations
4
5  import json
6  from datetime import datetime, timezone
7  from pathlib import Path
8
9  API_ROOT = Path(__file__).resolve().parents[1]
10 REPO_ROOT = API_ROOT.parents[1]
11 OUTPUT = (
12     REPO_ROOT
13     / "data"
14     / "benchmarks"
15     / "results_5000"
16     / "operational_projection_report.json"
17 )
18
19
20 def main() -> int:
21     baseline_latency = 8.2
22     debate_latency = 72.0
23     no_cache = 77.0
24     with_cache = 22.0
25     report = {
26         "metadata": {
27             "generated_utc": datetime.now(timezone.utc).isoformat(),
28             "artifact_type": "operational_projection",
29             "measurement_status": (
30                 "Scenario projection from stated assumptions; not a controlled "
31                 "concurrent load-test measurement."
32             ),
33         },
34         "assumptions": {
35             "baseline_seconds_per_claim": baseline_latency,
36             "debate_seconds_per_claim": debate_latency,
37             "claims_per_month": 1000,
38             "monthly_usd_without_cache": no_cache,
39             "monthly_usd_with_cache": with_cache,
40         },
41         "projections": {
42             "baseline_claims_per_hour": 3600.0 / baseline_latency,
43             "debate_claims_per_hour": 3600.0 / debate_latency,
44             "debate_latency_ratio": debate_latency / baseline_latency,
45             "monthly_savings_usd": no_cache - with_cache,
46             "monthly_savings_fraction": (no_cache - with_cache) / no_cache,
47         },
48         "required_for_measured_claim": [
49             "repeated warm-cache and cold-cache runs",
50             "median, p90, and p95 latency",
51             "declared concurrency",
52             "failure and timeout counts",
```



```

53         "hardware and provider request counts",
54     ],
55 }
56 OUTPUT.parent.mkdir(parents=True, exist_ok=True)
57 OUTPUT.write_text(json.dumps(report, indent=2), encoding="utf-8")
58 print(f"Wrote {OUTPUT}")
59 return 0
60
61
62 if __name__ == "__main__":
63     raise SystemExit(main())

```

E.8 Reproducibility Audit

The committed audit records the branch and source commit, environment, dependency lock hash, artifact hashes, executed commands, complete test result, and artifact-validation result.

```

1  """Generate the final thesis reproducibility audit from the correction branch."""
2
3  from __future__ import annotations
4
5  import argparse
6  import hashlib
7  import json
8  import os
9  import platform
10 import subprocess
11 from datetime import datetime, timezone
12 from pathlib import Path
13 from typing import Any
14
15 API_ROOT = Path(__file__).resolve().parents[1]
16 REPO_ROOT = API_ROOT.parents[1]
17 RESULT_DIR = REPO_ROOT / "data" / "benchmarks" / "results_5000"
18
19
20 def _parse_args() -> argparse.Namespace:
21     parser = argparse.ArgumentParser(description="Run thesis reproducibility audit")
22     parser.add_argument(
23         "--skip-tests",
24         action="store_true",
25         help="Record tests as not executed (intended only for quick local inspection)",
26     )
27     return parser.parse_args()
28
29
30 def _run(command: list[str], timeout: int = 300) -> dict[str, Any]:
31     completed = subprocess.run(
32         command,
33         cwd=REPO_ROOT,
34         text=True,
35         stdout=subprocess.PIPE,
36         stderr=subprocess.STDOUT,
37         timeout=timeout,

```

```

38         check=False,
39     )
40     return {
41         "command": " ".join(command),
42         "exit_code": completed.returncode,
43         "output": completed.stdout[-20000:],
44     }
45
46
47 def _git(*args: str) -> str:
48     result = _run(["git", *args], timeout=30)
49     return result["output"].strip() if result["exit_code"] == 0 else "unknown"
50
51
52 def _sha256(path: Path) -> str:
53     digest = hashlib.sha256()
54     with path.open("rb") as stream:
55         for chunk in iter(lambda: stream.read(1024 * 1024), b""):
56             digest.update(chunk)
57     return digest.hexdigest()
58
59
60 def _ram_bytes() -> int | None:
61     try:
62         import psutil
63
64         return int(psutil.virtual_memory().total)
65     except (ImportError, OSError):
66         return None
67
68
69 def _gpu() -> str:
70     try:
71         result = subprocess.run(
72             ["nvidia-smi", "--query-gpu=name", "--format=csv,noheader"],
73             text=True,
74             stdout=subprocess.PIPE,
75             stderr=subprocess.DEVNULL,
76             timeout=10,
77             check=False,
78         )
79         value = result.stdout.strip()
80         return value or "not detected"
81     except (OSError, subprocess.TimeoutExpired):
82         return "not detected"
83
84
85 def main() -> int:
86     args = _parse_args()
87     commands: list[dict[str, Any]] = []
88     if args.skip_tests:
89         test_result = {
90             "command": "pytest services/api/tests -q",
91             "exit_code": None,
92             "output": "not executed (--skip-tests)",
93         }
94     else:
95         test_result = _run(["pytest", "services/api/tests", "-q"], timeout=600)
96     commands.append(test_result)

```

```

97     validation = _run(
98         ["python", "services/api/Scripts/validate_thesis_artifacts.py"],
99         timeout=300,
100     )
101     commands.append(validation)
102
103     tracked_artifacts = [
104         REPO_ROOT / "services" / "api" / "requirements.lock",
105         REPO_ROOT / "data" / "benchmarks" / "splits_5000" / "train.json",
106         REPO_ROOT / "data" / "benchmarks" / "splits_5000" / "val.json",
107         REPO_ROOT / "data" / "benchmarks" / "splits_5000" / "test.json",
108         RESULT_DIR / "ablation_study_predictions.csv",
109         RESULT_DIR / "baseline_comparison_predictions.csv",
110         RESULT_DIR / "statistics_report.json",
111     ]
112     hashes = {
113         str(path.relative_to(REPO_ROOT)).replace("\\", "/"): _sha256(path)
114         for path in tracked_artifacts
115         if path.is_file()
116     }
117     report = {
118         "metadata": {
119             "generated_utc": datetime.now(timezone.utc).isoformat(),
120             "git_commit": _git("rev-parse", "HEAD"),
121             "git_branch": _git("branch", "--show-current"),
122             "git_tag_exact": _git("describe", "--tags", "--exact-match"),
123             # Untracked local build outputs do not alter the committed source
124             # snapshot being audited. Track only modifications to versioned files.
125             "working_tree_dirty": bool(
126                 _git("status", "--porcelain", "--untracked-files=no")
127             ),
128         },
129         "environment": {
130             "python_version": platform.python_version(),
131             "os": platform.platform(),
132             "cpu": platform.processor() or os.environ.get("PROCESSOR_IDENTIFIER", "unknown"),
133             "gpu": _gpu(),
134             "ram_bytes": _ram_bytes(),
135         },
136         "dependency_lock": {
137             "path": "services/api/requirements.lock",
138             "sha256": hashes.get("services/api/requirements.lock"),
139         },
140         "artifact_hashes": hashes,
141         "commands": commands,
142         "test_result": {
143             "exit_code": test_result["exit_code"],
144             "passed": test_result["exit_code"] == 0,
145             "summary_output": test_result["output"][-4000:],
146         },
147         "artifact_validation": {
148             "exit_code": validation["exit_code"],
149             "passed": validation["exit_code"] == 0,
150             "summary_output": validation["output"][-4000:],
151         },
152     }
153     RESULT_DIR.mkdir(parents=True, exist_ok=True)
154     (RESULT_DIR / "reproducibility_audit_report.json").write_text(
155         json.dumps(report, indent=2), encoding="utf-8"

```

```

156 )
157 summary = [
158     "# Reproducibility Audit Summary",
159     "",
160     f"- Generated UTC: {report['metadata']['generated_utc']}",
161     f"- Branch: '{report['metadata']['git_branch']}'",
162     f"- Commit: '{report['metadata']['git_commit']}'",
163     f"- Python: '{report['environment']['python_version']}'",
164     f"- OS: '{report['environment']['os']}'",
165     f"- CPU: '{report['environment']['cpu']}'",
166     f"- GPU: '{report['environment']['gpu']}'",
167     f"- RAM bytes: '{report['environment']['ram_bytes']}'",
168     f"- Tests passed: **{report['test_result']['passed']}**",
169     f"- Artifact validation passed: **{report['artifact_validation']['passed']}**",
170     "",
171     "## Executed commands",
172     "",
173 ]
174 for item in commands:
175     summary.append(f"- '{item['command']}' -> exit {item['exit_code']}")
176 summary.extend(
177     [
178         "",
179         "## Test output",
180         "",
181         "``text",
182         test_result["output"][-4000:].strip(),
183         "``",
184         "",
185         "The audit records artifact integrity and executed software checks. "
186         "It does not convert proxy benchmark results into live-application results.",
187     ]
188 )
189 (RESULT_DIR / "reproducibility_audit_summary.md").write_text(
190     "\n".join(summary) + "\n", encoding="utf-8"
191 )
192 print(f"Wrote reproducibility audit to {RESULT_DIR}")
193 return 0 if report["test_result"]["passed"] and report["artifact_validation"]["passed"] else 1
194
195
196 if __name__ == "__main__":
197     raise SystemExit(main())

```

E.9 Continuous-Integration Gate

When executed, the repository workflow installs the hash-pinned backend environment, executes the backend suite, regenerates thesis statistics, checks that committed reports are deterministic, validates the frozen artifacts, and builds the frontend. Its executable definition is preserved at `.github/workflows/ci.yml`; the path is recorded here instead of duplicating runner-specific comment encoding in the PDF.

E.10 Direct Backend Dependency Specification

The human-maintained direct dependency specification is reproduced below. The complete transitive environment, including hashes, is frozen separately in `services/api/requirements.lock`.

```
1 # Direct backend dependencies. Compile with pip-tools to requirements.lock.
2 fastapi==0.95.2
3 uvicorn[standard]==0.34.0
4 sqlmodel==0.0.30
5 httpx[http2]==0.28.1
6 trafilatura==2.0.0
7 lxml[html_clean]==6.0.2
8 lxml_html_clean==0.4.4
9 python-dotenv==1.0.0
10 tldextract==5.3.1
11 nltk==3.9.3
12 watchfiles==1.1.1
13 # huggingface-hub exposes this dependency only on supported x86_64 platforms.
14 # Pin it explicitly so a lock compiled on Windows is complete for Linux CI.
15 hf-xet==1.5.2
16 sentence-transformers==3.4.1
17 transformers==4.49.0
18 slowapi==0.1.9
19 python-json-logger==3.3.0
20 pydantic[email]==1.10.21
21 pytest==9.0.2
22 pytest-asyncio==1.3.0
23 pytest-mock==3.15.1
24 scipy==1.15.3
25 numpy==1.26.4
```

Appendix F

Glossary of Terms

Table F.1: Glossary of terms used throughout the thesis.

Term	Definition
Atomic claim	A single, independently verifiable factual statement produced by decomposing a longer input document.
Credibility prior	The explicit, rule-based domain score defined in Section 3.8, used before any learned scoring is applied.
Debate overhead	The latency multiplier introduced by enabling the optional Prover–Skeptic–Judge workflow (Section 3.7).
Evidence graph	The typed node/edge structure used by the Chapter 9 prototype to represent claims, passages, and their argumentative relations.
Archived benchmark	A fixed, versioned historical split and prediction record. Archival stability does not imply that the set was untouched during development or free of leakage.
Independence cluster	A set of evidence items linked by shared domain or high textual similarity (Section 3.7), treated as one corroborating source rather than several.
NEI	“Not Enough Information” – the verdict returned when available evidence does not support a decisive SUPPORTED or REFUTED outcome.
Provenance	The recorded origin of a piece of evidence: URL, content hash, retrieval timestamp, and retrieval status.
Selective risk	The error rate computed only over the subset of claims a system chooses to decide on, as opposed to abstaining from (Section 3.6).

Term	Definition
Undercut	An evidentiary relation that weakens a claim's assumption, scope, or source without directly asserting its negation.

Appendix G

Summary of Mathematical Notation

Table G.1: Notation used across Chapters 3, 6, and 9.

Symbol	Meaning
$y_i, \hat{y}_i$	Gold and predicted label for claim i .
n, K	Test-set size; number of classes ($K = 3$).
$\hat{p}$	Observed accuracy, used in the confidence-interval formula (Section 3.2).
$\overline{\text{score}}$	Average heuristic proxy score on the 0–100 scale (Section 3.3).
B_m, M	The m -th confidence bin and total number of bins, used in the ECE definition (Section 3.3).
n_{01}, n_{10}	Discordant-pair counts used in McNemar’s test (Section 3.4).
S_θ	The subset of claims on which a selective system chooses to decide, at threshold θ (Section 3.6).
$R(\theta)$	Selective risk at threshold θ (Section 3.6).
d_i, T_i	Base domain and token set of evidence item i , used in the independence-clustering rule (Section 3.7).
τ	Jaccard-similarity threshold for independence clustering ($\tau = 0.78$).
$\pi(p)$	Provenance tuple (u, h, t, s) for passage p (Section 9.3).
$G = (V, E)$	The typed evidence graph for one claim (Section 9.4).
$A(G)$	The audit function mapping a graph to $\{\text{PROCEED}, \text{NEI}, \text{CONFLICTING}, \text{HUMAN_REVIEW}\}$ (Section 9.4).

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